

IELTS Speaking

1- Talking about Books and Movies

1. Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you like to read books?

Marie: Yes ... I love reading ... I like nothing more than **to be engrossed in** a good book ... I regularly **take out** books from the library and usually read them **from cover to cover** in no time ... and I can't go to sleep at night without some good **bedtime reading** ...

Examiner: How often do you go to the cinema?

Jemma: Unfortunately we don't have a cinema near us so we have to go into the nearest town **to catch the latest movie** ... I usually avoid seeing popular **box-office hits** which I'm not always keen on seeing ... I prefer **low-budget films** ... **sci-fi** especially ... and there's a great cinema I go to that has frequent **showings** of films like these ...

Examiner: Do you prefer reading books or watching films?

Louisa: I'm not really **a big reader** ... I find books quite **heavy-going** ... so I much prefer to see a film ... perhaps it's the **special effects** or the **soundtrack** ... I don't know ... I just prefer a film ...

2. Part 2-style task *(Describe a book you have read or a film you have seen)*

- what this book or film was
 - when you read or saw it
 - why you decided to see the film or read the book
- and say if you enjoyed it and why.

Pauline I like reading ... especially English novels ... it's a great way to improve your vocabulary and there are so many fantastic authors to choose from ... one book that **came highly recommended** by my teacher was *The Mayor of Casterbridge* ... I was studying at a school in The UK at the time and she said it would give me a picture of what life was like years ago in the area I was living ... well I have to say I absolutely loved it ... it was **a real page-turner** ... it's a **historical novel** and **the setting** was a fictional town called Casterbridge ... but actually it was **based on** a town near where I was studying called Dorchester ... it had such a great **plot** ... to cut a long story short **it tells the story of** the downfall of a man called Henchard **the central character** who lives during a period of great social change around the time of the industrial revolution ... the reason I enjoyed it so much ... apart from the great story ... it gave me a picture

of what life had been like in the place I was studying at the time ... I really **couldn't put it down** ... a fantastic story ...

3. Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Is reading as pleasurable in digital format?

Alise: Personally I prefer reading a **paperback** or **hardback** ... especially if I'm reading a **classic** which I don't think feels right as an **e-book** ... but I can see it can be good for others ... my grandmother has an **e-reader** and she loves the way you can enlarge the text ...

Examiner: Do you think bookshops will survive the digital revolution?

Thomas: I think so ... at least I hope so ... I love **flicking through** books in a bookshop ... online shopping is useful ... finding out on Amazon if a book you want has **got a good review** ... maybe getting one that is difficult to find ... but I still love the experience of being in a bookshop ...

Examiner: Statistics show that visits to the cinema are up despite the availability of DVDs and online downloads. Why do you think this might be?

Jamie: I think it's the whole experience that the cinema offers ... going out **to see a film** when it **goes on general release** ... and seeing it **on the big screen** is more exciting than **watching the film** at home on TV ... especially if it's an **action movie** ... and watching it with others makes it even more special ...

- **an action movie**: phim hành động
- **to be engrossed in**: tập trung hoàn toàn vào một thứ
- **bedtime reading**: truyện đọc trước lúc đi ngủ
- **to be a big reader**: người đọc nhiều sách
- **to be based on**: dựa trên (vd: một câu chuyện có thật, một sự kiện lịch sử)
- **a box office hit**: một bộ phim ăn khách
- **to be heavy-going**: khó đọc (nói về thể loại sách)
- **a blockbuster**: phim thành công về mặt thương mại
- **to catch the latest movie**: đón xem bộ phim mới nhất
- **the central character**: nhân vật trung tâm
- **to come highly recommended**: được khuyến nghị cao
- **couldn't put it down**: không thể dừng đọc
- **an e-book**: sách điện tử
- **an e-reader**: thiết bị đọc sách điện tử
- **to flick through**: đọc lướt qua
- **to get a good/bad review**: nhận xét tốt/xấu
- **to go on general release**: được công chiếu rộng rãi
- **hardback**: sách bìa cứng (khác với paperback: sách bìa giấy)

- **a historical novel**: tiểu thuyết lịch sử
- **a low budget film**: một bộ phim với kinh phí thấp
- **on the big screen**: trên màn ảnh rộng
- **a page turner**: một cuốn sách bạn muốn đọc đi đọc lại
- **paperback**: sách bìa giấy/mỏng
- **plot**: cốt truyện
- **to read something from cover to cover**: đọc từ đầu chí cuối
- **sci-fi**: thể loại khoa học viễn tưởng
- **to see a film**: xem phim ở rạp
- **the setting**: bối cảnh
- **showings**: buổi chiếu phim
- **soundtrack**: nhạc phim
- **special effects**: hiệu ứng, kỹ xảo
- **to take out (a book from the library)**: mượn sách (từ thư viện)
- **to tell the story of**: liệt kê các sự kiện, kể câu chuyện
- **to watch a film**: xem phim trên TV

2-IELTS Speaking: Talking about Technology

Part 1 – Style questions

Examiner: Do you enjoy using technology?

Stephan: Well ... I wouldn't call myself a **techie** or a **computer buff** but I enjoy using computers ... I'd like to find out more about how they work ... when my **computer crashes** I never know what to do.

Examiner: Do you use the Internet for your studies?

Sophie: Yes ... I'd be lost without it ... I do lots of **video conferencing** to practise speaking and **social media** like Facebook is a good way to meet up with other students ... and I **download podcasts** that teach English vocabulary and grammar.

Examiner: Do you have your own computer?

Tania: Yes ... I have a Macbook Pro ... I use it all the time ... for **word processing** ... **browsing websites** and catching up with TV programmes I've missed.

Part 2 – Style task

Describe an item of technology you have that is very important. You should say:

- what the technology is
- when you got it

- how often you use it
and say how different your daily life would be without it.

Mattie: I don't have many **gadgets** ... just a computer ... a laptop and my mobile phone ... but I'll talk about my computer as it's so useful ... it's funny really ... 2 years ago I was still learning to use computers ... how to use email ... **send attachments** how to **access websites** ... then I decided to do a **digital editing** course for video and photography ... and so I bought the laptop when I started the course ... my husband had a **desktop PC** but it was very slow so I decided **to upgrade** to a powerful one because we do a lot of video editing on the course ... it's a **high-spec** laptop ... very fast ... the latest **operating system** ... it **boots up** really quickly and it's fun to use so it makes working a pleasure ... I've become a competent computer user now ... if I didn't have it I daresay I'd have to spend more time at college using their computers ... but on the positive side I suppose I'd read a lot more if I didn't have it ... I probably waste a lot of time **surfing the web** ... but hopefully I won't have to be without it .

Part 3- Style questions

Examiner: What do you think are the important things people need to learn when they start using computers?

Alejandro: Well ... there are things like how to use the Internet ... how **to enter a web address** ... how **to navigate websites** ... that kind of thing but it's also important to know how **to back up** your files in case your computer crashes ... and all about **Internet security**.

Examiner: What kind of technological developments have made the biggest impact on our lives?

Faydene: In my lifetime it has to be the Internet of course but I also think wifi has made a huge difference to how we interact with the Internet ... **wireless networks** at home and public **wifi hotspots** mean we can **go online** easily ... **access our mail** ... log into our work intranet and basically be connected wherever we are.

Examiner: Do computers make it much easier to study?

Jane: Definitely yes ... researching information is much easier with the Internet. You can **bookmark webpages** for future reference and writing essays is much easier ... being able **to cut and paste** sections of text means you can experiment with organisation ... so yes ... compared to years ago when you had a pile of books on your desk and a pen and paper ... it's now much easier.

- **to access websites/email**: truy cập trang web/ thư điện tử
- **to back up files**: lưu thư mục dự phòng (phòng trường hợp máy hỏng, mất dữ liệu)
- **to boot up**: khởi động máy tính
- **to bookmark a webpage**: đánh dấu trang web (để tiện xem lại khi cần)

- **to browse websites**: mở trang web
- **a computer buff**: chuyên gia máy tính
- **to cut and paste**: cắt dán chữ trên máy tính
- **a desktop PC**: máy tính để bàn
- **digital editing**: biên tập (ảnh hoặc phim) trên máy tính
- **download (podcasts)**: tải về
- **to enter a web address**: đánh tên địa chỉ web
- **a gadget**: thiết bị
- **to go online**: online, dùng Internet
- **high-spec (laptop)**: mạnh và hiện đại
- **Internet security**: an ninh mạng
- **intranet**: a mạng nội bộ
- **operating system**: phần mềm hệ thống
- **send an attachment**: gửi file đính kèm qua email
- **social media**: mạng xã hội (như Facebook hoặc Twitter)
- **to surf the web**: lướt web
- **a techie**: người đam mê công nghệ
- **to upgrade**: nâng cấp
- **video conferencing**: cuộc họp truyền hình ảnh qua mạng
- **wireless hotspot**: điểm truy cập Internet công cộng
- **wireless network**: mạng không dây

(Nguồn: <http://www.ieltssspeaking.co.uk/>)

3-IELTS Speaking: Talking about Fashion

Part 1 – Style questions

Examiner: Do you enjoy buying clothes?

Pedro: I used to ... yes ... like most young people I was a bit of a **slave to fashion** and I'd always have to buy that **must-have** shirt or pair of shoes ... I'm not so bothered now though ... I wouldn't feel comfortable wearing something **old fashioned** but I'm not as bothered as I used to be about what I wear ...

Examiner: What kind of clothes do you like to wear?

Marco: I prefer **casual clothes** actually ... I hate **getting dressed up** for special occasions ... personally I think it's possible **to look good in** a pair of jeans ... but that's my opinion ... I don't think my wife would call me a **fashion icon** that's for sure ...

Examiner: Are there many clothes shops where you live?

Sylvia: Yes ... there are lots in my town ... apart from the big chain stores we've

got a couple of really nice shops that sell **vintage clothes** ... old clothes but in a **classic style** that never really **go out of fashion** ... I love going there ...

Part 2 – Style task

Describe someone you know who dresses well. You should say

- who they are
 - how you know them
 - what kind of clothes they wear
- and say why you like the way they dress.

Tomoko: I'd like to talk about one of my teachers ... Miss Evans ... she teaches us English in the school I go to ... we always look forward to seeing what she's going to wear when our lessons start ... she's always very **well dressed** and **takes a lot of pride in her appearance** ... it's not that she dresses in very **smart clothes** ... she doesn't come to school **dressed to kill** or anything like that ... but what she wears really **suits her** ... and she has a great **sense of style** as well ... we often ask her where she gets some of her clothes and most of the time they're just **off the peg** ... and she says she's not interested in **designer labels** or anything like that ... she doesn't seem too concerned about **keeping up with the latest fashion** ... she just wears clothes that are **timeless**... yes ... Miss Evans is the person I think looks great in the clothes she wears ...

Part 3 – Style questions

Examiner: What factors do you think affect the clothes we choose to wear?

Maki: It depends ... where we are or where we're going is a big factor ... if you are going out to a club or party you're going **to dress for the occasion** ... and then there are those who think it's important to look like they're **on trend** ... they'll want to wear the latest fashions ... there are lots of factors really ...

Examiner: What kind of things determine what is in fashion and what we should be wearing?

Martin: I suppose the big **fashion houses** and **fashion shows** must have an effect but the clothes you see **on the catwalk** don't always reflect what normal people wear ... so I suppose it will be things like what singers are wearing in videos or models are wearing in magazines ... that kind of thing ...

Examiner: Is it possible to look good without spending lots of money on clothes?

Corinna: I'm sure it is ... yes ... I suppose it's about **having an eye for** what looks good ... knowing how **to mix and match** different items of clothing that go well together ... I think you can pick up great bargains in charity shops ... sometimes for youngsters even **hand-me-downs** can look good ...

to be on trend: cập nhật xu hướng

- **casual clothes:** trang phục bình thường
- **classic style:** phong cách đơn giản/cổ điển
- **designer label:** nhãn hàng thiết kế (thường để nói về một nhà mốt/công ty thời trang cao cấp và đắt tiền)
- **dressed to kill:** mặc trang phục rất có sức hút
- **to dress for the occasion:** ăn mặc phù hợp hoàn cảnh (ví dụ: công sở, đám cưới...)
- **fashionable:** thời trang, hợp mốt
- **fashion house:** nhà mốt (bán các thiết kế mới đắt tiền)
- **fashion icon:** biểu tượng thời trang
- **fashion show:** show diễn thời trang
- **to get dressed up:** ăn vận chỉnh tề (để đi đến một sự kiện nào đó)
- **to go out of fashion:** lỗi mốt
- **hand-me-downs:** quần áo cũ của anh hoặc chị nhường lại cho em mặc
- **to have an eye for (fashion):** có mắt thẩm mỹ (về thời trang)
- **to have a sense of style:** có gu ăn mặc
- **the height of fashion:** rất hợp thời trang
- **to keep up with the latest fashion:** bắt kịp xu hướng mới nhất
- **to look good in:** mặc vào thấy đẹp
- **to mix and match:** phối đồ, kết những trang phục không phải là một bộ với nhau
- **must-have item:** món đồ thời trang cần phải có
- **off the peg:** đồ may sẵn
- **old fashioned:** lỗi mốt
- **on the catwalk:** trên sàn diễn thời trang
- **a slave to fashion:** nghĩa đen: nô lệ thời trang (nghĩa bóng: những người luôn bị ám ảnh bởi chuyện ăn mặc hợp thời trang và chạy theo xu hướng)
- **smart clothes:** trang phục thanh lịch
- **to suit someone:** hợp, vừa vặn với ai đó
- **to take pride in one's appearance:** chú ý tới vẻ bề ngoài
- **timeless:** không bao giờ lỗi mốt
- **vintage clothes:** trang phục cổ điển
- **well-dressed:** ăn mặc đẹp

4- IELTS Speaking – Describe a Person

- **A selfish streak:** you sometimes act in a selfish way (đôi khi ích kỷ)

- Eg: You are good company but you may have a selfish streak.
- **Lose one's temper:** get angry (nổi giận)
 - Eg: My friend tends to lose her temper too easily.
- **Keep one's temper:** not get angry (giữ bình tĩnh để không nổi giận)
 - Eg: She finds it hard to keep her temper if she thinks someone is making a fool out of her.
- **Have a good sense of humor:** be humorous/funny (hài hước)
 - Eg: My friend John has a good sense of humor. His jokes make us laugh all the times.
- **Highly intelligent:** very smart (cực kì thông minh)
 - Eg: My daughter is highly intelligent, with an IQ of 146.
- **Fiercely loyal:** stronger than "extremely loyal" (cực kì trung thành)
 - Eg: Jane is fiercely loyal to her friends.
- **Keep one's word:** do what you say you will do, keep your promises (giữ lời hứa)
 - Eg: My teacher has a strong sense of responsibility and always keep his words.
- **Bear a grudge:** resent for a long time bad things other have done to you (thù dai)
 - Eg: My brother always bears a grudge, he can't forget bad things his friends did to him.
- **Brutally honest:** honest in a way that may hurt (thành thật tới mức làm phật ý hoặc tổn thương người khác)
 - Eg: I don't think being brutally honest is good because you might sometimes hurt others' feelings.

Sau đây là một số đoạn nói mẫu có sử dụng những collocations trên nhé:

1. My boyfriend has a really friendly, outgoing personality and a **great sense of humour**. He's **highly intelligent** and has a razor-sharp mind. We've been together, now for a year, and I like him a lot, but he has a tendency to **lose his temper**. Sometimes I wonder if I should be **brutally honest** with him and tell him.

I know that I have a tendency to **bear a grudge**, but I just can't forget something bad a friend did to me recently. She **has a selfish streak** and doesn't care sometimes how much she hurts my feelings. I am finding it increasingly hard to **keep my temper** with her. But perhaps it might be better to **keep my temper** and let her know how I really feel.

5-IELTS Speaking Part 1: giving negative answers

1. What sports or physical activities do you regularly do?

Unfortunately I don't have time to do any sports or physical activities because of my work commitments. I'd like to find more time for regular exercise.

2. Which sport or game would you like to be good at?

I'd like to be good at tennis. It must be great to be able to hit the ball as hard as you can and watch it land exactly where you wanted it to.

3. Do you prefer watching or playing sports?

I don't watch much sport on TV and I'm not a big sports fan, so I think I would probably enjoy doing sports more than watching them.

4. Do you think children should be encouraged to do more sport?

Yes, I think that sport is really important for children. Sports and games teach children to play together and try their best.

Mở rộng câu trả lời của mình với những ý như:

+ Because I don't have much free time, I usually do exercise while I'm cooking, just a few ones like bend down, running around my kitchen and walking from home to my children's school. Although I practise not much, but I think those little things are very important to keep my body fit.

Hay đối với câu số 4, bạn cũng có thể nói đôi điều về lợi ích của việc tập thể dục đối với trẻ em như:

+ Children, especially in their early ages, need to keep fit and have a balance, healthy diet. And in order to help them to have a healthy life style, I believe that they certainly will need to exercise. A sport child will be healthier than a child which is a couch potato- I mean that a child who always sit in front of a television and do nothing else. Furthermore, enjoying in sports of physical activities may brings friends to children, and so that they will be much more socialized, or even encourage their team spirit if those sports need some kinds of team work such as football, basketball,...

Sau đây, tình hình là để "cứu nguy" cho các sĩ tử nhà ta chuẩn bị thi IELTS, thì tốt nhất là chúng mình vẫn phải biết đôi chút vốn từ Sport phải hông các bạn: (From <http://www.englishclub.com/>)

Word	Example sentence	Meaning
arena	The arena was full of excited spectators cheering on their team.	a level area for holding sports events, surrounded by seats for spectators
amateur	The Olympic Games were originally for amateur athletes only.	engaged in something, like playing sports, without payment; non-professional
athlete	Most professional athletes spend hours every day in training.	a person who trains for and competes in a sport
athletics	There are some very good runners on our athletics team.	'track and field' events of running, jumping, throwing, etc.
award	All the members of the winning team were awarded a gold medal.	to give someone something as a reward for high achievement
beat	Italy beat France to win the 2006 FIFA World Cup.	to defeat someone in a game or a competition
captain	The captain usually leads his or her team onto the field.	the leader of a team
catch	A wicketkeeper in cricket must be very good at catching the ball.	to grab and hold something that has been thrown
champion	The boxer Muhammad Ali was World Heavyweight Champion three times.	a top-rated, highly successful player
cheer on	The fans made a lot of noise cheering on their team.	to shout encouragement to a team or a player
coach	Players should carry out their coach's instructions during a game.	a person who trains and directs an athlete or a sports team
compete	Over 10,000 athletes will compete in the Olympic Games.	to take part in a contest or a competition
competition	The English Premiership League is one of the world's top football competitions.	an organized event in which people compete to win
competitor	Each competitor in a golf tournament must record his or her own score.	a person who takes part in a competition or a sporting contest
contest	Do you know who won this year's figure skating contest?	a game or event in which people compete to win
court	The tennis courts at Wimbledon in London have a grass surface.	a quadrangular area on which ball games are played, such as tennis or basketball
course	A golf course usually has eighteen holes.	an area of land prepared for racing, golf, or other sports

cup	After they won the final game, the winners were awarded the Championship Cup.	a cup-shaped trophy, awarded as a prize in a contest
defeat	Our players were very happy after they defeated their opponents in the final game.	to win a victory over opponents in a game or contest; to beat
defend	The team attacked and scored two goals, then spent the rest of the game defending the lead.	to protect one's goal rather than attempt to score against one's opponents
draw	The score was 1-0, but the losing team got a late goal and the game ended in a 1-1 draw.	to finish a contest or game with an even score; tie
event	The 100 metres run is one of the most exciting events in athletics.	a particular contest in a sporting programme
fan	Sometimes the umpire of a tennis match has to tell noisy fans to be quiet.	a person who supports a particular sport, team or player
field	How many players are allowed on the field during a baseball game?	a piece of land marked out for a sports contest e.g. hockey field
final score	Today's basketball game was very close. The final score was 84 to 82.	the score at the end of a game
gym / gymnasium	Our gym has a lot of new exercise equipment, including running machines and cycling machines.	a room or building equipped for physical exercise
half-time	The players went into the rooms at half-time and listened to their coach.	the interval between the first and second halves of a game
judge	In sports like diving and gymnastics, judges score each performance in a contest.	a person who rates the quality of a sporting performance, usually by awarding points
league	Nearly every town in the U.S. has teams in a local baseball league.	a group of sports clubs that play each other over a period for a championship
leisure	It's good for kids to spend some of their leisure time playing sports.	free time, or the use of free time for enjoyment
lob	Her lob flew high into the air and dropped into the back of the court, just inside the baseline.	a shot that is hit in a high arc, usually over the opponent's head
manager	Liverpool sacked their manager after they lost eight of their previous ten games.	the person in charge of a sports team

medal	Every athlete's dream is to win a gold medal at the Olympic Games.	a piece of engraved metal given to signify an achievement or an honor
object	The object of the game of football is to score more goals than the opponents.	the thing you want to get or achieve; what you aim to do
offside	Forwards have to learn how to avoid being caught in an offside position.	In an illegal position ahead of the ball (in football, rugby, hockey, etc.)
opponent	Roger Federer's opponent in the Wimbledon final was Rafael Nadal.	the person one competes against in a contest or a game; rival
pass	A defender tries to pass the ball to a forward in a good position to score.	to throw or kick the ball to another player on one's own team
penalty	The penalty for abusing a referee is usually a one-match suspension.	a punishment imposed on a player or team for breaking the rules of a sport
perform	All the athletes will do their best to perform well in the Olympic Games.	to carry out a practised activity, such a play a sport
performance	Venus Williams put in one the best performances of her life to win the tournament.	an instance of competing in a sports event in public
physique	Rugby players work hard in the gym to build up their physiques.	the form or shape of a person's body
pitch (1)	The fans cheered as the players ran onto the pitch.	a playing field (British)
pitch (2)	Our pitcher threw one of the best pitches of his life to win the game.	a throw of the ball, esp. in baseball and softball
player	How many players are on the court during a doubles match in tennis?	a person who plays a sport
practise (U.S. spelling; practice)	Professional golfers spend hours every day practising their shots.	to repeatedly do something in order to develop one's skill
professional	Tiger Woods has been a professional golfer since he was 20 years old.	a person whose paid occupation is playing a sport
record	Do you know who holds the world record for the men's 100 metres?	the best performance that has been officially measured and noted
referee	The referee saw a foul, blew his whistle and awarded a free kick.	a sports official with authority to make rulings during a contest

rules	In several sports there is an offside rule, and it's often difficult to explain.	the laws or regulations that govern how a game or sport is played
score	Do you know how to keep score in badminton?	the number of points a competitor or team earns during a game
serve	Serving the ball is one of the most important skills in sports like tennis.	to hit the ball to begin play (in tennis, table tennis, squash, volleyball, etc.)
shoot	In basketball, players try shoot from outside the 3-point line to score the extra points.	to kick, hit, or throw the ball in an attempt to score a goal (in soccer, hockey, basketball, etc.)
skill	Ken has gone to a boxing camp to improve his boxing skills.	the ability to do something well
spectator	Spectators can add a lot to sporting events by creating an exciting atmosphere.	a person who watches an event
sportsmanship	Good managers know how to teach their players sportsmanship.	an attitude of fairness, respect for opponents, and graciousness in winning or losing
stadium	The stadium was built for sports, but it's sometimes used for concerts as well.	a sports arena with tiered seating for spectators
strategy	One of the jobs of the manager or coach is to develop a strategy for winning each game.	a plan to achieve an objective
tackle	Rugby players have to learn how to tackle an opponent strongly but fairly.	to challenge an opponent who has the ball
tactics	Players use tactics such as attacking their opponent's weaknesses in order to win.	an action or strategy planned to achieve an objective
talent	Our daughter's basketball coach says she has a lot of natural talent for the game.	a natural aptitude or skill
teammate	The team wins because the players are always looking for their teammates.	a fellow member of a sports team
teamwork	The best teams spend a lot of time on the training ground working on teamwork.	the combined action of a group of people
tie	The score was very close throughout the game, and it ended in a tie with 89 points each.	a result in a game in which teams have the same final score; a draw

tournament	The four major tennis tournaments form what is known as the 'Grand Slam'.	a series of contests between a number of competitors, who compete for an overall prize
trainer	Some players are a bit lazy and need a strict trainer to make them work hard.	a person who helps athletes develop their skills and fitness
train	The hockey team trains every Tuesday and Thursday after school.	to teach a skill over time through instruction; to practise a skill
trophy	The players carried the trophy over their heads as they ran around the stadium.	a decorative object awarded as a prize in a contest or a tournament
umpire	In a game of cricket, there are two umpires on the field during play.	a sports official with authority to make rulings during a contest
victory	The players had worked very hard, and they deserved their victory.	the act of winning a game or contest
whistle	The referee blew his whistle twice to signal the end of the match.	a small instrument that makes a high-pitched noise when blown

(Nguồn: hocielts.vn)

See eye to eye= If you 'see eye to eye' with someone you agree with them

Rub sb up the wrong way = If someone 'rubs you up the wrong way' they unintentionally annoy you.

Fight like cat and dog = If you 'fight like cat and dog' with someone you regularly argue violently with them.

6-IELTS Music Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: What kind of music do you listen to?

Katherine: I'm a big fan of **classical music** ... it doesn't make me very popular with my children ... their **taste in music** is completely different ... they always want to listen to their favourite **rock bands** ...

Examiner: Do you play any instruments?

Jamie: No I don't ... I've always wished I'd **taken up a musical instrument** ... I'd love to be able to play the guitar ... but I think I'm a bit **tone deaf** so perhaps I'd find it hard

Examiner: Have you got any hobbies or interests?

Marco: I'm really into **live music** ... I go to a lot of **music festivals** ... I think a **live performance** always sounds more exciting than a recorded version ... as long as the performers can sing and play well of course ...

Part 2-style task (a song you like to listen to)

Describe a song you like to listen to. You should say

- what the piece of music is called
- how long you have liked it
- when you like to listen to it

and say why you like it so much.

Millie: Well ... I'm a little older than most students and when I was young Abba the Swedish **pop group** were very famous ... I don't think it was cool to like them even though they had a **huge following** but I think now people have realised what wonderful songs they wrote ... one **piece of music** in particular is called 'Slipping through my fingers' ... it wasn't a **massive hit** but I love it ... it's a song for parents and it's all about how quickly our children grow up ... it's a **slow number** and like a lot of their songs it's a very **catchy tune** ... the two women in Abba had great voices and it's the kind of music you can also **sing along to** easily ... even if you don't have a great voice ... I listen to Abba when I feel like a **sing-song** ... and I especially like to listen when I'm doing the housework ... it stops me thinking about the hard work ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Is the Internet a good or bad thing for the music industry?

Thomas: On the one hand it's good for marketing new **musical talent** or particular bands but it's so easy to share and **download tracks** for free I think it is costing the industry a lot of money ...

Examiner: Should music be treated as seriously as subjects like maths or sciences at school?

Carla: I think it should ... I don't think it should be taught in a boring way ... I mean making children **read music** ... but I do think they should be encouraged to play instruments and to **play things by ear** perhaps ... to keep the lessons fun ...

Examiner: Where do people usually enjoy listening to music?

Sally: In lots of ways or places ... as **background music** when they are doing something else ... at concerts when a band **goes on tour** ... or in clubs or discos ...

- **adoring fans**: people who love a particular band or singer
- **background music**: music that is played while something else is happening
- **a catchy tune**: a song that is easy to remember and makes you want to sing it
- **classical music**: music that is regarded as part of a long, formal tradition
- **to download tracks**: to obtain music from the Internet
- **to have a great voice**: to sing well
- **to go on tour**: to go on a planned series of performances around a region or country
- **a huge following**: a large number of fans
- **live music**: music that is listened to while it is performed (not recorded)
- **live performance**: (see live music)
- **a massive hit**: a record that sells lots of copies
- **a music festival**: music performances at a venue often over several days
- **musical talent**: skilled at music
- **to be/sing out of tune**: to not be in harmony/to sing the wrong notes
- **a piece of music**: an item of music
- **to play by ear**: to play without reading the musical notes
- **a pop group**: a small group of people who play or sing pop music together
- **to read music**: to understand and follow written musical notes
- **a rock band**: a group of musicians that play rock music
- **to sing along to**: to join in singing
- **a sing-song**: to sing informally, often with other people
- **a slow number**: a song with a slow tempo
- **to take up a musical instrument**: to begin learning a musical instrument
- **taste in music**: the music someone likes
- **to be tone deaf**: to be unable to distinguish the different notes in music

➔ What kind of music do you like to listen to?
 What was the first piece of music you ever bought?
 Is the Internet a good or bad thing for the music industry?

7-IELTS Town and City Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: What is it like where you live?

Christiane: I live in a **residential area** of a busy town in the south of Spain ... we have all the facilities you need ... good **public transport** ... a good **shopping centre** ... it's nice ...

Examiner: Do you like living in the city?

Andrea: Yes I do ... I like going out with my friends and there are lots of **lively bars and restaurants** within walking distance of my apartment ... I'm a bit of a culture vulture as well so it's great to have access to art exhibitions and that kind of thing ...

Examiner: Do you get many tourists visiting your area?

Mandy: Not really no ... I live in the **inner-city** and the area is a little **run down** ... it's basically a lot of **high-rise flats** and many of the shops are **boarded up** ... so nothing to interest tourists really ...

Part 2-style task

Describe an interesting town or city in your country that visitors might enjoy. You should say

- what the place is called
- where the place is
- what the facilities are like
- and say why visitors might enjoy going there.

Monique: Anyone who comes to my country really should spend some time in Barcelona ... it's a beautiful place ... it's not what you would call a **sprawling city** ... it's quite compact really and you could walk across the city in a couple of hours ... but there's no need to do that as we have a fantastic **public transport system** so it's easy **to get around** ... there are various districts all with their own character ... you have the **upmarket shops** in the centre ... you'll find lots of **chain stores** you'll recognise from your own country but also local brands as well ... we have the narrow streets in the Gothic district with lots of **fashionable boutiques** and **tourist attractions** ... there's the Olympic area and the beaches along the coast ... and dotted around the city are some lovely **public spaces** ... parks and squares in the **city centre** and **on the outskirts** of Barcelona where people relax with their friends and family ... and of course **pavement cafes** everywhere ... all that and some great historical **places of interest** ... so a great destination for tourists ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: What are the advantages of living in a city or big town?

Carrie: I think it's having access to **local facilities** really ... local shops as well as access to larger **shopping malls** in the city centre ... and if you're well-off you can afford to live **in the suburbs** away from the busy traffic ...

Examiner: In your experience are city centres usually attractive places?

Mary: Some can be yes ... especially those with a historical interest ... but sometimes they're full of ugly **office blocks** ... **multi-story car parks** ... and residents living in **poor housing** ... it depends on the city doesn't it?

Examiner: What are some of the challenges facing towns and cities?

Penny: I suppose **traffic congestion** is a major problem ... and the growth in **out-of-town supermarkets and retail parks** mean lots of town centre shops are **closing down** ... plus a shortage of good quality housing ... I think these are the major challenges ...

- **boarded up shops:** shops that are no longer doing business
- **chain stores:** well-known brands with shops in multiple cities
- **to close down:** to stop doing business
- **fashionable boutiques:** fashionable clothes shops
- **to get around:** to travel around
- **high-rise flats:** multi-story apartments
- **inner-city:** the central part of a city where people live and where conditions are often poor
- **in the suburbs:** the outer area of large towns and cities where people live
- **lively bars/restaurants:** bars or restaurants with a good atmosphere
- **local facilities:** local buildings or services serving the public
- **multi-story car parks:** car parks on several floors
- **office block:** a large building that contains offices
- **out of town shopping centre/retail park:** large shopping centres outside of the town or city
- **pavement cafe:** cafes with tables outside on the pavement
- **places of interest:** buildings that have a particular interest for visitors
- **poor housing:** housing that is not in good condition
- **public spaces:** areas in a town or city that are open to the public
- **public transport system:** public vehicles such as buses and trains that operate at regular times on fixed routes
- **residential area:** an area where people live
- **run down:** old and of a poor standard
- **shopping centre:** an area consisting of multiple shops
- **shopping malls:** large indoor shopping centres
- **sprawling city:** a city that has grown over time and which covers a wide area
- **tourist attraction:** a place of interest to tourists
- **traffic congestion:** heavy traffic making it difficult to move around a town or city
- **upmarket shops:** expensive fashionable shops

➔ Do you live in a town, city or the countryside?

What do you like about where you live?

What are some of the challenges facing towns and cities?

8-IELTS Physical Appearance Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you look like any other people in your family?

Carlo: No ... not at all ... take my brother for example ... he has short **cropped hair** and has quite a **pointed face** ... he's also quite **fair-skinned** compared to me ...

Examiner: Tell me about your family.

Andrea: My father's **getting on a bit** ... he's **in his 60s** ... but he **looks very young for his age** ... he still does lots of exercise and is quite **well-built** ...

Examiner: What does your best friend look like?

Mandy: She's the same age as me ... she has **shoulder-length hair** ... **fair hair** ... she has a **slim figure** and is **medium height** ...

Part 2-style task (a person whose appearance you like)

Describe a person whose appearance you like. You should say

- who this person is
- what their relationship is to you
- what they look like

and say what it is about their appearance you like.

Monique: OK ... I'd like to talk about my aunt ... her name's Marta and she's quite a character ... she's **middle-aged** but has a very **youthful appearance** ... she's a little **overweight** I suppose but not too much ... she has a friendly **round face** framed by **thick blonde hair** ... she has a lovely **complexion** and she's always **well-turned out** ... she actually always looks like she's going out for the evening to somewhere special ... there's **never a hair out of place** ... I've always thought she **bears a striking resemblance to** someone on TV ... I can't remember the name now ... she **wears glasses** and always seems to have a different pair on every time I see her ... I like the way she looks because she wears clothes that are right for her age and manages to look glamorous without it looking like she's too done up ... yes ... I'll be happy if I look like her when I'm her age ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Is it important to dress well whenever we go out?

Mark: It depends where you're going ... I know some people **get done up** just to go to the shops ... but I don't see the point ... you shouldn't go out looking **scruffy** with **disheveled hair** but I really don't see the point in **getting dressed up to the nines** unless you're going somewhere special ...

Examiner: Do people worry too much about their appearance as they get older?

Mira: I'm sure they do ... yes ... but it happens to all of us doesn't it ... we all **go grey** eventually and get **hard of hearing** ... we start **to lose our figure** ... that's why plastic surgery is so popular ... personally I think we just need **to grow old gracefully** and not worry too much about how we look ...

Examiner: Is attractiveness a quality worthwhile aiming for?

Phoebe: I'd like to say no ... it shouldn't matter what we look like in terms of our physical appearance ... but unfortunately it seems women especially are taken more seriously if they are **good looking** with a **slender figure** with perfect **make up** and so on

...

- **to bear a striking resemblance:** to look very similar to
- **cropped hair:** very short hair
- **disheveled hair:** untidy hair
- **to dress up to the nines:** to dress very smartly or glamorously
- **fair hair:** light-coloured hair
- **to be fair-skinned:** light skinned
- **to get done up:** to dress smartly
- **to be getting on a bit:** to be getting old
- **to go grey:** to have hair that is turning grey
- **to be good looking:** to be attractive
- **to grow old gracefully:** to act in a way that embraces the fact you are getting older
- **to be hard of hearing:** to find it difficult to hear
- **in his/her 30s/40s:** to be 20/30 something
- **scruffy:** dressed untidily
- **to look young for your age:** to look younger than you are
- **to lose one's figure:** to have a figure that has lost its toned shape
- **complexion:** natural skin colour and texture
- **make up:** cosmetics
- **medium height:** average height
- **middle-aged:** approximately between 45-65
- **to never have a hair out of place:** perfectly styled hair
- **to be overweight:** to weigh more than is regarded as healthy
- **pointed face:** the opposite of a round face
- **shoulder-length hair:** hair that comes down to the shoulders and no further
- **slender figure:** a figure that is tall and slim
- **slim figure:** attractively thin
- **thick hair:** a lot of hair
- **to wear glasses:** to use spectacles
- **to be well-built:** to be muscular
- **to be well-turned out:** to look smart
- **youthful appearance:** to look young
- ➔ How would you describe yourself?
What does your best friend look like?
Do people worry too much about their appearance as they get older?

9-IELTS Business Vocabulary.

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you work or are you a student?

Hati: I **run my own business** actually ... I have an online business selling cosmetics ... I **set up the business** 5 years ago and I'm really enjoying **working for myself** ...

Examiner: What is your ideal job?

Kaori: I don't think I'd enjoy working for a big company ... I think I'd like **to go it alone**

and be **self-employed** ... I'm not sure what area of business it would be but I think I'd enjoy the process of **drawing up a business plan** and seeing if I could be successful ...

Examiner: Is your town a nice place to live?

Monique: It's OK ... the main problem we have is our local high street ... it used to be a busy centre but lots of shops have **gone bust** ... it must be very difficult **to make a profit** when you have huge supermarkets in the area and a lot haven't been able to survive with such **cut-throat competition** ...

Part 2-style task (a business you know that you admire)

Describe a business you know that you admire. You should say

- what this business is
- what the business sells
- how long you have known about the business

and say why you like it so much.

Magda: Actually I discovered a business very recently that I like so much I'd like to do something similar in the future ... it's a small **niche business** that runs courses in how to cook ... especially bread ... the owner uses his kitchen for the courses and **went into business with** a local community shop and sells a lot of the bread and cakes they make in the shop ... I first got to hear about the business last year ... my wife paid for me to do one of the baking courses and I got to know the owner during the training ... it's a **lifestyle business** really ... he doesn't have plans **to take on employees** or expand into new areas ... he's happy **earning a living** doing the thing he loves ... I really admire what he does and I'm sure a lot of people would love to do something similar ... he **has a web presence** ... in fact that's how we got to find out about his company ... and he uses social media **to raise the company profile** ... but he's the only person involved in **running the business** so he's in complete control of where the business goes ... that's something that must make it really satisfying ... as long as he's managing **to balance the books** and the **cash flow** is healthy I'm sure he must be very pleased with what he has achieved ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Why do some people decide to set up their own business?

Marion: I suppose it's the idea of being in control of your own destiny ... or of believing in a product or service idea you may have ... plus it must be very exciting ... **launching products** ... **winning contracts** ... and seeing your **sales figures** improving must be wonderful ...

Examiner: What are some of the dangers involved in starting a business?

Hiro: Well ... obviously you need to have a good idea ... some people say you need to

do market research beforehand so you know what the market wants ... if you don't do this you could **go under** ... and if it is a good idea the chances are someone else is doing the same thing so you could end up facing **stiff competition** ...

Examiner: What are some of things you have to do when running your own business that might not appeal to everyone?

Katy: Personally i don't like being in debt so **taking out a business loan** wouldn't suit me at all ... and I know a lot of companies do **cold calling** to try and **drum up business** ... that's something I'd hate to do ... and **laying people off** if the business gets into trouble ... that would be horrible ...

- **to balance the books:** to not spend more money than you are earning
- **to be self-employed:** to work for yourself/to not work for an employer
- **to cold call:** to make a sales call to someone without asking them for permission first
- **cut throat competition:** when one company lowers its prices, forcing other companies to do the same, sometimes to a point where business becomes unprofitable
- **to do market research:** to do research into what potential customers would or wouldn't buy
- **to draw up a business plan:** to write a plan for a new business
- **to drum up business:** to try to get customers
- **to earn a living:** to earn money
- **to go bust:** when a business is forced to close because it is unsuccessful
- **cash flow:** the money coming in and going out of a business
- **to go into business with:** to join another person to start or expand a business
- **to go it alone:** to start your own business
- **to go under:** (see 'to go bust')
- **to have a web presence:** to have a website or social media profile that showcases your business
- **to launch a product:** to start selling and promoting a new product
- **to lay someone off:** when a company ends an employee's contract of employment
- **lifestyle business:** a business that is set up to bring in a sufficient income and no more
- **to make a profit:** to earn more money than it costs to run the business
- **niche business:** a business that serves a small, particular market
- **to raise a company profile:** to make more people aware of a business
- **to run your own business:** to have a business of your own
- **sales figures:** a report of the income a company generates through sales of products or services
- **to set up a business:** to start a business
- **stiff competition:** strong competition from other companies in the same area of work
- **to take on employees:** to employ people

- **to take out a loan:** to borrow money
- **to win a contract:** when a business gets legally-binding work with an individual or company
- **to work for yourself:** (see 'to be self-employed')

➔ What is your ideal job?

Do you work or are you a student?

Which jobs are highly respected in your country?

10-IELTS Personality Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: How would you describe yourself?

Paula: Everyone tells me I **take after** my mum as I'm quite **laid-back** ... I think I'm **good company** but you should ask my friends if they agree ...

Examiner: In which ways are you similar to your friends?

Manuel: I seem to be attracted to **introverts** ... not people who are **painfully shy** but most of my friends are a little **reserved** ... and I think that's what I'm like ...

Examiner: Are you similar or different to your brother(s)/sister(s)?

Mira: I think my brother and I are very similar ... I'd say we're **fun-loving** and tend to be a bit **extroverted** ... my brother is certainly **the life and soul of the party** ... I'm not sure that applies to me ...

Part 2-style task (a teacher you once had who you enjoyed being taught by)

Describe a teacher you once had who you enjoyed being taught by. You should say

- who this person was
- when they were your teacher
- which subject they taught you

and describe what it was about their character that you liked.

Carolina: I'd like to describe my English teacher from school ... Miss Thomas ... this was a few years ago now and she was my teacher at a time when I was getting a little bored with being at school ... unlike some of the other teachers Miss Thomas never **lost her temper** ... she was very calm and **easy-going** ... she was also very **broad-minded** ... we were able to ask her questions about lots of subjects that some other teachers would refuse to discuss which made us respect her even more ... she had a great **sense of humour** too ... she'd laugh at our jokes as well as making us laugh ... and she would also **bend over backwards** to help us with our work ... she always **put us first** and often stayed around at the end of class to talk with anyone who needed help ... apparently she was highly respected within her field but you would never know as she was the type that

hid her light under a bushel ... she was very modest and **self-effacing** ... so yes ... Miss Thomas was a teacher I have fond memories of ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Which personal qualities do you think we most want to pass on to our children?

Martin: I certainly would want my children to be **self-confident** and **self-assured** ... I really believe that people who feel good about themselves are in a good position to face what life has to offer them ... and I'd hope they wouldn't be **self-centred** ... but remembered to think about others ...

Examiner: Which characteristics do you think are the least appealing in a person?

Marianne: Well ... people who are very **narrow-minded** are difficult to get on with ... it's nice when someone is open to other people's opinion and willing to think about their own views ... and people who are **two-faced** can be a little irritating ... relationships are built on trust and without honesty there's not much left ...

Examiner: Which personality types do you think are less likely to suffer from stress or anxiety?

Sol: Probably people who are **thick-skinned** ... who don't let people or problems affect them too much ... and if you are **fair-minded** you'll be less likely to overreact to situations or be **quick-tempered** ...

- **to be the life and soul of the party:** a fun person, someone who is the centre of activity
- **to bend over backwards:** to try very hard to help someone
- **broad-minded:** prepared to accept other views or behaviours
- **easy-going:** relaxed and not easily worried about anything
- **extrovert:** an energetic person who likes the company of others
- **fair-minded:** to treat people equally
- **fun-loving:** to enjoy having fun
- **to hide one's light under a bushel:** to hide one's talents and skills
- **good company:** enjoyable to socialise with
- **good sense of humour:** the ability to understand what is funny
- **introvert:** someone who is shy
- **laid-back:** see 'easy-going'
- **to lose one's temper:** to suddenly become angry
- **narrow minded:** opposite of 'broad-minded' (see above)
- **painfully shy:** very shy
- **to put others first:** to think of others before yourself
- **quick-tempered:** to become angry quickly
- **reserved:** shy

- **self-assured**: confident
- **self-centred**: thinks only of oneself
- **self-confident**: believes in one's own ability or knowledge
- **self-effacing**: to not try to get the attention of others (especially in terms of hiding one's skills or abilities)
- **to take after**: to be like (often another member of the family)
- **thick-skinned**: not easily affected by criticism
- **trustworthy**: can be trusted
- **two-faced**: not honest or sincere. Will say one thing to someone to their face and another when they are not present.

➔ How would you describe yourself?
 In which ways are you similar to your friends?
 Which personal qualities do you think we most want to pass on to our children?

12-IELTS Accommodation Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you live in a house or an apartment?

Callum: Actually I live **on campus** ... in a **single room** in **halls of residence** ... all first year students are encouraged to do that as they're close to the university ... next year I plan to move into **student digs** in town ...

Examiner: Tell me about where you live.

Julia: I live with my parents **in the suburbs** of Madrid ... we only **moved in** recently ... in fact we had a **house-warming party** just a few weeks ago ...

Examiner: What kind of accommodation do most people live in in your city?

Maria: In the city itself the majority of people live in **apartment blocks** ... that's what surprised me about England ... most people seem to live in **terraced houses** with lovely **back gardens** ...

Part 2-style task (a house or an apartment you would like to live in)

Describe a house or an apartment you would like to live in. You should say

- what kind of accommodation it would be
- where it would be
- who would live there with you

and say why you would enjoy living in this place.

Paolo: I think most people when answering this question would say they'd like to live in a big **detached house** with **spacious rooms** ... views of the countryside and so on ... but actually my **ideal home** would be a lot different ... I've always loved the idea of having a

mobile home ... a really expensive one with **all the mod cons** ... so I could live wherever I wanted or at least have lots of holidays and be able to take all my **home comforts** with me whenever I travelled ... I realise this would have to be a second home as I'd need a base ... a **permanent address** ... but the mobile home would be the accommodation I'd find it exciting to live in ... I suppose once I settle down and have children I'll want **to get on the property ladder** ... I'll be like everyone else ... saving up **to put down a deposit** on a house or an apartment ... I don't think my family would want to live in a mobile home ... but I like to think I'll still keep that **dream home** in mind ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Is it better to own your own home or to rent?

Ana: I think both have their advantages ... living in **rented accommodation** isn't necessarily a bad thing ... you don't have a huge debt like you do when you **take out a mortgage** but I suppose the **property market** offers you an investment for the future ... I'm sure that's why most people prefer **to own their own home** ...

Examiner: What options are available to young couples looking for accommodation in your country?

Toni: If they want to buy their own home it isn't easy for **first-time buyers** ... mortgages are hard to get so most people live with their parents or in **rented accommodation** ... but that can also be very expensive ... you often have to **pay rent in advance** ... and if the accommodation isn't **fully furnished** you have the expense of buying furniture ...

Examiner: What are some of the pleasures involved in making a home for ourselves?

Suki: I suppose it starts with **house-hunting** ... finding your ideal home ... some people enjoy **doing up an old property** ... giving a property that's old and tired a new lease of life ... others like making wherever they live feel like home with some **home comforts** ...

- **(all the) mod cons**: technology at home that makes jobs easier such as a washing machine, dishwasher etc.
- **apartment block**: a large building made up of smaller units of apartments
- **back garden**: a garden at the rear of the house
- **detached house**: a house that is not physically connected to another property
- **to do up a property**: to repair an old building
- **dream home**: a home you regard as perfect
- **first-time buyer**: someone buying a property for the first time, especially when taking out a loan (mortgage)
- **fully-furnished**: a rented property with all furniture included
- **to get on the property ladder**: to buy a property with the aim of buying another bigger or more expensive one later in life

- **hall of residence:** a college or university building where students live
- **home comforts:** things that make a home feel comfortable to live in
- **house-hunting:** looking for a property to live in
- **house-warming party:** a party to celebrate moving into a new home
- **ideal home:** a perfect home
- **to live on campus:** to live on the university or college grounds
- **mobile home:** a home that can be moved by a vehicle or one that has its own engine
- **to move into:** to begin to live in a property
- **to own your own home:** to have bought the property you live in
- **to pay rent in advance:** weekly or monthly rent paid at the beginning of the week or month
- **permanent address:** a fixed address
- **property market:** the buying and selling of land or buildings
- **to put down a deposit:** to pay an amount of money as the first in a series of future payments
- **rented accommodation:** property owned by someone else and for which a person pays a fixed amount to live in
- **single room:** a room for one person
- **spacious room:** a large room
- **student digs:** student accommodation
- **the suburbs:** a residential area on the edge of towns or cities
- **to take out a mortgage:** to borrow a large amount of money, paid back over several years, in order to buy a house
- **terraced house:** a house connected on both sides by other properties
-
- Tell me about where you live.
What kind of accommodation do most people live in in your city?
What are some of the pleasures involved in making a home for ourselves?

13-IELTS Books and Films Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you like to read books?

Marie: Yes ... I love reading ... I like nothing more than **to be engrossed in** a good book ... I regularly **take out** books from the library and usually read them **from cover to cover** in no time ... and I can't go to sleep at night without some good **bedtime reading** ...

Examiner: How often do you go to the cinema?

Jemma: Unfortunately we don't have a cinema near us so we have to go into the nearest town **to catch the latest movie** ... I usually avoid seeing popular **box-office hits** which I'm not always keen on seeing ... I prefer **low-budget films** ... **sci-fi** especially ... and there's a great cinema I go to that has frequent **showings** of films like these ...

Examiner: Do you prefer reading books or watching films?

Louisa: I'm not really **a big reader** ... I find books quite **heavy-going** ... so I much prefer to see a film ... perhaps it's the **special effects** or the **soundtrack** ... I don't know ... I just prefer a film ...

Part 2-style task (a book you have read or a film you have seen)

Describe a book you have read or a film you have seen. You should say:

- what this book or film was
 - when you read or saw it
 - why you decided to see the film or read the book
- and say if you enjoyed it and why.

Pauline I like reading ... especially English novels ... it's a great way to improve your vocabulary and there are so many fantastic authors to choose from ... one book that **came highly recommended** by my teacher was *The Mayor of Casterbridge* ... I was studying at a school in The UK at the time and she said it would give me a picture of what life was like years ago in the area I was living ... well I have to say I absolutely loved it ... it was **a real page-turner** ... it's a **historical novel** and **the setting** was a fictional town called Casterbridge ... but actually it was **based on** a town near where I was studying called Dorchester ... it had such a great **plot** ... to cut a long story short **it tells the story of** the downfall of a man called Henchard **the central character** who lives during a period of great social change around the time of the industrial revolution ... the reason I enjoyed it so much ... apart from the great story ... it gave me a picture of what life had been like in the place I was studying at the time ... I really **couldn't put it down** ... a fantastic story.

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Is reading as pleasurable in digital format?

Alise: Personally I prefer reading a **paperback** or **hardback** ... especially if I'm reading **a classic** which I don't think feels right as an **e-book** ... but I can see it can be good for others ... my grandmother has an **e-reader** and she loves the way you can enlarge the text ...

Examiner: Do you think bookshops will survive the digital revolution?

Thomas: I think so ... at least I hope so ... I love **flicking through** books in a bookshop ... online shopping is useful ... finding out on Amazon if a book you want has **got a good review** ... maybe getting one that is difficult to find ... but I still love the experience of being in a bookshop ...

Examiner: Statistics show that visits to the cinema are up despite the availability of DVDs and online downloads. Why do you think this might be?

Jamie: I think it's the whole experience that the cinema offers ... going out **to see a film**

when it **goes on general release** ... and seeing it **on the big screen** is more exciting than **watching the film** at home on TV ... especially if it's **an action movie** ... and watching it with others makes it even more special ...

- **an action movie**: a film with fast moving scenes, often containing violence
- **to be engrossed in**: to be completely focused on one thing
- **bedtime reading**: something to read in bed before you go to sleep
- **to be a big reader**: someone who reads a lot
- **to be based on**: to use as a modal
- **a box office hit**: a financially successful film
- **to be heavy-going**: difficult to read
- **a blockbuster**: a film that is a big commercial success
- **to catch the latest movie**: to see a film that has just come out
- **the central character**: the main person in a film or book
- **a classic**: of the highest quality
- **to come highly recommended**: to be praised by another person
- **couldn't put it down**: wasn't able to stop reading a book
- **an e-book**: a digital book
- **an e-reader**: a device for reading e-books
- **to flick through**: to look quickly through a book
- **to get a good/bad review**: to receive positive or negative feedback
- **to go on general release**: when a film can be seen by the general public
- **hardback**: a book with a rigid cover (see 'paperback' below)
- **a historical novel**: a story set in the past
- **a low budget film**: a film made with a small amount of money
- **on the big screen**: at the cinema
- **a page turner**: a book that you want to keep reading
- **paperback**: a book with a flexible cover (see 'hardback' above)
- **plot**: the main events in a film or book
- **to read something from cover to cover**: to read a book from the first page to the last
- **sci-fi**: science fiction
- **to see a film**: to see a film at the cinema (see 'watch a film' below)
- **the setting**: where the action takes place
- **showings**: performances of a film
- **soundtrack**: the music that accompanies a film
- **special effects**: the visuals or sounds that are added to a film which are difficult to produce naturally
- **to take out (a book from the library)**: to borrow a book from the library
- **to tell the story of**: to outline the details of someone's life or an event
- **to watch a film**: to watch a film on TV (see 'to see a film' above)

Do you like to read books?

Do you prefer reading books or watching films?

Do you think bookshops will survive the digital revolution?

14-IELTS Health Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Have you got a relation you're particularly fond of?

Sinita: Yes ... my granddad ... he's 94 years old but generally he's **as fit as a fiddle** ... we're very close and see each other a lot ... whenever he **goes down with a cold** or **is under the weather** I make a point of visiting him ...

Examiner: Do you do any sport?

Jon: Yes ... I'm keen on skateboarding ... but I haven't done it for a while ... I had a bad fall recently and **pulled a muscle** and had a few **cuts and bruises** ... but I'm **on the mend** and hope to be doing it again soon ...

Examiner: Is there anything you're particularly afraid of?

Davide: The dentist ... I hate going to the dentist ... I only ever go if I **have a toothache** so it usually means I have to **have a filling** or even **have a tooth out** ... I really don't like it ...

Part 2-style task (a time when you were ill)

Describe a time when you were ill. You should say:

- when this was
- what your symptoms were
- how long the illness lasted

and say how it affected your life at the time.

Pierre: This is a tricky one really as I'm usually quite healthy ... I've never been seriously ill ... like everyone else I sometimes get a few **aches and pains** or **catch a cold** ... I can remember a few months ago I had to have time off work with **a heavy cold** ... I had the usual symptoms ... **a blocked nose** ... **sore throat** ... it lasted quite a while ... about 2 weeks I think though I didn't have that much time off work ... for a few days I remember **feeling poorly** but I was **over the worst of it** after a few days and went back to work ... I always find it's better to be active when you feel ill as it keeps your mind of your symptoms ... I think my family get a little fed up with me when I'm ill though ... I tend to feel sorry for myself and lie on the sofa all day as if I'm **at death's door** ... but as I said earlier ... on this occasion it was nothing serious and didn't really cause me any problems ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: What costs are involved when you are ill in your country?

Anya: Well ... people have to pay **prescription charges** which can be quite expensive ...

but fortunately general healthcare is free ... unless you want to **go private** of course and then you can pay a fortune for your treatment ...

Examiner: In your experience are people too quick to take time off work when they're ill?

Alicia: Yes .. I've got friends who have a day off work if they wake up with a **runny nose** ... and in most cases they seem **to make a speedy recovery** after they've **phoned in sick** ...

Examiner: Do women pay more attention to their health than men?

Julie: I think so yes ... women are more likely to see their **GP** for a **check-up** if they're concerned about something ... men tend to avoid facing up to any health problems they have ... my dad always seems to have a very **chesty cough** but refuses to go to **make an appointment** to see the doctor ...

- **aches and pains**: minor pains that continue over a period of time
- **to be a bit off colour**: to feel a little ill
- **to be at death's door**: (informal) to be very ill indeed
- **to be on the mend**: to be recovering after an illness
- **to be over the worst**: to have got through the most serious or uncomfortable stage of an illness
- **to be under the weather**: (informal) to not feel well
- **a blocked nose**: when the nose has excess fluid due to a cold
- **to catch a cold**: to get a cold
- **a check-up**: a physical examination by a doctor
- **a chesty cough**: a cough caused by congestion around the lungs
- **cuts and bruises**: minor injuries
- **to feel poorly**: to feel ill
- **as fit as a fiddle**: to be very healthy
- **to go down with a cold**: to become ill
- **to go private**: to choose to be treated by commercial healthcare rather than by services offered by the state
- **GP**: General Practitioner (family doctor)
- **to have a filling**: to have a tooth repaired
- **to have a tooth out**: to have a tooth removed
- **a heavy cold**: a bad cold
- **to make an appointment**: to arrange a time to see the doctor
- **to make a speedy recovery**: to recover quickly from an illness
- **to phone in sick**: to call work to explain you won't be attending work due to illness
- **prescription charges**: money the patient pays for medicine authorised by a doctor
- **to pull a muscle**: to strain a muscle
- **a runny nose**: a nose that has liquid coming out of it
- **a sore throat**: inflammation that causes pain when swallowing

How do you feel about going to the dentist?
 Do you like to keep fit?
 Do women pay more attention to their health than men?

15-IELTS Work Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: What do you do?

Sasha: I **do a job-share** with a friend in a boutique ... I enjoy it ... I like working with customers ... unfortunately it's only **temporary work** but **one of the perks of the job** is I get a discount on the clothes ...

Examiner: Do you have any career plans yet?

Carly: Yes ... I'd like to **be my own boss** one day ... I'm interested in programming and I'd like to create apps for myself or for other companies ... I know being **self employed** would be a challenge but the idea of doing a **nine-to-five job** doesn't appeal to me at all ...

Examiner: What do you see yourself doing in 10 years time?

Marie: I'd hope to be working ... not a **high-powered job** ... but I'm quite a creative person so something where I can **work with my hands** would be nice ... as long as I'm not **stuck behind a desk** doing something boring **in a dead-end job** I'll be happy ...

Part 2-style task (Describe your ideal job)

Describe your ideal job. You should say:

- what this job is
- whether you would need any qualifications
- whether it would be easy to find work

and say why you would enjoy this job in particular.

Max: I've always loved watching wildlife programmes on TV and often thought how much I'd enjoy working with animals ... perhaps in a safari park ... something like that ... you'd probably need a degree to have any chance of being **called for an interview** and whether there are many **full-time jobs** I don't know ... I'm sure a lot of parks rely on **voluntary work** so it might not be easy ... and it probably wouldn't be **well-paid** either but money isn't everything ... I'd get so much **job satisfaction** ... I can't imagine it being the kind of job where you get **stuck in a rut** ... and I think I'd be good at it as well ... I'd love to work with animals I enjoy **manual work** and I'm a **good team player** ... so even though the **working conditions** might not be the best I think that would be my ideal job ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: If there are a limited number of jobs available who should be given priority, young people or older people with more experience?

Anna: Things are so different these days ... a few years ago older employees would often **take early retirement** or go onto **part-time** contracts and there were always opportunities for younger people but now jobs are so scarce ... I think younger people need to be given the chance whenever possible ...

Examiner: What are some of the important things a candidate should find out before accepting a job?

Ali: Well ... you'd need to know about your area of responsibility ... and your salary of course and then there are things like **holiday entitlement** ... **maternity or paternity leave** ... if you're thinking of having children ... and what the situation is regarding **sick leave** ... that kind of thing ...

Examiner: What are the advantages of having your own business rather than working for someone else?

Julie: Well ... unfortunately being an employee at the moment is very stressful ... people have very **heavy workloads** ... they're always under pressure to **meet deadlines** ... **running your own business** isn't easy ... but I do think it would be far more satisfying

- **to be called for an interview:** to be invited to attend an interview
- **to be your own boss:** to have your own business
- **a dead-end job:** a job with no promotional opportunities
- **to do a job-share:** to share the weekly hours of work with another person
- **a good team player:** somebody who can work well with other people
- **full-time:** the number of hours that people usually work in a complete week
- **a heavy workload:** to have a lot of work to do
- **a high-powered job:** an important or powerful job
- **holiday entitlement:** the number of days holiday allowed
- **job satisfaction:** the feeling of enjoying a job
- **manual work:** work that requires physical activity
- **maternity leave:** time off work given to a woman about to have a baby
- **to meet a deadline:** to finish a job by an agreed time
- **a nine-to-five job:** a normal job that consists of an 8 hour day (approximately)
- **one of the perks of the job:** an extra benefit you get from a job
- **part-time:** working less than full-time
- **to run your own business:** see 'to be your own boss'
- **to be self-employed:** see 'to be your own boss'
- **sick leave:** time allowed off work when sick
- **to be stuck behind a desk:** to be unhappy in an office job
- **to be/get stuck in a rut:** to be in a boring job that is hard to leave
- **to take early retirement:** to retire early (retire: to reach an age when you are allowed to stop working for a living)
- **temporary work:** work done for a limited time only

- **voluntary work**: to work without pay
- **to be well paid**: to earn a good salary
- **working conditions**: the hours, salary and other entitlements that comes with the job
- **to work with your hands**: to do manual work

➔ Do you have any career plans yet?

What do you see yourself doing in 10 years time?

If there are a limited number of jobs available who should be given priority, young people or older people with more experience?

16-IELTS Education Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Are you studying English at a school?

Michel: Yes ... I'm taking **an intensive course** at a local **private language school** ... I **attend classes** three times a week ...

Examiner: Would you say you are a good student?

Susan: I'm OK I think ... I'm pretty good at **meeting deadlines** and I'm **keeping up with my studies** ... plus I find it quite easy to **learn things by heart** which is useful when learning a language ...

Examiner: When you were younger did you enjoy your time at school?

Theo: Yes ... I liked school ... it was an ordinary **state school** ... nothing special ... **a single-sex school** ... which I'm not sure I liked ... but the teachers were great ... I had lots of friends and I never **played truant** like some pupils there ...

Part 2-style task(a time during your education that you really enjoyed)

Describe a time during your education that you really enjoyed. You should say:

- when this period was
- where you were
- what you were studying at the time

and say why you were so happy.

Caroline: I'd like to tell you about my time at university ... I was **a mature student** ... I didn't go to university until I was 25 ... and it was my first time away from my parents so it was very exciting ... I was doing **a Bachelors Degree** and it was a bit of a challenge ... some people **take a year out** but I'd been away from education for 8 years ... plus I had **to work my way through uni** so I was very busy ... and **sitting exams** at the end of each year was a new experience for me as well but I really enjoyed **higher education** learning about a subject I loved ... history ... and the social life was great as well ... I don't think

I've ever had so many friends ... I had my **graduation ceremony** last year in the local cathedral and I know my parents were really proud ... so yes ... that was a really happy time ... I'm thinking of doing a **Masters Degree** soon ... though that might be through **distance learning** as I have a full-time job now ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: What qualities do you think a good teacher has?

Anna: They should be patient ... they should be **subject specialists** and be able to explain the subject clearly ... they should **give feedback** quickly ... for example not hang on to essay for ages like some of my teachers ...

Examiner: What are the advantages of studying on a distance learning course?

Florrie: It's a more flexible way of studying especially if you have a job ... **tuition fees** are usually cheaper ... but you have to be very motivated ... and I would imagine more people **fall behind with their studies** compared to **face-to-face classes** ...

Examiner: Do all children get equal opportunities in education?

Julie: In my country I think it is quite equal but in the UK I've heard that most people who go to the top universities have studied at **public schools** ... you have to be very rich to study in a school like that ... they're usually **boarding schools** as well so the fees are enormous ...

- **to attend classes:** to go to classes
- **bachelors degree:** an undergraduate course which usually lasts 3-4 years
- **boarding school:** a school where pupils live during term time
- **distance learning:** a way of studying where tuition is carried out over the Internet or by post
- **face-to-face classes:** as opposed to distance learning the traditional way of studying in a classroom with colleagues and a teacher
- **to fall behind with your studies:** to progress less quickly than others
- **to give feedback:** to offer guidance on a student's work
- **a graduation ceremony:** an event where a successful student receives his or her academic degree
- **higher education:** education, usually in a college or university, that is followed after high school or secondary school
- **an intensive course:** a course that offers lots of training in order to reach a goal in as short a time as possible
- **to keep up with your studies:** to not fall behind
- **to learn something by heart:** to memorize it
- **a mature student:** a student who is older than average and who has usually returned to education after a period at work
- **masters degree:** a period of study which often follows the completion of a bachelors degree or is undertaken by someone regarded as capable of a higher-level academic course

- **to meet a deadline:** to finish a job or task in the time allowed or agreed
 - **to play truant:** to stay away from classes without permission
 - **private language school:** an independent school run as a business concern
 - **public schools:** exclusive independent schools in the UK
 - **a single-sex school:** a school where only boys or girls attend (as opposed to a mixed-sex school)
 - **to sit an exam:** to take an exam
 - **state school:** a school paid for by public funds and available to the general public
 - **subject specialist:** a teacher who has a great deal of knowledge about the subject they teach.
 - **to take a year out:** to spend a year working or travelling before starting university
 - **tuition fees:** the money paid for a course of study
 - **to work your way through university:** to have a paid job whilst studying to support yourself financially
- ➔ Are you studying English at a school?
Would you say you are a good student?
What qualities do you think a good teacher has?

17-IELTS Food Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you like to cook?

Mandy: Not really no ... most of the time I eat **ready meals** and **take-aways** ... that's one of the reasons I love visiting my mum ... you can always guarantee lovely **home-cooked food** ...

Examiner: What time do you usually eat dinner?

Michelle: We have our **main meal** at around 7.00 ... I'm usually **starving hungry** by then ... in fact I often **grab a bite to eat** as soon as I get home from college ... a sandwich perhaps ... but not too much **to spoil my appetite** ...

Examiner: Are there any types of food you don't like?

Lionel: No not really ... I'm not **a fussy eater** at all ... actually I **eat like a horse** ... I do a lot of sport and **work up quite an appetite** ...

Part 2-style task (restaurant you like)

Describe a restaurant that you like to use. You should say

- where this restaurant is
 - what kind of food it serves
 - how often you go there
- and say why you like eating there so much.

Howard: OK ... this is a nice topic to talk about ... there's a restaurant just around the corner from where I live ... it's an Italian restaurant so as you'd expect you can eat various pasta dishes and pizzas and I usually go there with my family for **a slap-up meal** if we have anything to celebrate ... it's quite a posh restaurant ... the kind of place you would take someone if you wanted **to wine and dine** them ... we usually order **a 3-course meal** ... a light starter then a main dish ... and I have quite **a sweet tooth** so I always look forward to the dessert ... I usually order Tiramisu ... it **makes my mouth water** just to think about it ... I'm always totally **full up** by the end ... why do I enjoy it there ... well ... it's not cheap ... my parents always **foot the bill** and we couldn't afford to go there regularly so it's always a nice treat ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: How can we encourage people to eat more healthily?

Anna: I think the best approach is to have everything in moderation ... **processed food** won't kill you if you only eat it occasionally ... but people should also be encouraged **to eat a balanced diet** ... try to cook fresh ingredients at home a few times a week ...

Examiner: Do you think people enjoy their food as much as they should?

Florrie: I don't know really ... I suppose it's true that people will often eat **a quick snack** because they're bored not because they're **dying of hunger** ... and often they just **bolt it down** and don't savour it ... so yes ... perhaps we could take more time over our food ...

Examiner: Do you think cooking is a pleasure or a chore for people who have busy lives?

Julie: Well ... whether you **follow a recipe** or make something up as you go along ... I think cooking is a very creative process ... and cooking for other people is a particular pleasure ... there's nothing more satisfying than seeing people you love **tucking into** something you've cooked yourself ...

- **to be full up:** to eat to the point that you can no longer eat any more
- **to be starving hungry:** an exaggerated way of saying you are very hungry
- **to bolt something down:** to eat something very quickly
- **to be dying of hunger:** an exaggerated way of saying you are hungry
- **to eat a balanced diet:** to eat the correct types and amounts of food
- **to eat like a horse:** to eat a lot
- **to follow a recipe:** to cook a meal using instructions
- **to foot the bill:** to pay the bill
- **a fussy eater:** somebody who has their own very high standards about what to eat
- **to grab a bite to eat:** to eat something quickly (when you're in a rush)
- **to have a sweet tooth:** to enjoy sugary food
- **home-cooked food:** food cooked at home from individual ingredients
- **the main meal:** the most important meal of the day, usually eaten in the evening
- **to make your mouth water:** to make you feel very hungry for something
- **to play with your food:** to push food around the plate to avoid eating it

- **processed food**: commercially prepared food bought for convenience
- **a quick snack**: to eat a small amount of food between meals
- **a ready meal**: see 'processed food'
- **a slap up meal**: a large meal
- **to spoil your appetite**: to eat something that will stop you feeling hungry when it's meal-time.
- **a take away**: a cooked meal prepared in a restaurant and eaten at home
- **to tuck into**: to eat something with pleasure
- **to wine and dine**: to entertain someone by treating them to food and drink
- **to work up an appetite**: to do physical work that leads to you becoming hungry

→ What time do you usually eat dinner?
 Are there any types of food you don't like?
 How can we encourage people to eat more healthily?

18-IELTS Sports Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you do any sports?

Loiuse: Not really ... no ... I always say I'm going **to take up exercise** and try **to get into shape** but I never seem to get started ... I sometimes wonder whether I should get **a personal trainer** ... someone who will sort out **a fitness programme** for me and make me **train hard**

Examiner: How do you spend a typical weekend?

Stella: I'm a big **football fan** and weekends always centre around **a football match** ... I support FC Utrecht and have **a season ticket** so I go to most of the **home games** and quite a few of the **away games** too ... I'm really looking forward to the new **football season** starting soon ...

Examiner: Have you got any hobbies or interests?

Theo: Yes ... I'm really keen on sports ... I **do judo** once a week and **play tennis** in the summer ... I think it's really important **to keep fit** ... it makes you feel good and energised for work and your studies

Part 2-style task

Describe a place you like going to in your leisure time. You should say:

- what this place is
- when you go there
- what you do there

and say why you enjoy it there so much.

Maurice: I'd like to talk about my local **sports centre** ... it's a place I spend a lot of time in ... it's a new building with all the latest **sports facilities** ... I probably go there at least twice a week ... sometimes more often ... it's a huge place ... there's an outdoor **athletics track** and some **football pitches** ... I **play football** so I'm often out there ... there are several indoor **squash and tennis courts** that I use occasionally ... a big **swimming pool** ... although I don't use that very often ... I'm not a very **strong swimmer** ... there's a gym ... lots of things really ... why do I enjoy going there ... it's just a really fun place to be ... there's a good social side to it all ... you can enter competitions ... meet up with other people who want to do the same sports ... and because there are so many activities on offer it gets you interested in different things ... for example I was listening to some people talking about training **to run the marathon** and I've decided I might even think about that ... I **go jogging** a couple of times a week so it would give me something to aim for ... so yes ... the sports centre ... that's the place I really like to visit ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Should people be encouraged more to take up sport?

Alejandro: I think young people should be given the chance to discover which sport they might like ... watching sport is sometimes a good way to get people started ... not on TV but actually getting out ... take athletics for example ... they could go to **an athletics meeting** ... there are so many different sports on show one might interest them ...

Examiner: Why do some people enjoy participating in sport more than others?

Florrie: That's a good question ... I suppose some people are more concerned about their health ... they can't stand the thought of **being out of condition** ... other people might be driven to excel ... they want **to set records** or get **personal bests** ...

Examiner: Which sports do you think are best for people who aren't used to physical activity?

Julie: Well ... I think people like this should avoid **strenuous exercise** so things like **circuit training** are definitely out of the question ... maybe just doing **a brisk walk** every day ... or swimming is always a good way to get started ...

- **an athletics meeting:** an event where various athletics sports are held
- **an athletics track:** a running track
- **an away game:** a football match played in the opposing teams stadium
- **a brisk walk:** a fast walk
- **to do judo:** (not go or play)
- **a football fan:** someone who likes football
- **a fitness programme:** a schedule of activities to keep fit
- **a football match:** a game of football
- **a football pitch:** the surface on which you play football (as opposed to a stadium, which is the building)
- **a football season:** a period in the year when football is played

- **to get into shape:** to become fit
- **to go jogging:** to run around the streets
- **a home game:** a football match played in the team's own stadium
- **to keep fit:** to stay in good physical condition
- **to be out of condition:** to not be physically fit
- **a personal best:** to achieve the best personal result so far in a sport
- **a personal trainer:** a sports coach that helps you on a one-to-one basis
- **to play tennis/football:** (not do or go)
- **to run the marathon:** to run a distance of 42.195 Kilometres
- **a season ticket:** a ticket that gives you entry to most of a team's home games during the sporting year.
- **to set a record:** to achieve the best result in a sport
- **a sports centre:** a public building where people can do various sports
- **sports facilities:** the equipment and services needed to do a sport
- **a squash/tennis/badminton court:** the surface where you play these sports
- **strenuous exercise:** exercise that needs a lot of physical effort
- **a strong swimmer:** a good swimmer
- **a swimming pool:** the place where you swim
- **to take up exercise:** to start doing exercise
- **to train hard:** to train with a lot of effort

Do you do any sports?

Which sports are popular in your country?

Why do some people enjoy participating in sport more than others?

19-IELTS Technology Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you enjoy using technology?

Stephan: Well ... I wouldn't call myself a **techie** or a **computer buff** but I enjoy using computers ... I'd like to find out more about how they work ... when my **computer crashes** I never know what to do.

Examiner: Do you use the Internet for your studies?

Sophie: Yes ... I'd be lost without it ... I do lots of **video conferencing** to practise speaking and **social media** like Facebook is a good way to meet up with other students ... and I **download podcasts** that teach English vocabulary and grammar.

Examiner: Do you have your own computer?

Tania: Yes ... I have a Macbook Pro ... I use it all the time ... for **word processing** ... **browsing websites** and catching up with TV programmes I've missed.

Part 2-style task

Describe an item of technology you have that is very important. You should say:

- what the technology is
- when you got it
- how often you use it

and say how different your daily life would be without it.

Mattie: I don't have many **gadgets** ... just a computer ... a laptop and my mobile phone ... but I'll talk about my computer as it's so useful ... it's funny really ... 2 years ago I was still learning to use computers ... how to use email ... **send attachments** how to **access websites** ... then I decided to do a **digital editing** course for video and photography ... and so I bought the laptop when I started the course ... my husband had a **desktop PC** but it was very slow so I decided **to upgrade** to a powerful one because we do a lot of video editing on the course ... it's a **high-spec** laptop ... very fast ... the latest **operating system** ... it **boots up** really quickly and it's fun to use so it makes working a pleasure ... I've become a competent computer user now ... if I didn't have it I daresay I'd have to spend more time at college using their computers ... but on the positive side I suppose I'd read a lot more if I didn't have it ... I probably waste a lot of time **surfing the web** ... but hopefully I won't have to be without it ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: What do you think are the important things people need to learn when they start using computers?

Alejandro: Well ... there are things like how to use the Internet ... how **to enter a web address** ... how **to navigate websites** ... that kind of thing but it's also important to know how **to back up** your files in case your computer crashes ... and all about **Internet security**.

Examiner: What kind of technological developments have made the biggest impact on our lives?

Faydene: In my lifetime it has to be the Internet of course but I also think wifi has made a huge difference to how we interact with the Internet ... **wireless networks** at home and public **wifi hotspots** mean we can **go online** easily ... **access our mail** ... log into our work intranet and basically be connected wherever we are.

Examiner: Do computers make it much easier to study?

Jane: Definitely yes ... researching information is much easier with the Internet .. you can **bookmark webpages** for future reference and writing essays is much easier ... being able **to cut and paste** sections of text means you can experiment with organisation ... so yes ... compared to years ago when you had a pile of books on your desk and a pen and paper ... it's now much easier.

- **to access websites/email**: to locate
- **to back up files**: to make a copy of files in case of a computer problem
- **to boot up**: to start a computer
- **to bookmark a webpage**: to mark a webpage for future reference
- **to browse websites**: to look at websites
- **a computer buff**: an expert computer user
- **to crash**: to suddenly stop working
- **to cut and paste**: to move text or images from one place in a document to another place
- **a desktop PC**: a computer that isn't portable and remains in situ on a desk
- **digital editing**: to edit digital materials like audio or video files
- **download (podcasts)**: to save a copy of a file from the internet to your own device
- **to enter a web address**: to type the address of a website into the address bar of your browser
- **a gadget**: a technological tool like a mobile phone or camera
- **to go online**: to start using the Internet
- **high-spec (laptop)**: powerful computer with top quality components
- **Internet security**: Internet safety
- **intranet**: a network of connected computers within an organisation that is not accessible by unauthorised visitors
- **to navigate a website**: to find your way around a website
- **operating system**: the software that tells the computer how to work
- **send an attachment**: send an email with an accompanying file
- **social media**: media used to interact with other people such as Facebook or Twitter
- **to surf the web**: to look at a series of websites one after the other
- **a techie**: somebody who has an interest in technology
- **to upgrade**: to obtain a more powerful or feature-rich computer or piece of software
- **video conferencing**: to see and hear people from different locations using the Internet
- **wireless hotspot**: a public place where you can access the Internet
- **wireless network**: a network where users can access the Internet without the use of fixed cables
- **word processing**: producing written texts on a computer

Do you enjoy using technology?

What's your favourite gadget?

Do computers make it much easier to study?

20-IELTS Relationships Vocabulary

Read the following IELTS-style questions and answers below and pay attention to the phrases in **bold**. Use the ‘’ section at the bottom of the page to check the meaning of any phrases you don't understand.

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: Do you see your friends very often?

Louisa: Yes ... we meet up most weekends ... we all **get on really well** and **have a lot in common** so we're always happy doing the same things and going to the same places.

Examiner: What do you like about your close friends?

Anna: I think we **enjoy each other's company** ... we **see eye-to-eye on** most things so we rarely **fall out with** each other.

Examiner: Have you known each other long?

Amy: Most of them yes ... although my closest friend Carrie ... we **struck up a relationship** at college and **got on like a house on fire** ... but yes ... my other friendships **go back years** to when we were at school.

Part 2-style task

Describe a person you are very close to. You should say:

- who this person is
- when you met them
- where you met them
- and say what it is about them you like so much.

Reiko: I'd like to talk about my boyfriend ... Jose ... we **got to know** each other at University almost 4 years ago ... we were in the same department ... initially we were **just good friends** and used to go out in a group with our other friends ... when Jose went back to Spain for the holidays we would **keep in touch with** each other ... then one year he invited me to come to Spain with him ... and that's when we **fell for** each other I think ... so you couldn't really say it was **love at first sight** as it had been over a year since we'd met ... but we really **hit it off** and by the time we got back to university in September we were able to tell all our friends that we were **in a relationship** ... what do I like about Jose ... well he's very kind ... very funny ... and very supportive ... and we're really **well matched** in our interests ... he hasn't **popped the question** yet though ... we've talked about getting married and I think we're both ready **to settle down** and have children ... we'll just have to wait and see ...

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: Do you think marriage is still as important as ever?

Cristine: Yes ... it certainly is in my country ... I think the problem for some people is a lack of commitment ... all relationships **have their ups and downs** ... but some people prefer to **break up** rather than **working at** the relationship.

Examiner: What do you think is the ideal time to get married?

Terry: Personally ... I think you should wait until you've found yourself first ... decided

if you want a career ... perhaps do some travelling ... you should do this before **tying the knot** ... although if you **fall head over heels in love** plans like these can easily be forgotten.

Examiner: Is it important to keep in contact with our friends when we're in a relationship?

Maria: Absolutely ... it's so easy to **drift apart** from your friends when you **fall in love** ... but I think both partners should try not to **lose touch with** their friends ... that's the best way to have a **healthy relationship** with your partner.

- **to break up:** to end a romantic relationship
- **to drift apart:** to become less close to someone
- **to enjoy someone's company:** to like spending time with someone
- **to fall for:** to fall in love
- **to fall head over heels in love:** to start to love someone a lot
- **to fall out with:** to have a disagreement and stop being friends
- **to get on like a house on fire:** to like someone's company very much indeed
- **to get on well with:** to understand someone and enjoy similar interests
- **to get to know:** to begin to know someone
- **to go back years:** to have known someone for a long time
- **to have a lot in common:** to share similar interests
- **to have ups and downs:** to have good and bad times
- **a healthy relationship:** a good, positive relationship
- **to hit it off:** to quickly become good friends with
- **to be in a relationship:** to be romantically involved with someone
- **to be just good friends:** to not be romantically involved
- **to keep in touch with:** to keep in contact with
- **to lose touch with:** to not see or hear from someone any longer
- **love at first sight:** to fall in love immediately you meet someone
- **to pop the question:** to ask someone to marry you
- **to see eye to eye:** to agree on a subject
- **to settle down:** to give up the single life and start a family
- **to strike up a relationship:** to begin a friendship
- **to tie the knot:** to get married
- **to be well matched:** to be similar to
- **to work at a relationship:** to try to maintain a positive relationship with someone

What do you like about your close friends?

Where did you meet your best friend?

What qualities do you value in a friend?

21-IELTS Holiday Vocabulary

Part 1-style questions

Examiner: What kind of holiday do you like?

Miguel: I try to avoid **tourist traps** ... I like to **get away from it all** and prefer going

somewhere **off the beaten track** ... last year I had **the holiday of a lifetime** ... a two week **wildlife safari** in Kenya.

Examiner: What do you like to do when you're on holiday?

Anna: I enjoy visiting the local **places of interest** ... I like **to go sightseeing** and always sign up for **guided tours** as it's a chance to be shown around and take photographs ... one of my hobbies.

Examiner: Do you have many tourists in your country?

Amy: Yes ... we have a lot of **holiday resorts** along the coast that are popular with tourists ... most people come on **package holidays** and stay in one of the many hotels and **self-catering** apartments.

Part 2-style task

Describe a beautiful place you once visited. You should say:

when you went to this place

where it was

who you went with

and say why you liked it so much.

Sally: A few years ago I went on a **long weekend** to the Lake District in the UK ... it's a very popular **holiday destination** in the north of England ... I went on my own and had a wonderful time ... I stayed in a **youth hostel** and met some really nice people ... but the most memorable thing about the holiday were the **breathtaking views** ... and lovely **picturesque villages** ... it can get very busy with **hordes of tourists** so I decided **to go out of season** in the autumn ... the weather was fantastic and the shops were full of **local crafts** ... a really great holiday ... it's certainly not the kind of **short break** for someone looking for a busy nightlife but if you want to relax in the middle of **stunning landscape** I would certainly recommend a holiday to the Lake District.

Part 3-style questions

Examiner: What do you think has led to the growth in the tourist industry?

Miguel: It's much easier and affordable to travel now ... nowadays you can get cheap **charter-flights** or **all-in packages** ... to somewhere near or to a **far-off destination**.

Examiner: How do people tend to choose a destination?

Anna: The Internet is a great source of information and high street **travel agents** are still very popular ... that's where I like to go to get **holiday brochures** for the place I'm interested in.

Examiner: People sometimes say flying is the most glamorous form of travel. Do you agree?

Amy: I'm not so sure really ... flying can be quite boring ... queuing up at the **check-in desk** ... going through **passport control** ... sitting for ages in the **departure lounge** ... then the flight itself can be quite uncomfortable ... no ... I'm not sure I agree.

all-in package/package holiday: a holiday where you purchase the travel and accommodation together

brehtaking view: an extremely beautiful view

charter-flight: a cheaper form of flying than a scheduled flight

check-in desk: the place at the airport where you register for your flight and deposit your luggage

departure lounge: where you wait for your flight to be called

far-off destination: somewhere a long way away

to get away from it all: to take a holiday to escape a busy or stressful lifestyle

guided tour: an organised group shown around a place of interest by an expert

holiday brochure: a glossy publication with details of holiday packages

holiday destination: where you go for a holiday

holiday of a lifetime: a special holiday that you are unlikely to repeat

holiday resort: a place where lots of people go for a holiday

hordes of tourists: crowds of tourists

local crafts: objects produced locally

long weekend: an extended weekend holiday including Friday or Monday

out of season: outside of the main holiday period

picturesque village: very pretty village

passport control: the place where your passport is checked

places of interest: sites of interest to tourists

wildlife safari: a holiday, often in Africa, to observe wild animals

self-catering: a holiday where you supply your own food

short break: a short holiday

to go sightseeing: to look around the tourist sites

stunning landscape: extremely beautiful countryside

travel agent: a shop that specialises in booking holidays

tourist trap: somewhere where too many tourists go

youth hostel: a cheap form of accommodation

➔What do you like to do when you're on holiday?

Do you have many tourists in your country?

People sometimes say flying is the most glamorous form of travel. Do you agree?

PART 2

22- Describing Places

Describe a place that you enjoy visiting.

You should say:

where the place is

- **what you can see and do there**
- **how it has changed since you first visited it**

and explain why you enjoy visiting this place.

A place that I enjoy visiting is Prague. It's the capital and largest city of the Czech Republic, with a population of nearly 2 million. It lies in the north-west of the country, in the centre of the Bohemian region, which is a green and lush part of Czech Republic.

There is lots to do in Prague. It has several universities, so first and foremost it's a fantastic place to be a student. It's buzzing, with a good nightlife, good restaurants and a lively cultural life. In fact, it's a UNESCO World Heritage Site and a cultural and economic centre of central Europe a few years back.

If you climb up to the hill overlooking the old town, you have an amazing view of the city. What strikes me most when I go up there is all the traditional, pale buildings with their red roofs, and then right in the middle of it all, a remarkable piece of art and engineering, the Charles Bridge. It is one of the most loved attractions in Prague that crosses the Vltava River. It was built between the 14th and 15th centuries and connects Prague Castle with the Old Town. Today you can walk across it and find many souvenir stalls or have your caricature drawn. There are many statues on the bridge and some people think that if you touch the statue of St John of Nepomuk you will receive good luck and return to Prague soon.

The last time I went to Prague, they were having a wine festival. People were tasting all kinds of wines from stalls on the street, very informally and chatting with friends while they drank. It was wonderful.

How has it changed since I first visited it? Well, I would say it has undoubtedly become more trendy. Like I say, they have built a stunning new museum. Another example is "the Lennon Wall", a monument of recent vintage: It is a wall covered in graffiti and pictures inspired by John Lennon and the Beatles. People have been drawing on the wall since the 1980s and they continue to do so today. I would say the local inhabitants have become more overtly proud of their city too. It has received quite a bit of recognition in recent times, which has really placed Prague well and truly on the cultural map; something the inhabitants are always happy to talk to you about. In fact, that is something else I enjoy about going there: the local people are invariably friendly and helpful.

When did you last go to Prague?

I last went there the year before last. I wish I could go more often, but unfortunately work commitments mean I can't.

23- Family Tradition

Describe your favourite family tradition.

You should say:

- **what the tradition is**
- **when it occurs**
- **what you do**

and explain why it is your favourite tradition.

My favourite family tradition is most certainly Thanksgiving, which is celebrated on the fourth Thursday in November. Thanksgiving is a wonderful holiday. Actually, everyday should be a day of Thanksgiving. My family loves to celebrate this holiday. It is a yearly tradition for our family to gather at my grandma's house for Thanksgiving. I always look forward to this event. My cousins and other family members that I do not get to see often are there. My grandma and other family members prepare a big meal. There is always plenty for everyone. The main thing is of course the turkey. I like turkey, especially the legs. My uncle never eats turkey. He says it is an ugly bird, and he doesn't want to eat it. When I was younger, I would always want to get the wishbone and break it. We also have sides to go along with the turkey. Everyone loves my grandma's mashed potatoes. We also have rolls, dressing, cranberry sauce, and yams. Then, for dessert we have fresh pumpkin pie with whipped cream. Before we eat everyone always gathers around the table and someone says the blessing. Thanksgiving is always a good time of fellowship and bonding for my family. We usually watch some of the parade on television or a football game. Sometimes after everyone is done eating, we play card games like Rook. You can see why this is a favorite tradition for me and my family. I wish we could do it more often.

24- Hobby

Describe a hobby you enjoy.

You should say:

- **how long you have been doing it**
- **how often you do it**
- **what benefits you get from it**

and explain why you enjoy it.

1. I've joined a club where I can play chess.(become a member of a club)

2. I'm a **philatelist**. I collect all sorts of stamps.

(a person who collects stamps for pleasure)

3. I often **go camping** in the summer.

(to live in a camp or outdoors)

4. I **do a bit of / a lot of climbing**.

(go mountain climbing)

5. I **make my own clothes**.

(I make clothes for myself. I don't buy them.)

6. I like **photography**.

(the skill or process of taking photographs)

7. I'm mad about **DIY**. I think this is a very good hobby for people who have a house but don't have much money.

(do it yourself; the activity of making and repairing things yourself around your home)

8. I **took up** golf when I was at school.

(to start a hobby for the first time)

9. I **gave up** photography.

(to stop doing a hobby)

10. I **collect antiques**. I really enjoy going round the shops looking for a bargain.

(you collect stamps, coins, antiques)

11. I try to practice **playing** the guitar every day.

(to make music with a musical instrument)

12. I usually **go jogging** two or three times a week.

(run slowly, especially as a form of exercise)

13. I took up **hiking** because I wanted to get more exercise.

(a long walk in the country)

14. I don't really do anything in my **spare time**.

(time when you are not working)

15. In winter, I **do quite a lot of skiing**.

(in English you normally do a lot of / a bit of sport)

16. In summer, I **play tennis and cricket**.

(in English you normally play a game)

Holiday making

17. **My aunt is a great traveler: she's been to every country in Europe.**

(a person who is travelling or who often travels)

18. **We toured / went / were on a tour round the United States last summer.**

(to make a journey for pleasure during which you visit many places)

19. **I will be going overseas in my new job.**

(to travel to another country across the sea)

20. **The island's economy is heavily dependent on tourism.**

(the business of providing Holidays for people)

21. **We went on an excursion to the mountains.**

(an organized trip with a group of people)

22. **I'm not taking any holiday / vacation**

(time when you do not go to work for a special reason)

23. **I'm taking a short break and going to my sister's for a few days.**

(a short period of time when you do not work)

24. **You look exhausted. You should take a few days off and relax.**

(not present at work)

25. **I can't come I'm afraid. I'm on holiday / off that week.**

(to leave your home and go somewhere else for a holiday)

26. **We're only going away or a few days.**

(to live the place where you leave at least one night)

27. **We've booked two weeks in Australia in July.**

(to reserve and pay for a holiday before you go)

28. **They run a small resort hotel in Vermont.**

(a place where a lot of people go on holiday)

29. **I brought a model of the Eiffel Tower as a souvenir of Paris.**

(something that you buy on holiday [for your friend] as a reminder of that place)

30. **We travelled overland to Delhi and then flew on to Singapore.**

(by road or rail)

31. **The voyage from England to India used to take six months.**

(a long journey by sea)

32. **We decided to go cruising in the Mediterranean.**

(to travel by sea, visiting a number of places as a holiday)

33. **We take / get / catch the train / bus, to Leeds and then got a bus to where she lives.**

(to travel to a place by train, bus, plane)

34. **We headed for / made for (informal) the town centre.**

(to travel towards somewhere)

35. **We stopped off in Paris en route to Nice.**

(on the way to somewhere)

36. **The travel agent suggested some changes to my itinerary.**

(a plan of a journey, route, etc.)

37. **One of the most famous landmarks in London is Nelson's Column.**

(an object especially a building, that can be seen from a distance)

38. **We had been on the move for twenty four hours and were absolutely exhausted.**

(to be travelling)

39. **We made a stopover at Frankfurt on the way to Tokyo.**

(a short stop on a journey)

40. **I'm learning Spanish, just for fun.**

(you do something for enjoyment and pleasure)

41. **I think I get more pleasure out of doing my garden than anything else.**

(the feeling of being happy)

42. **Let your hair down (informal) for once!**

(to allow yourself to enjoy something freely, without worrying about what other people think)

43. **We had the time of our lives.**

(to enjoy something very much)

44. **There isn't much entertainment for young people in this town.**

(things to do that interest and amuse people)

45. **I had a great time last night.**

(to get pleasure from doing something)

46. **I have to amuse myself for a few hours while I waited for her to arrive.**

(to keep yourself entertained)

25-IELTS Speaking : Home Town

1. **We left home and set up house together in another part of town. (informal)**

(begin to live independently in a house)

2. **The first thing you must do is to find some accommodation.**

(somewhere to live or stay)

3. **The town has 20000 inhabitants.**

(people who lives in a country, town, etc.)

4. Are you resident in the UK?

(If your home is in a particular country, town, etc. you are a resident of that place)

5. I haven't met my next-door neighbour.

(a person who lives in the house nearest to yours)

6. I am native of London.

(a person who was born in a particular place)

7. If you get lost, ask one of the locals.

(a person who lives in a particular place)

8. Homelessness is a growing problem in inner-city areas.

(the condition of being homeless)

9. A lot of people / homeless sleep rough / live rough in cardboard boxes.

(you sleep outside because you have no home)

10. The families were evicted for not paying the rent.

(to force a person to leave the building or land where they live)

11. We're moving house next week.

(you go and live in another house)

12. We must vacate the flat by the end of the year.

(you stop living in a house and take your belongings away)

13. We haven't met the people who have moved in next door.

(you bring your belongings to a new house and begin to live in it)

14. We have got used to a better standard of living.

(the level of money and comfort that people have in their everyday lives)

15. Some people live on bread and water.

(to have something as your only food)

16. In most big towns, there is a commercial centre.

(an area with lots of banks and company offices)

Some useful words to describe cities

17. People who prefer the countryside to big towns often say towns are noisy, dirty and polluted, stressful, and crowded; however, the countryside is quiet and peaceful, clean; calm and relaxing, and has lots of open space and is safe.

People who prefer big towns have a different point of view. They say, in towns, there are plenty of things to do, and life is exciting; there is a wide range of shops and lots of night - life; however, in the countryside, there's nothing to do; it's boring, and there are only a few shops; there's no night-life.

18. **Every day, particularly in the rush-hour, we are / get stuck in a traffic jam.**

(the times each day when there is a lot of traffic because people are travelling to or from work; not able to move because of heavy traffic)

19. **The streets get so packed with traffic that travel is very slow or even comes to a standstill.**

(extremely crowded; a situation in which there is no movement or activity at all)

20. **This is really stressful for commuters who travel to work in the town..**

(someone who travels a long distance to work every day)

21. **Vandalism is one of the major problems of big cities.**

(the crime of deliberately damaging things, especially public property)

22. **He grew up in the East London slums.**

(a house or an area of a city that is in a very bad condition and is poor)

23. **A picturesque new England village in the fall.**

(pretty and interesting, especially in an old-fashioned way)

24. **These are a lot of historic buildings in the village.**

(old)

25. **I've had a pretty hectic social life.**

(very busy or full of activity)

26. **In big towns, you can see a continual bustle of people coming and going.**

(energetic activity)

27. **It is a run-down inner-city area.**

(an area that is in a very bad condition)

28. **A lot of people are moving out of rural areas to urban areas.**

(connected with a village: connected with a town or city)

29. **It's a city of six million inhabitants / citizens.**

(a person who lives in a town or city)

30. **The (whole) town was on the streets.**

(the people who live in a town or city)

31. **We're moving downtown.**

(to or in the centre of a city)

32. **Which part of town district do you live in?**

(an area of a town)

33. **Many people live in the suburbs and travel to work in the centre of town.**

(an area of a town where people live, outside the centre)

34. I live on the outskirts of Bradford.

(the parts of a town or city that are farthest from the centre)

35. We lived on the other side of the square.

(an open space in a town or city that has buildings all around it)

26- Family

1. I live in a one-parent family / single-parent family.

(a family where the children live with only one parent)

2. I really enjoy my family life.

(the way a family lives)

3. I come from a big family of eight children.

(the group of people who are related to you)

4. I grew up on a farm.

(develop from being a child to being an adult)

5. I grew up knowing that my elder brother would take over the family business one day.

(the job your parents and probably your grandparents used to do)

6. Nuclear family

(a family consisting of mother, father and their children)

7. Extended family

(all the people in a family including aunts, uncles, grandparents, etc.)

8. Family background

(the sort of family you come from)

9. She's / he's family (informal)

(used to say that someone is related to you)

10. A large household

(all the people who live in one house)

11. My domestic life isn't very happy.

(connected with the private family home)

12. I live on my own. I haven't got any family.

(the group of people who are related to one another)

13. We've got the same name but are not related.

(the way you are connected)

14. He lives with us, but he's not related / unrelated.

(a person who is not a member of your family)

15. He is a **close / distant relative of mine**.

(near or not in a family relationship)

16. I really **take after** my mother.

(to look like or be like a parent or older member of your family)

17. All the men in our family are bald. I support it's **hereditary**.

(a quality which is passed from parents to children)

18. All her children are very artistic. It must **run in the family**.

(something which is passed from parents to children / a common feature in a family)

19. **Bringing up / raising** children is never easy.

(to look after children in a family until they are adults and to teach them how to behave)

20. My parents really tried to give me a good **upbringing**.

(the way somebody is brought up)

21. My father recently lost his job, so my mother's the main **breadwinner** now.

(a person who earns all or most of the money in family)

22. I need a job, so I can **support** my family.

(to have enough money to be able to look after a family)

23. I am getting married next year and hope to **start a family** straight away.

(have children)

24. My father is really a **family man**.

(a man who enjoys being at home with his wife and children)

25. He's got some **fatherly** concern and duties.

(behaving like a father)

26. **Motherhood** really suits her.

(the state of being a mother)

27. She is a **motherly** sort of person.

(behaving like a mother)

28. Danny is my **foster brother**.

(having different parents, but being brought up in the same family)

29. My **step father** is a nice man.

(the man who is married to your mother but is not your father)

30. Paul is my **big brother / older / elder brother**.

(older than you)

31. Anna is my **little sister / younger sister**.

(younger than you)

32. We're identical twins.

(twins who look exactly the same)

33. My twin sister is a dentist.

(either of the children who have the same parents and are born at the same time)

34. She doesn't get on well with her in-laws.

(the parents of your husband or wife)

35. Next of kin

(your closest relative, who should be told if you are injured or killed)

36. I closely resemble my father.

(to be closely similar to, or look like someone)

37. You can see the resemblance between Susan and her sister.

(a similarity between two things, especially in the way they look)

38. He bears a remarkable resemblance to my father.

(to be or look somebody / something else)

39. My parents live apart from each other.

(if married people decide to separate, then they live apart)

PART 1

Hometown

Where is your hometown?

My hometown's in Hanoi, which is the capital city of Vietnam. It's located in the north of the country, not really that far from the southern Chinese border.

Is there much to do in your hometown?

Oh yes, there's certainly lots to do there as it's a fairly big city. If you like going out in the evening there are a lot of good restaurants and bars. If you prefer cultural activities there are museums and art galleries. But if you like nature there are lots of other things outside of the city which are easy to reach.

What are the people like in your hometown?

They are mostly quite friendly, but as with most big cities everyone is often busy so it may seem as if they are not interested in speaking or having a chat. But if you live there you know that most people are quite happy to have a chat if they have time and will help you if needed.

Studies

What are you studying at the moment?

I'm studying history at university. It's a four year course, and I started it three years ago, so I have just one year left. I'm enjoying it a lot so it will be sad to finish.

What do you like most about your studies?

We learn about many things from the past such as politics and wars, but I like learning about how people lived in the past the most. It's amazing to see how our lives have changed so much from the past up until now. In some ways our lives have got much easier now, but in other ways the simplicity of life in the past made people much happier. Learning about all that is fascinating.

What do you hope to do in the future when you have finished?

I'm not sure at the moment, but I may go into teaching. This is why I'm doing the IELTS, as I intend to carry on and do a Masters in a specific area of history. I'll probably decide for sure what to do when I have completed that.

Work

What is your job?

I currently work as an office manager at a large marketing company. I've been in the job for about five years now. I'm usually assigned to work with a specific business in order to improve their sales through various marketing strategies.

Do you have to work with other people?

Oh yes, all the time. It's a big office and we all have to work as a team if we want to achieve results. I have colleagues I need to liaise with such as the graphic designers and I also have administration staff who work under me. And of course I also have to work alongside the companies that we provide marketing for. So yes, I definitely have to work with other people.

Do you think you will change jobs in the future?

Well, that's not something I'm thinking about at the moment as I really enjoy what I do and it's a really good company to work for. The pay is good and they have other good

benefits such as flexi-time and end of year bonuses. But that said, change is always a good thing, so I can't see me being there forever. I'm sure I will change one day.

Leisure time

What do you like to do in your free time?

I do quite a lot of sport actually. I play football mostly - on Wednesday nights and Sunday afternoon with a local team. I also play tennis and squash when I can but I don't really get the time to do them as well every week. I work quite hard at the moment, so I don't get a lot of free time unfortunately.

Have your leisure activities changed since you were a child?

Not a great deal actually. I used to love playing football when I was young as well - I played a lot at school. Though of course I did all the other things kids loved to do such as going out on bike rides after school and things.

Do you prefer to spend your free time alone or with other people?

It depends on my mood really. I think most people need some time on their own. Sometimes my work is quite stressful and I spend a lot of time there with others, so it's good to just get home and relax and read a book or something. But I get bored if I am alone too much so I like to go out and meet friends in the evening or play football.

Trains

Do you like to travel by train?

Yes, I quite like them. If you are on a train you can relax and look out the window, read, use your lap top - it's all quite comfortable. On the bus it's more difficult to do those things because there is less space and the movement can make you travel sick too. The only problem with trains in my country is that they are often delayed or late. That can ruin your journey.

Where do you usually go by train?

It's usually on long trips across the country if I want to visit friends or I have an appointment somewhere. For short journeys around where I live or to work it's much easier to drive or take the bus. As I said before, you can do things such as read on the train so it's good for long journeys.

When was the last time you travelled by train?

Er....I'm not quite sure, let me think. It was a while ago now. I think the last time was last year when I went up to see some friends I had not seen for a while in the north of the country. Yes, that was it. It was a journey of about 3 hours and I had to change trains once during the journey. The first train was a bit crowded and noisy as I think there were people on there going to a football match, but it was an ok trip most of the way..

Time**Are you good at managing your time?**

Actually I'd say I'm not too good! I don't really have a system in place to organize things. I know some people have an electronic organizer or use some device to plan what they are doing but I don't do that. But I always make sure I am on time for appointments and things like that, and I meet deadlines and get things done.

How do you manage your time?

As I said, I don't have any specific system in place to manage my time. For example, if I am at work and I have a lot of cases, I just go through them each day and decide which I need to tackle first. At work we do have an online diary which I guess I use, so in that sense I do manage my time to an extent.

When is it most important for you to manage your time?

I think it is probably when you are at work. When out of work, it's not really going to affect things too much, or at least only yourself, if you are late to meet friends or for an appointment, or if you are getting things done in your house. But at work, it will cause problems if you don't manage your time effectively because you could miss deadlines or miss appointments. You could lose your job. So at work is when it is most important to manage your time.

Books**What kind of books do you like to read?**

I mostly like to read biographies. I'm not sure why but it is interesting to read about people's real lives, especially when they have had interesting lives and have had to deal

with many problems. I do read fiction as well, but I often find it difficult to get hold of a book that I really like. I also like reading about books to do with current affairs.

Do you read the same kind of books now that you read when you were a child?

Not really, no. Actually I didn't read that much when I was a child, but if I did it was mainly fiction books, such as fairy tales. Things like The Lion, The Witch, and the Wardrobe. Fantasy things.

When do you think is the best time to read?

I think any time is ok, but when I read I like to concentrate, so I can't read for a short time like on a bus ride like some people do. I like to put time aside to enjoy it. So if I have some free time at the weekend I might read for a few hours. And I nearly always read before I go to bed - this really helps me to sleep.

Art Galleries

Are there many art galleries where you live?

No, not that I know of. I live in a small town so I don't think there are any, though we do have a few museums and other cultural institutions. In our capital city there are quite a few art galleries, however.

Did you like to go to art galleries when you were a child?

I've never been that interested in art to be honest, so not really. We were taken to one as part of a trip when I was at school. It has a lot of paintings from famous artists from our country. It was quite interesting to see I guess but I've not been to any since.

Should people have to pay to go to art galleries?

I think it depends really. If possible they should be free because if people do have to pay they are less likely to go and see it. But on the other hand these things cost money so a small fee may be necessary if it can keep the art gallery going and keep it open. Ideally though the government should pay for this as I believe this kind of thing is paid for by our taxes.

Swimming

Can you swim?

Yes I can. I learnt at school when I was about 7 years old. Swimming lessons were compulsory at our school, like most schools I think.

Are there many places to swim near you?

Yes, there are a few public swimming pools. There is the main indoor one at a big sports complex in the center of town. There are also a couple of outdoor ones, but you can only use them in summer as it is too cold in winter. One is a big one in a park, the other is a much smaller one.

Do you think everyone should learn to swim?

Of course, I think it's very important. Firstly, you spend much of your life on holiday by water, for example, when you go to the beach on holiday, so you won't be able to enjoy yourself with your friends if you can't swim. Also, for safety reasons it's very important. You often hear about sad accidents involving young children so it's very important.

“Describe a present you have given someone

You should say:

Who you gave it to

What kind of present it was

How it compared to other presents you have given

Explain why you decided to give this particular gift”

I'm going to talk about a present that I gave to someone. **The person that I gave it to** **was** a very good friend of mine at the time. His name was Kaaliya and he came from India. I knew him because we studied together at a language school in Cambridge. Although we were from different backgrounds and cultures, we got on really well and we had the same sense of humour so we became very good friends. **The present was a picture** that had been painted of the River Cam in Cambridge. It was not so big - maybe around 10 inches by 14 inches, but it was very beautiful. It came in a gold plated frame and the picture had been drawn by a particularly well-known Cambridge artist. It had been signed by this person as well. It's the first time I have given this person a present, and I guess **it's quite different from presents that I have given to other people before** – I don't recall ever giving someone a picture actually. If I'm buying for family then I'll usually buy clothes or maybe some jewelry if it is a special occasion. Normally when I've bought something for friends it's something more jokey so we can have a laugh about it, nothing that serious.

The reason why I decided to give this particular gift is because we had spent a lot of time together in Cambridge and we had had some really fun times punting on the River Cam – that's obviously why I thought this was an appropriate present. We used to go punting at least once a week, sometimes a couple of times. On one occasion there was a group of about ten of us that went down there, and we spent the whole day

sitting by the river in the sun and as usual we went on a boat trip together. We all have a lot of photos to remind us of this great day.

So my friend, Kaaliya, is the person that I gave a present to and this was because I felt it would always remind him of the fun times that we had and also of Cambridge.

Describe an old person that you know.

You should say:

What your relationship is to this person

How often you see them

What people think about this person

Explain why you like them.

Ok, I'd like to tell you about an old person that I know.

His name is John, and he is the owner of a small convenience store at the end of my street.

I would say that my relationship with him is as a friend. I know him because I regularly go to the shop in order to buy things when I don't have time to go to a supermarket. He's quite friendly and I always have a chat with him. I've known him now for about five years - since I've lived in the area in fact. That's why I'd now call him a friend.

I'd say that I see him fairly regularly. Like I said, I go to the big supermarket out of town sometimes to stock up, but you always need odd things during the week such as milk, or some snack or other. So when this happens I just have a walk down to his shop. So I'd say I see him every one or two days.

I think John is pretty popular as he's been there for years as far as I'm aware, so most of the locals around the area know him. There will always be someone in the shop having a chat with him. They like him because he's not just the shopkeeper but he's also very involved in activities in the community. For example, I know he helps out at the old people's home some nights, and he runs the quizzes at the local pub. He also helps to organize the fete that is held each year in the town.

The reason that I like him is that he's great to have a chat with. For instance, a while back I was having problems with my work, and I was really feeling stressed. I didn't really have anyone to talk to at the time as my family is abroad and a couple of my good

friends were not around. I mentioned it to John and he was great. He listened and also gave me some really good advice. He didn't need to do that so it was great that he made the time to anyway. Generally, though, he's really welcoming when you go to his shop. He'll always have a smile on his face.

Describe a happy childhood event

You should say:

When it happened

Who was involved

How you felt at the time

Explain why you remember this particular occasion.

I'm going to talk about a happy childhood event that I remember, and that event was my 13th birthday.

It was 10 years ago now because I'm 23. My birthday is on the 7th May. What happened was my parents surprised me on my birthday by telling me that they were going to take me to a theme park that is a few hours from our house. I'd never been before - it had only been open a few months and they knew that I really wanted to go. As I recall it was a Saturday that we went. They didn't tell me until the morning when I woke up that day.

My whole family was involved in the event. I have a brother and a sister so of course they came as well as my Mum and Dad, and not only that, we also picked up my grandparents on the way so they could join us. They were too old to go on the rides but it was still a great trip out for them!

The theme park was really amazing. There was a huge roller coaster which I remember was really scary but still excellent fun. One particular thing I remember is the ghost train. My younger sister was not allowed to go on the ride because she was too young and she was really upset and jealous of me and my brother! I think it was lucky she didn't though. It was really realistic – there were real people in there who were actually dressed up as ghosts and they jumped out just when you weren't expecting it – it made us jump so many times!

How I felt really depended on what I was doing. Obviously I was excited the whole day, but I remember that I felt really exhilarated when I was on the rides such as the roller coaster, and scared but still excited on the ghost train.

The reason that I remember it so well is that I had been so desperate to go to the theme park and I'd been talking to my friends at school for ages about how I wanted to go. So it was so great when I found out that I could. Also I remember it so well because

all of our family was together. My Dad was pretty busy most of the time with his work so we didn't always have much time to do things together when I was a younger.

So for these reasons, it was a really special occasion that I'll never forget.

Describe an environmental problem that has occurred in your country

You should say:

The cause of the problem

What effect it has had on your country

The steps, if any, that have been taken to solve this

Explain why you think this problem is so important to solve.

Model Answer

Ok, I'm going to talk about a problem with the environment in my country.

One of the most serious problems at the moment is flooding. This is starting to happen every year and each year it seems to get worse. I think it may be caused by a number of factors. Firstly there has been a lot of deforestation in the north of the country, a lot of it from illegal logging. Because of this, when it rains the water has nothing to soak it up so it just runs down the mountains and into the villages and towns. Another factor may be global warming. Scientists believe that this is causing more severe weather so this may account for the increasing amount of rain that we seem to be seeing. It also means the soil is more dry so again the rain water runs off it rather than being soaked up.

Unfortunately, there have been really serious effects on my country. As I said, the excess water runs into the villages and the towns through the rivers and the rivers then overflow causing massive flooding. This affects thousands of people who then become homeless. Several hundred usually die each year as well. It travels through the country as it starts in the north and goes down to the sea, so it can affect many towns and the capital city too. This also has repercussions for the government as they have to spend so much money managing the disaster each year.

The government is trying to tackle the problem, but it is not easy. They are trying to stop so much deforestation but a lot of the damage has already been done so what can they do? They are also starting to build defences such as walls along some of the major rivers that run through the town to try to stop them overflowing. Another thing they are

doing is trying to improve their response systems. In most towns there is now a government organization responsible for coordinating relief operations and making sure they are prepared in advance.

I think this problem is a top priority to solve because it has such devastating impacts. As I mentioned before, it causes suffering for so many people and it is also a huge expense for the government and as we are not a rich country we cannot afford this. It means that other services suffer because of a lack of money. There are other problems that my country has but I think that is by far the worst.

So, that is the serious problem in my country, and I only hope that it does not continue to get worse.

Describe someone in your family who you really admire

You should say:

What relation this person is to you?

What are your first memories of this person?

How often you see this person?

and explain why do you admire this person

Possible Answer:

I've got a small family with only 5 members and all of us are very close to each other and we love each other very much. Among them I love my mother more than anyone else in the whole world. I adore my mother for her caring, loving, adorable behaviors and wit. She is the person I can share everything with and that's the reason I worship her so much.

Possibly she was the first human I saw when I opened my eyes in this world. A relationship with a mother is divine and all of my childhood memories are either related to my mom or my school. I can still remember a day I was late to come back home after school and that's because there was a ceremony at the school I did not know about. All of a certain I found that my mother was entering through the school-gate to find me. I was so frightened that my mother would rebuke me for being late unnoticed and she must be mad at me. But to my best surprise, when my mother saw me she had a warm smile in her face that I'll never forget till my last breath in this earth. Then she hugged me and gave me a kiss. I felt then that I love my mother more than me. She attended the program at the school and afterward we came back home together.

I spent my 19 years or so with my father and mother but I stay at a metropolitan city now for my education. Whenever I get vacation I meet my mother at my village home. On an average I spend 2/3 months with my mother each year but I talk to her over phone almost twice a day.

The reasons why I admire her are endless. She is caring, tender, she has got a big heart and she possesses love for everyone. She had been an ideal mother to raise 3 kids and making sure our education and moral values. She had made a lot of sacrifices all of her life and had never complained about anything to my best knowledge. She is the person who reminds me the power of love and caring.

Alternative Answer:

I have got 6 family members and all of them are very dear and close to me. If I need to pick one family member among them to talk about, that would be my father. My father's name is (say your father's name) and he is around 50 years old. He is the kind of person I would want my offspring to be. He did his graduation in a time when formal education was not people's first choice. They would rather start earning from work rather than going to school. My father fought to ensure his education with the people who thought working or doing some sort of business has more value than education. But my father believed that education is the most important part of a man's life. He heartily held the idea that education shapes a man's life and is the kind of power and asset that would always accompany him.

I have lots of memories of my father and I see him every day. There exists a strong bonding between us that only two of us feel. I still remember those days of my childhood when I used to wait in the evening for my father to return from office. He would then play with me and help on completing my lessons. I vividly remember him sometimes taking me to the market and buy me gifts. When I was an infant he moved to the city from the village to ensure me better schooling and environment. That was a decision that has changed my life path. He himself helped me finishing my home works and lessons, always allured me of gifts if I could complete my study. Besides my education he taught me lots of moral values and important things of life.

He used to work in a Government organization and for his hard-working and kindness; he is revered by all of our relatives, his friends and neighbors.

He believes in humanity, good behavior, our creator, and leads a life that can be exemplary. He still does most of his own works and helps my mom on her house hold works. After retirement he has picked 2 new habits: gardening and teaching neighbors' kids. He is a quiet and intelligent man who has benevolent heart and that what make him so admirable to me. He is still the pillar of our family and all of our family members love and respect him very much.

Describe your favorite restaurant

You should say:

Where it is

What it looks like inside and outside

What kinds of foods they serve***What makes this restaurant so special to you and others*****Cue card Answer 1:**

Thank you very much for giving me the chance to talk about my favourite restaurant. The name of my favourite restaurant is (say the name of the restaurant you are going to talk about) and it's situated at the centre of the city I am currently living in. Not only I like the spacious, serene environment, tasty menus that the restaurant serves, but I have lots of memories related to this restaurant. I remember that my parents celebrated some of my birthday parties there, our college friends arranged the get-together parties, one of my cousins' marriage ceremony was celebrated there and similarly I attended lots of other parties at this very restaurant.

The restaurant has 3 floors and the sitting arrangement is quite nice. Paintings of famous artists have been hanging on the walls and the place is quite neat and clean. The interior decoration is charming and gorgeous feeling. The ground floor is spacious and can accommodate more than 50 cars' parking. The front view of the restaurant is different as the place gives the impression of an urban garden.

The restaurant offers several dishes including exotic desserts, ice-creams and also offers a separate place for the kids to play and have fun. The prices are reasonable and the foods are served quickly as opposed to some other restaurants where you will have to wait for a long for your foods to appear on your table. The waiters and other staffs are friendly and welcoming. The restaurant offers Chinese, Italian, Indian, Thai, Pakistani and local menus that gives you a wide ranges and options to pick from. The soft background music and instrumentals make the environment more enjoyable and soothing. The tables are not congested and people can chat over their personal topics without interruption. The long glass made windows offer the city view which makes the place worth visiting besides the delicious foods. The place must be a good place to be as I often found the foreign tourists visiting the restaurant. The authority lets the customers provide their feedbacks and comments on foods and the place and as I have noticed they take prompt action on a customer complaint.

In short, this is a really nice restaurant to go and enjoy the delicious meals.

Cue card Answer 2:

Today I am going to talk about my favourite restaurant. Where it is, what it looks like, the kinds of food it serves and why it is so special to me.

My favourite restaurant is in England! It is actually in the suburbs of the city of Sheffield which is where I live. The restaurant is on a busy street very near to a large park. It is quite a small and hectic place called Jonty's because Jonty is the name of the person who set up the business.

From the outside the restaurant doesn't look very impressive. It has large glass windows at the front, and some benches outside for people to sit on if they are waiting

to go in. There used to be a large sign with the name of the restaurant written on it in big letters, but recently they have taken down the sign and not yet replaced it! Inside there are lots of square wooden tables, each with about four chairs around them. The restaurant is on two levels, I prefer to go upstairs to the first floor, because there you can sometimes get a window seat and enjoy watching people as they go past in the street outside.

The restaurant serves mainly breakfast and lunch meals. It does really good coffee – I like their latte's best – and lots of sandwiches, salads and special soups. The restaurant also has a selection of delicious, gooey home-made cakes. However, when I go, I always have the same thing – scrambled egg on wholemeal toast with mushrooms, because that is what I like best!

The restaurant is very special to me and my friends because we meet there every Saturday. On Saturday's about 500 people go to the local park for 9.00 in the morning to take part in a 5 km run. Afterwards, I like to go to breakfast at Jonty's with three of my best friends. We feel we deserve a big breakfast after our run, and we enjoy catching up with each other's news over a leisurely meal together.

So if ever you are in Sheffield, I hope you will find Jonty's and enjoy it as much as I do.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Sample:

You should talk about a restaurant that you know about. Do not pick a renowned restaurant that you know very little. You are free to describe the interior design, service, external environment, dishes served at the restaurant the way you like. It does not have to be an exact match with the restaurant you actually go to. You should add some of your memorable events at this restaurant. Some of the common features that people like about a restaurant are:

1. Delicious dishes.
2. Reasonable price.
3. Easy to go there from home.
4. Quiet and nice environment.
5. Attractive decoration and view.
6. Playground for kids.
7. Open space.
8. Privacy.
9. Service and behaviour of the staffs.
10. Special treats for the regular customer.
11. Variety of foods.
12. Past memory related to the restaurant.
13. Recommendation from friends and family members.
14. Discounts, etc.

"Describe a teacher who has influenced you in your education."

You should say:

- *Where you met him/ her.*
- *What subject s/he taught.*
- *What was special about him /her*
and explain why this person influenced you so much.

Possible Answer:

I consider myself lucky to get several very good teachers throughout my academic years. Among them I'd like to talk about Mr. Smith who was an extraordinary teacher, a really good mentor and who has a great influence in my education.

I met Mr. Smith when I was in class 4 and he was our math teacher. Initially we thought that he would be a moody teacher and we would have to be very polite in front of him. This impression came mostly because of his serious face and tidy dress-up. But soon we found that, he is a very friendly person and teaches us very well. He never made things complicated and tried over and over again to explain something to us. He had a very unique way of teaching. Seems like he would start an interesting story and later we would find that he would relate the math with the story. Thus everything we learned from him was interesting and that's why we remember most of the theory and techniques of math he taught us.

I'd say he has a great influence in my education because he made a very strong foundation on Mathematics. Later on I studied Science and the Mathematics was the most important subject. I have always been good at math and that's mainly because of Mr. Smith who had a major role on making the subject interesting to me. Before I learned math from Mr. Smith, my impression on math was not good and I considered mathematics to be a very difficult and uninteresting subject. But his teaching and influences changed my way of thinking about math and later on math became my one the most favourite subject.

Tips for answering this cue card question:

Talk about a teacher you remember and liked. Say his/her name and which class/ grade s/he taught. Also mention which subject she taught and what have you learned from him/ her. Following are some of the reasons a teacher becomes influential for a student that you can talk about:

The way of teaching is very effective and interesting.

S/he has a great personality and leads an exemplary life.

S/he tells lots of example and stories to make the subject and topic interesting.

S/he is a famous teacher on your locality who also taught your elder brother, father etc.

S/he has a great personality and because of that students like his/ her very much.

S/he has is successful explaining difficult topics in an easy and intuitive way.

S/he behaves very politely with all and never discriminates among students.

S/he is brave and speaks the right thing no matter what.

S/he teaches lots of moral values as well as inspires students to study properly.

Apart from teaching s/he does some social works, creative stuffs and or anything which is beneficial for others.

S/he is a great orator and has a great personality.

Describe Your Favorite movie

You should say:

1) What's the name of the movie/ film?

2) What's the theme of the movie/ film?

3) Why do you like it?

and describe the story of the movie in brief.

Possible Answer:

The name of my favourite movie is 'Casablanca' which was directed by Michael Curtiz. It was released in 1943 and the story was adopted from a stage-play named 'Everybody comes to Ricks'. The movie starred Humphrey Bogart & Ingrid Bergman and was made in USA. It was a romantic drama film and the story-line was set during the World War II. It focuses on a man torn between love & virtue. In 1941 American expatriot Rick who professed to be neutral by all means met his former lover Ilsa in his nightclub & gambling den. She was accompanied by her husband, Laszlo, a renowned fugitive Czech Resistance Leader. They needed a letter to escape to America, where he can continue his work against Nazis. German Major came to Casablanca to see that Laszlo does not succeed. One night Ilsa confronted Rick in the deserted cafe and asked for the letter. She threatened him with a gun for the letter and later on confessed that she still loves him. Rick's bitterness dissolved learning that Ilsa was married to Laszlo before even their relationship began. When Rick and Ilsa planned to flee together, she could not do so because all of a sudden she found that her husband was still alive and needed her badly to recover. Hearing the story Rick calmed down and agreed to give the letter to Laszlo so that he can fly to America safely. They would take a different path to fly away together. But finally Rick let Ilsa and Laszlo fly to America which surprised Ilsa very much.

In 1989, the film was selected for preservation in the United States National Film Registry a being deemed 'Culturally', 'Historically' and 'Aesthetically' significant. It is the 2nd best movie of all time based on AFI's 100 best movies of all time.

I've seen the movie more than 2-3 times. The story is excellent, the casting, plot, acting, dialogues and all other aspects of the movie is superb. The movie deeply touched me and became the most favourite movie I have ever seen.

Describe a historical place that you know about

You should say:

What the place is

Where it is located

What is the historical meaning of the place and describe your experience of the place.?

Possible Answer:

I have a special interest on visiting famous places and on my list historical places always get preferences. I have visited many historical places like Machu Picchu in Peru, The Pyramids at Giza, Taj Mahal, Parthenon in Greece and many more. The historical significance and the site attractions sometimes mesmerized me. The historical place that I would like to talk about today is Colosseum (also known as Coliseum, also known as the Flavian Amphitheatre) which is situated in Rome, Italy. It is basically an elliptical amphitheatre in the centre of the city of Rome, Italy which is the largest amphitheatre in the world and is made of concrete and stone. The construction of Colosseum began under the emperor Vespasian in 70 AD and was completed under Titus in 80 AD. The Colosseum could hold approximately 50,000 to 80,000 spectators and was used for gladiatorial contests and public spectacles such as mock sea battles, animal hunts, executions, re-enactments of famous battles etc. The Colosseum was listed as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO in 1980 and was also included among the New Seven Wonders of the World. It is 189 meters long, and 156 meters wide, with a base area of 6 acres. The height of the outer wall is 48 meters. The Colosseum nowadays is one of the major tourist attractions in Rome with thousands of tourists each year paying to view the interior arena. I have heard and seen of this famous place a lot and when I witnessed it for the first time, I became speechless. The huge architect, the overwhelming interior and exterior decoration was beyond appreciation. The place kept reminding me the classical mythological and historical facts I have read and heard about.

Tips for answering this cue card topic:

This cue card is different from the cue card 'describe a historic place you have visited'. For the later one you should pick a historic place which is usually located in your country and you have visited. In this case you need to say when you visited and what you enjoyed there. But for the cue card 'describe a historic place that you know about', you can talk about any historic place located at anywhere in the world. Not necessarily you need to visit a place to know about it.

Do not pick a place which has very little historic significance or the places that store historic evidences but not itself is a historic place. For instance, you can learn a lot about history from museum but the museum is not a historic place. A historic place can be part of national history or international history. For instance, some places in your country may be the part of the history of your country but not known in world history. In your IELTS you can pick such nationally recognized historic places. There is a subtle difference between a famous place and the historic place. To be a historic place, the place itself has to be qualified and registered for the historic place. Don't pick a broad area or a whole city as a historic place, rather pick the particular place. Like, there are lots of historic places in Rome like: Colosseum, The Pantheon, St Peter's Basilica etc. and if you pick Rome as the historic place, you won't be able to cover all the historic significance of this city. Alternatively, picking only Colosseum or The Pantheon would give you a better option to describe it.

Describe a journey you went on.

You Should say:

Where did you go on your journey?

Why did you go to this particular place?

What did you do and with whom?

and describe why you enjoyed your journey? Or if not why?

Possible Answer 1:

I like visiting famous places and whenever I get vacation, I try to visit new places or places that I have heard about. One such trip that I took with one of my friends was a journey to Holland. I would like to talk about this tour to Holland that we took 2 years ago.

Both of us (me and my friend) wanted to visit Holland and specifically Amsterdam, Hague and Rotterdam very much because we saw pictures and heard stories from friends about how beautiful and wonderful the place is. So finally we applied for visa, bought plane tickets, booked a hotel, packed our bags and our trip began.

We spent a lot of time before our holiday, researching of all the interesting places to visit and all the sights to see. So we went to Rijks museum, Van Gogh museum, Amstell Beer museum, took a romantic sunset cruise in the water channels, drove to Volendam, a small prettiest fisherman village, visited a cheese farm. We went to Rotterdam, which is the architecture city of Holland that stimulates innovation. We enjoyed the architectures and building there as much as we did walking in the neat roads and besides the beaches. Visiting the famous Anne Frank house was an exciting moment for me. I've read the Anne Frank's Diary in my early childhood and witnessing the place was very much exciting.

Every evening we took long walks along the channels, resting in small gardens, which Amsterdam has a lot of. Street artists were performing everywhere and a lot of people came to watch their show.

We enjoyed very much everything we did and especially in such a beautiful country. Having my friend by my side on this trip made it even more fun. Since we have never been to Holland, everything we saw and did seemed interesting and completely new to us. The people, their way to interpretation their culture attracted us very much. Before leaving the place, both of us agreed that the place is worth visiting and someday we would come back to re-explore it.

Possible Answer 2:

Once I was reading an article when I came across the lines of Rabindranath Tagore highlighting the beauty of Taj Mahal. It stated, "The Taj Mahal rises above the banks of the river like a solitary tear suspended on the cheek of time." The lines encouraged me to visit the monument of love, The Taj Mahal. Taj Mahal is included in the Seven Wonders of the World. So, before even I think of visiting any other site, it becomes more of a responsibility to give a visit to the heritage site of India. It was the prime reason I visited Taj Mahal. It was a short trip with my family. My parents and my brother accompanied on my trip. It was a fun-filled trip as after a long time I got an opportunity to spend time with my family. Moreover, we opted for a road trip so that we had the flexibility to visit other famous places in Agra. It is rightly said, that journey matters, and not the destination, and this is what I experienced during my short-trip.

Tips for answering this Cue card question:

You are free to talk about any journey you are comfortable to talk about. It can be journey to another city of your country, to a historic or tourist place, a foreign country or to a relative or friend's house to a different location. While talking about this cue card, take some notes about a journey you remember particularly where you went, what was the purpose of going there, how you travelled there, what you saw on your way and at the place, what you did, how long you stayed, whom you met there, who you went there with. If you liked the journey tell about some exciting things you watched and did there than the usual things you do. For instance: you can mention some of the great places you visited there, the sightseeing of the journey. Do not focus too much on the place you went rather emphasize what happened on the way. This cue card is bit different that 'Describe a place you have visited' where you would mostly describe things you watched and did on the place but for this cue card you should mostly tell about your experience during the journey.

Some key points to mention for this cue card:

You had a plan to visit this place for a long time and when you had the journey, you had been excited about the whole thing.

You would meet a friend or relative after a long and that made you feel good.

You have some memories related to this place and visiting there was a good experience for you.

If this is a foreign country, say that you had a longing to visit this country.

The weather was comfortable and there was no interruption on the way.

You had friends with you and you enjoyed their company as well as the vehicles.

This was not a typical journey that you usually take.

The natural beauty surrounding the roads was charming.

You observed some different custom and culture there.

Describe a website you often browse.

You should say:

What is it

How long have you been using it

Detailed information about the website

and explain why you often browse this website.

Possible Answer :

I've been using the internet for more than 10 years and from the very beginning till now there are some websites those I use almost every day. www.yahoo.com is one of those web-sites and possibly I'll use this site forever. www.yahoo.com is basically an e-mail service provider and a very popular search engine. I can still remember my first day at a cyber-cafe where I opened the first web site of my life and that was yahoo.com and the cafe owner helped me to open an e-mail address and I still use this email address to send and receive e-mails and for chatting. www.yahoo.com is a popular search engine possibly next to www.google.com but as an e-mail service provider it is more popular than www.google.com in my country .This web-site has many other useful features like: the homepage contains up-to-date news and feeds. It also gives the option to open free websites to its users etc. www.my.yahoo.com is a very popular service and recently the www.answers.yahoo.com has become one of the most popular questions and answers web-site that's millions of people are using.

Alternative Answer:

I use internet daily and there are lots of websites that I often browse for different reasons. But probably www.facebook.com is the one I most often browse. It is a social networking website and probably is one of the top 5 most visited websites in the world. The website mainly facilitates me stay connected with my friends and helps me update and broadcast my news as well. Though the primary purpose of this website is to let people communicate friends and known people but there are lots of other features as well. It offers games, eCommerce facility, emailing, chatting, making new friends, social marketing, different campaign, fan page opening etc. I have been using the website from 2004 and it is important to me because all of my friends and relatives are connected there. If a friend has a birthday, the website notifies me and I can wish him/her a birthday, if someone has a new photo or news to share, I can see it from my account. I can share my photo, video, updates, thought as well. If someone opines on an issue, others can comment on it. For me, the website is important because my

childhood friends, adolescence friends, college & University friends are connected there. I get their updates regularly and can let them know what's happening over here. In no other way I could have been connected to the people I am now connected via facebook. I use this website from my computer and from my cell phone as well. For me this is a social networking website where I remain close to my friends and relatives. But with its own right it has become a powerful eCommerce platform, gaming place, marketing channel, and many more other business related platform.

Nowadays everybody owns a facebook ID. Making new friends is easy in facebook and that helps people grow their friends beyond boundary. Millions of people use facebook and it is almost impossible to connect with people you care and know without this website.

Model Answer 3:

I have just a few minutes to tell you about a website I often browse. I will tell you what the website is, how long I've been using it, a bit about what is on it and why I visit it so often.

The website is the BBC news website. You can find it at <http://www.bbc.co.uk/news> but I just have it as a favourite on my toolbar.

I am a complete BBC junkie! I visit the website several times a day if I can, and have been using it for as long as I can remember. Possibly for as long as the website has been in existence but definitely for the past ten years or more.

The BBC news website is massive. It contains rolling headlines of breaking news, and from the landing page you can jump to sections on different types of news categories. For example there are tabs for world news; health issues; environmental reports; education; sport; education and science as well as entertainment and arts stories. You can read just text based articles illustrated with a few pictures – which is my preferred way of accessing news and information – or you can opt to see news film or audio clips. I think the website is really comprehensive and easy to use too.

The BBC news website for me, is a one-stop location for all current affairs and news items. I really like that I can see headlines of breaking news almost instantaneously, but it also includes more thoughtful reporting. Detailed online articles with considered analysis about global or local events. I can also find out what the weather forecast is – always handy in the UK where it can change so quickly, plus I like to be able to keep an eye on what is happening locally to me in Sheffield where I live. I also trust the BBC website to give balanced reporting, I think it has journalistic integrity, so I feel if I read it every day, I will have a good perspective on what is going on in the world, and enough information to come to my own conclusions on current affairs across the globe. The only downside of the website is that I find it can be a bit addictive! Because it is updated frequently it is tempting to keep going back and having another look if there is some running news item that I am following. It can lead me to procrastinate when I am supposed to be working, but I tell myself it is important to keep up to date with what is

going on in the world, even though I know that really, it wouldn't hurt to limit myself to a news 'fix' just a couple of times a day!

I wonder if you use the website too, and if you do, whether you might as avid a follower as me!

Tips for answering this Cue Card question:

Pick a website which is popular and you often visit. If you prefer to talk about a website which is not known to all, mention that this is not a very popular website but I visit it for this particular reason. You can pick a social networking website, email service providing website, news channel website, your university or office website, a website you have developed and visit for updating it, Wikipedia like website etc. If you pick a website which is popular, do not give any fictitious information. Giving false information about a well-known website like Google, Yahoo or Facebook would create some doubts in the examiner's mind as s/he might also be a user of this website.

Do not worry if you do not know every details of the website even if the question asks you to describe about it. If you do not know the owner name, operation since, technical aspects of the website, simply skip those parts instead of giving imaginary information. You can focus on what the website offers to the visitors and what you do from this website. For instance:

Social Networking websites:

Most of my friends are also connected in this website/ social network and I get their updates.

I can publish my updates and let my friends know about it.

It helps me finding my old friends/ family members.

It offers me to use third party applications and play games.

I can share my images and videos.

Help me find out information related to my education/ job.

Chat with my friends.

Email Service providers:

I send emails from this website.

I check the emails sent to me.

I can send attachments.

Has a good spam filtering and threat detection service.

Wikipedia like website:

Helps me finding reliable and details information on various topics.

Loads faster and has subscription option.

I can contribute on updating the information.

Most of the topics are covered and you can get almost all of the information you need.

News websites:

Provides updated and latest news.
 Both local and international news are served.
 Has email notification service on my selective topics.
 Gives sports news and events.
 Offers interesting supplementary and magazines as well.
 News presentation is outstanding and sources are very reliable.
 Covers last minute news as well.

Describe a newspaper or a magazine

What is it and why you read it

What are the benefits of reading a newspaper or a magazine

How often you read it and what are the contents of it

and explain why do you like to read this newspaper or magazine

Possible Answer:

I read newspaper almost every day and sometimes I purchase or borrow magazines to read as well. I'd like to describe a magazine that I usually buy each month and enjoy reading a lot. The name of this magazine is PC World which is a global computer magazine published monthly by IDG in USA. It offers advice on various aspects of PCs and related items, the Internet, and other personal-technology products and services. In each publication, PC World reviews and tests hardware and software products from a variety of manufacturers, as well as other technology related devices such as still and video cameras, audio devices and televisions.

I have been reading this magazine for the last 6-7 years or so. It is specifically useful for people who love computers, other technology devices; software and IT related news and updates. I am doing my graduation in Computer Science and Engineering and love to learn about new hardware and software. This is a magazine that offers great hardware & software reviews, tips on advanced computing and many other useful articles.

Reading a newspaper or a magazine is always helpful for learning new information. Newspapers provide contemporary local news, international news, editorials, entertainment, news, sports news and so on. Without reading newspapers or magazines one can't keep himself / herself updated with the latest news and views of the world. I purchase the PC World magazine every month and read it for about 7 days. Sometimes I read older versions as well to find out any particular reviews or articles. This magazine is helpful for basic, moderate and advanced computer users and techno lovers. Someone who has a computer should read it to increase his/ her knowledge on hardware and software. Even it's helpful for those who are going to buy computers, printers, cameras, scanners, software or other hardware devices. I enjoy reading it a lot.

Sample Answer 2:

Today I'm going to talk about one of my favourite magazines. It's quite fun to think about it, first I'll tell you what it is and why I read it. Then I'll try and persuade you of the benefits of doing so, and a bit about how often I read it and what the contents are. Finally, I'll explain why I like to read it so much.

The magazine is called 'Women's Running'. It's a monthly publication, dedicated to helping female runners, at every level to improve their running and learn more about the sport.

For me the benefits of reading this periodical are huge. It has great information about running techniques and nutrition; advertising features on new running related products; helpful articles on topics like 'how to choose new trainers' and advice on running events and how to prepare for them. That is great in itself, but even more importantly for me, it contains lots of human interest stories. Real women talking about their experiences of running, why they do it and how they stay motivated, keep positive and enjoy the sport.

Even though I do like the magazine, it is really expensive, it's £4 a time, so I'm embarrassed to admit I don't buy my own copy. Instead, I have a friend who subscribes to it regularly. Every few months she has a big clear out, and she drops off a great big bag of magazines for me to read. I then have a binge of reading about running – which is a bit ironic really, I should be out doing it rather than reading about it! So I don't read it each month, but every few months I'll have a whole weekend curled up on the sofa avidly soaking up every article. I read each copy from cover to cover. I like the personal accounts best. Women talking about perhaps over-coming injuries and illness to keep on running; forming friendships and achieving goals they never thought possible. It can be really inspirational! It makes me believe that I too can do more than I think. Once I've read all the magazines I keep them for a while to refer back to, but eventually I too need to de-clutter, so I'll pass them on to another running friend, and so the cycle continues!

Through reading the magazine I've started to think of myself more as part of the 'running community' whatever that means! I've started to realise that not everyone who takes part in running is choosing to do ultra-marathons, we can all run at our own level and still get the fitness and social benefits at whatever level you are at. The main competition is not with other people but with yourself, other runners can support and help you whether that's with advice on how to up your speed or distances to get a new Personal Best or agreeing to go out with you on a wet and windy night when really the sofa looks a great deal more appealing than a rain soaked pavement in winter!

Tips for answering this Cue Card Topic:

To answer this cue card, first decide if you are going to talk about a newspaper or a magazine. If you want to talk about a newspaper, decide which one you would like to talk. For the magazine you should finalize the magazine name also. Deciding a particular newspaper or magazine would help you focus on the features and

characteristics of it. There are some differences between a daily newspaper and a magazine.

If you decide to talk about the magazine focus on following points:

- a) What type of magazine it is: weekly, monthly etc.
- b) what's it about: Lifestyle, technology, fun, business travel, fashion etc.
- c) For magazine describe the topics and issues it covers. Like a computer magazine covers the software and hardware reviews, tips on computing, tutorials, and price list etc. whereas a fashion magazine highlights the current trends in fashion, new arrivals and focus on brands.
- d) Why do I read it? Entertainment, tutorials, academic or professional benefits, new recipes etc.
- e) Why this magazine is better than similar other magazines? Article presentation, economic, has subscription facility, exclusive etc.

If you talk about a newspaper focus on their news presentation, editorial and overall contribution to help people get unbiased and quality news and articles.

Since, almost all the daily newspapers cover same type of news i.e. political, sports, editorial, international, business etc. you should focus less on the type of news they present. Rather emphasize what makes it a worth reading newspaper.

Describe an accident you saw

You should say:

Where the accident occurred

Where you were then

How the accident affected you

and give detailed information about the accident

Possible Answer:

The most devastating accident that I have ever seen is the one that I witnessed near (say the name of the place) while a train smashed a passing bus. I saw accident almost 4 years back and yet I can remember the event clearly. I was on my way to home from the capital city that I'm currently residing in. There is a train pass in the road and our bus stopped at the signal. I was busy reading a magazine in the bus and all of a sudden I heard a loud blasting sound and I looked through the window. What I saw was unbelievable: The quickly passing train has hit a bus that was trying to pass the train road. The bus had been thrown away like a toy and we could hear the unbearable screaming of victims. Lots of people have gathered the place and the train was passing slowly. People became speechless on the effect of the devastating accident. I could see people were trying to help the wounded people and 2-3 ambulances reached there after 15 minutes. The bus driver was blamed for the incident and I heard that he was dead too. We could not move on from the place as a huge jam occurred. The wounded people were moved to nearby hospitals and medical centers and the dead people were

placed in a nearby field. The entire place became a gloomy area and people mourned on the event. I started feeling sick and tried to help the wounded people.

I have witnessed more than 30 people were lying dead and their relatives were crying and mourning heavily. I left the place after 8/9 hours and could not think anything else. The whole event occurred in a few minutes and the effect was devastating. I had spent nearly 2 weeks in a hallucination and thought a lot about the people who died there and about their relatives. It came to my mind that, our life is hanging on the cliffs and we are so helpless sometimes deciding our fates.

Tips for answering this cue card topic:

Watching an accident and its effect is a devastating experience. So describe how dangerous the accident was, how awfully you felt about it. Even if you have not seen any major accident, you should talk about one. Pick some of the points from the below list to describe this cue card:

1. It was a car accident/ bus accident/ train accident.
2. You were just passing by/ were in another transport while the accident occurred.
3. Everything happened all of a sudden and you were devastated to watch it.
4. You can also talk about a plane crash but for that mention that you watched it on TV.
5. If you live in a country where water transportations are available, you can talk about the boat accident due to storm as well.
6. Describe how severely the accident caused damage.
7. Mention that due to the accident you were stuck there for a long time and raised your helping hand.
8. Tell how bad you felt and what steps should be taken to prevent such unexpected and unbearable accident.
9. If you were the victim of the accident, give details on how the accident occurred and how you were safe.
10. Tell that you had a hard time forgetting this mournful experience.
11. Regarding the part 'how the accident affected you' say about your feeling of the unsafety of the road, how uncertain our lives are, what changes you brought to your life after the accident etc.

Describe a museum that you have visited

You should say:

- When you visited the museum
 - Describe the museum
 - How you felt after going there
- and describe your experience of the visit

Possible Answer:

I have visited 5-6 museums in total in different countries and enjoyed visiting the (tell a museum name you know about) in (say the country name). I went to the museum 2 years back while visiting the city. Visiting the museum was not in our tour plan and yet we went there as it was prominently expressing its present in front of us. I went there with my 2 friends and one cousin who were my tour partners. My cousin and one of my friends were not at all interested to roam inside the museum as they had other plans. I insisted them to go there and convinced them by saying that if you do not enjoy it; I would pay for the dinner!

After we bought our tickets, we entered in to the museum and the colossal front side of the museum building and the large open garden in front of it mesmerized us. At that time I had a feeling that our time would worth the visit.

After we entered inside the museum, we found that the place is even larger than we initially thought it would be. There were 5 floors in the museum and the inside architecture reminded us the imperial age. We could see the top of the building from the ground floor. People from different age groups and countries were closely observing the museum. Taking photo was prohibited and yet I was sometimes allured to take some hidden snaps especially when I saw the colossal dinosaur fossil and alien ship!

The first floor of the museum had some art from famous artist of the world and sculptures from different era. The first floor gave us the impression of visiting a theatre or art gallery rather than museum. We came to know that some of the arts were so expensive that one can buy an island by selling it! Then we moved to the second floor which was full of Second World War memories. Guns, tanks and other war materials from 1945 WW II had been arranged there. A video was showing some of the fighting scenes of WW II.

When we reached third floor, it's been already 2.5 hours. We found all the costumes and traditional things from different parts of the world have been placed here. One can easily learn about the customs of different ages and countries just by visiting this floor.

The next floor had more adventure and surprises for us. It has placed all the major inventions of different ages and they were historically famous. I felt overwhelmed seeing the First computer, Speed boat, Wheel, Motor Engine and many more famous invention of history at this floor. I was so much dying to touch the first 4 wheeler that had been placed there.

We had visited the whole museum as much as possible and spent almost the whole day. We were so enthralled to visit the place that we literally forgot to have our lunch. The overall experience was fantastic and I learned so many things in few hours. As soon as I left the place, I planned to revisit it someday.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Topic:

While describing a museum you should pick the national stadium of your country. If you have already visited the museum, you should be comfortable describing it. Since this is the museum that the examiner might also know about, you should give the factual information of it. Start by saying when you visited it, with whom you went there, number of times you went there, the exterior or interior of the museum, number of floors of the museum, things you did there, the things present there and so on. If you can't remember an exact museum try to visualize one and describe the museum as if you have visited it. If you ever been to a foreign country and visited a museum of that city, you can also mention that museum. If the cue card topic asks you to describe a museum in your country, you would then have to describe a museum located at your country.

Some of the common features of a museum:

1. A museum is a place where collection of artifacts and other things are preserved for public exhibition.
2. Almost all of the countries have museums in their major cities.
3. The things preserved there are generally of scientific, cultural, historic and artistic interests.
4. Things are arranged and categorized on different floors for the convenience of the visitors.

There are several types of museums based on the types of things they present for public exhibition and you can talk about any type of museum you like and know about. General categories of museum are as following:

Cultural museum, historic museum, science and technology museum, craft museum, fine arts museum, archaeology museum, natural history museum, children's museum, modern art museum, military history museum, aviation museum, universal museum etc.

A botanical garden or a zoological garden is also referred as a museum but avoid describing one of these two unless you have no clue about the other types of museum. If you plan to describe a botanical garden or a zoological garden as a museum, make it clear at the very first level of your speaking so that the examiner does not have any confusion.

Describe an old person you admire

You should say:

Who this person is?

How long you have known him/ her?

What qualities he/ she has?

And say why do you admire him/ her?

Possible Answer:

The aged person whom I really admire and like is my grandmother. From my childhood she had been a caring person and loved me very much. Still she is a good friend of mine whom I share many things. She is a benevolent and good person who possesses a good heart. She tries to help others with her highest efforts. I know her from my childhood as she lives with us and we have lots of happy memories together.

She is a successful mother of 4 persons including my father. She has devoted her life for her kids and made them educated and established. She possesses a nice and charming personality that illuminate people around her. She is a kind and a wise woman.

I love and admire her for many different reasons. The most important reason is because of her unconditional love and affection for me. She is a good mentor who can show me positive ways and guide me in my distressed time. Talking to her is a soothing experience and the story she tells is always attractive and full of morality. I have learned many positive attitudes and good thinking from her. For all those reasons and a strong bonding between us I admire her very much.

Tips for answering this cue card topic:

You can talk about one of your relatives who is a senior citizen like your grandfather, grandmother. If you talk about one of your grandparents, you would be able to give lots of details since you know a lot about them. Alternatively, you can talk about one of the aged persons who is your relative, neighbour, friend's grandparents, teacher, a renowned person of your country who has great contribution in some ways.

It is advisory not to talk about a person who is dead. As the issue expects you to talk about the old person who is alive and have some sort of interaction with you or had some intimacy or influences on you. While describing the qualities s/he has, keep in mind that you should talk in a way so that you can conclude by saying that you admire his/ her for all the previously said qualities s/he has and because of your intimacy/ relationship with him/ her.

Usually we like a senior person for some of the following reasons:

S/he is **a relative** and **has intimacy** with us.

We have some **good memories with** this person. S/he has done many things for us.

We are close to the person and we **share our updates**.

S/he is **talented** and gives us **good advises** when needed.

Is a successful person and **exemplary for** others.

Have some **contributions for** the betterment of others.

Is a **honest/** brave and very talented person.

You have learned a lot from him/ her. He still gives you good advises.

Is kind and a **well-wisher**.

Is bit strange and you like his/her qualities.

Successful parents and led a great life.

You do some sort of activities together.

Describe a thing that you possess and which is important to you. (electronic instrument)

You should say:

What is it and who gave it to you

What's the specialty of it

Would you ever give it to someone else
and explain why it is important to you

Possible Answer:

My cell phone is very important to me as it helps me communicating my friends, family members, teachers and gets me connected with the people I care. I use internet in my cell phone, check my mails, update my blog, track the statistics of my website, send and receive SMS, play games, listen to music, take pictures and then share in my Facebook, Google plus and twitter profile. Besides these I do lots of other things in my cell phone including using important apps, reading e-books, using it as a modem to use internet in my PC etc. My father gave me the money to buy a cell phone and I bought the HTC desire X cell phone from an authorized seller. So my father actually gave the mobile phone to me.

This smart phone has versatile usages and is very special to me. I spent a significant time with this device and some of them are very positive for me like updating my blog and reading e-books. This is a small device with approximately 6.5 x 4 inch dimension but it is a powerful tool and the internet connection in it makes it even more powerful. The first and foremost specialty of this device is that it lets me get connected with my family members and friends. Second, it is an amusement and recreational device that lets me play games and listen to music. Third, I can update my social networking profiles and get updates of my friend right from my cell phone. I had to go to a cyber cafe to check an email or to send one before I purchased this smart phone. Now I have

this handy device that I can easily use to connect to internet. Since this is an android OS device I can download many application and tutorials and learn new things.

Sometimes I take photos and then share it with my friends. Communication has become so easy and convenient with the help of this cell phone.

Yes, if needed I can give this device to someone who I care about but I will then have to own another one. It's not like I will give this cell phone to someone and then would stop using any cell phone or switch to an ordinary phone. What I mean is, I can give this particular phone to someone but can't stop using a Smartphone.

Technological advantages have made things easier especially communication and my cell phone is a really unavoidable and inevitable device to me.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Topic:

This cue card question asks you to talk about something you possess and which is useful to you. Since the question implies that it is a tangible thing you should not talk about something you can't touch like your painting habit, your music lessons, some advice you got from someone etc. You can talk about one of the following devices or things that you have and important to you:

Your cell phone. Your laptop or computer. A gift you got from someone. Your certificate.

A famous book or CD. Your pager or land phone. Your gaming device Your exercise instruments. One of your household appliance. Your notebook. A car you own. A motorbike you have. A greeting card/ letter you got. A musical or sports instrument. etc.

You should talk about the thing, how you use it, how it is helpful to you and if you would give it someone or not.

Mention some of the points regarding this thing mentioned below:

1. This was a special gift from a family member or from a friend.
2. You use it daily and you will have a difficult time if you lose it.
3. You become dependent on it and it helps you to communicate with others/ help you enhance your knowledge.
4. It helps you to do exercise and thus helps you keep your body and mind fit.
5. You learn something using it.
6. It has some memory related to someone and thus it is important to you.
7. This is a valuable possession and you do not want to lose it.
8. You would give it to someone who you really care and s/he needs that more than you do.

9. You would not give to someone random because it is very useful to you.

Describe a television programme you watched and did not enjoy

You should say:

what this programme was

where and when you watched it

what it was about

and explain why you did not enjoy it

Model Answer:

We usually do not watch TV programs that we not like and since we have lots of channels to pick from, we change the channel as soon as we find that this is not an interesting program. But sometimes we have to watch the program that other people are watching and we do not have control on the channel changing and thus we often watch programs that we do not like at all, one such program was a talk show that I recently watched. This was a talk show in our national TV channel (...say the name of a TV channel...) and apart from the host there were two political figure who came from 2 opposite parties. Since this is a famous TV channel, I am sure a good number of people watched it. I watched it at a friend's house when I was sitting at their drawing room and my friend's uncle was watching and controlling the TV channels.

The talk show was about a sensitive national issue and the starting was interesting as the host of the program discussed in details about the program and later on asked some interesting questions to the two guests. After 5 minutes or so, I got an impression that the talk show was scam and with this program the Government is trying to give some misleading facts to the viewers. The two guests started attacking each other and showed abominable attitude to each others. That was so surprising that respectable people like them can behave so abhorrently. The program went on and I found that I was completely irritated to see such type of behaviors from our national leaders and the feelings that this was a scam gave me nausea. I left the room before the program ended and walked outside for about 30 minutes. After I returned I found that the program ah ended and that was a kind of relief for me.

Describe a situation when you were late

You should say:

What was the event you were late for

What was the reason that you were late

How did you feel about it

and explain how did you handle it

Model Answer:

The city I live in has a severe problem of traffic jam and due to that we often get late. One such event when I was late in an important exam was a frustrating experience for

me. It was 2 years ago when I was a student of the university. I had an exam at 8.30 am which I thought would be at 9.30 am. I did this mistake because I noted the time wrong in my notebook. I prepared for the exam well and left home at 8.15 am as my usual journey to my university takes around 40 minutes. According to the schedule, I should have reached at least 30 minutes before the exam time.

I already had wrong idea about the exam timing and over it I found that it was raining outside and there were very little transportation available in the road. I had to stand at the bus stoppage for more than 30 minutes before I actually got into a bus. To my surprise, the traffic on the road was very bad. The bus was moving very slowly because of the unavoidable traffic jam. I was hopping desperately to reach the university in time. But that was not my day! I reached at the exam hall at 10.15 am and I was shocked to learn that the exam would end only in 15 minutes. I was so worried and anxious that I could not think clearly what to do.

I felt helpless at that time and was asked the teacher what can I do now. He asked me to come after the exam ends. I followed him as soon as he left the exam room. I noticed that some of my classmates were also looking at me with surprise and were probably thinking how careless I was to miss such an important exam.

After I reach the class exam coordinator's room, he took me to our advising tutor and asked me to give a good reason why I was late for the exam. I told everything that has happened and the coordinator arranged an exam in his room. As a penalty he deducted 20 minutes from the exam time and asked me to finish the exam and leave the answer sheet to him. I was kind of worried and felt bit relived also. As my preparation was good,

I had been able to answer all the questions in the due time. Thus the situation was handled and I was not in a big trouble for the late I made unintentionally.

Describe a time when you were asked to give your opinion in a questionnaire or survey.

You should say:

what the questionnaire/survey was about

why you were asked to give your opinions

what opinions you gave

and explain how you felt about giving your opinions in this questionnaire/ survey.

Sample Answer:

The survey I recall very clearly that I participated was the one conducted in our university. I was a student of 7th semester then and I actively participated in University debate team. Our team did well in different contents and then our university administration took this seriously. As part of their initiatives, they conducted a survey to gather information what can be done to make the team even better. As far as I recall, it was Friday evening and after reaching the 6th floor of our university debate team room, I heard that we will have a session in the auditorium. We left the room and went to the

auditorium. I was amazed to notice some of the high level administrative officials in the hall and then learned that they would be discussing about the debate team we have.

They congratulated us and promised that they would help the team and the association every way possible so that we can practice and do even better in the future. As part of the discussion, the debate team members, trainers and associated members were asked to take part in a survey. After I got the survey papers and pen, I found that that was a questionnaire of 2 pages and there were approximately 20 questions there. Most of the questions were multiple choices but there were 5-6 questions that asked to write our comments or thoughts. The topic of the survey was (as far as remember): "How initiatives can be taken and what improvements can be done to make our university debate team even better". As a debate team member and active debater I was naturally asked to participate in the survey to express my opinion. I mostly expresses what should be done to make the debate team a good one, appreciated the university authority's so far help and specifically mentioned what are the difficulties we have faced and what are the steps that should be taken to eradicate this issues. I was excited that the upper administration was taking notice on our debate team and when they conducted the survey, I felt really good and kind of honored to be the part of the team. I have been involved in the debate team for about 2 years and with very little help from the university fund and administration we started doing better and after the session and survey I felt it was worthy to be the part of the extra curriculum activities.

The overall experience was good and that's why I still remember this survey; even after I took part many different marketing and online surveys, this one was special to me.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Question:

People are usually asked to give opinion in a questionnaire or survey when they are a part of a team and the authority feels that the team members opinion are needed to bring some changes. Also a marketing executive or marketing representative can ask you to volunteer in their survey to give your opinion on their products or survey. The government runs some survey among people to know the overall opinion of the countrymen. Sometimes you would be asked to give your opinion by a radio, television channel about an issue or on their program quality. You should be able to talk about one such survey or questionnaire you were asked or requested to take part. The questionnaire can be both in written and verbal form.

For this cue card first say a survey you have taken part and mention when it was, what was the survey, who conducted it and whether you have given written answer to the questionnaire or verbally. Some surveys ask people to give survey takers identity while some conduct it anonymously. Mention what type of survey you took.

You should try to talk about a survey that has some value like a survey conducted by the local authority to make the area a better place rather than the random marketing surveys.

For the second question "why you were asked to give your opinions" say the reason the survey conductor asked you to participate it. If it was a marketing survey say that you were randomly picked. If this is a survey conducted by the local administration, say they conducted the survey among the local people and you were one of them. Being a part of a team sometimes may require you to take part of the survey and if you talk about such a survey, mention that you were asked to take part of this survey because of your involvement in the team.

For the question "what opinions you gave", you do not need to talk about the questions asked in the survey and the exact answers you gave. Try to give an overview of the things which were asked and a summary of the opinion and answer you gave.

If the survey was an important one for the team authority, mention that you felt really proud to be able to let the authority know your thinking. If this was a marketing survey mention that you felt well to let them know how your idea of their product or service. If this was your first survey mention that you were very excited to be able to gain a new experience as you have never took part in such a survey. Give some reason why the survey was important and finally say that it was important for you to give your thinking and you felt really good for being able to do so.

Describe one of your favourite electronic media like TV / printing media / radio etc.

You should say:

what is it and why it's your favourite

what do you do with it

why it's useful for you

and describe the advantages and disadvantages of this media

My favourite electronic media is TV and I guess this is the most popular electronic media in the world. With the popularity of the satellite and diversity and quality of the programs offered by different channels, people started liking the TV programs more than ever. With the TV satellite network connection, watching more than 500 channels cost a very little amount.

Television offers various kinds of channels and people can easily pick the channels they like. News, Movies, documentary, entertainment, soap opera, music, sports, lifestyle channels offers entertainment as well as different information and news. People heavily rely on TV news for latest and international news. The audio visual representation of news and information in TV are easier to grasp than other media like radio and magazines. I watch news, documentary, movies and music on TV. There are lots of channels that offer specialized programs for people and among them I find National Geographic, Discovery, BBC are very reliable and authentic source of information.

I can't always catch up with the newspaper and can easily get updates from TV in few minutes. I get sports news and can watch live games on TV. The main advantages of

television are the ease with which it offers news, information and entertainment. One can easily watch TV while getting involved in other tasks which is quite impossible for other media like print media. The variation of program and channels offered are helpful for people to easily pick one's favourite channels. We can watch live events and news on TV and with the advancement of technology; it has become easier for everyone to own a TV.

The main disadvantage of this media is that, it is addictive. People become addicted to TV programs and thus often spend more time watching TV than they should have. Biased news sometimes mislead people and causes non-avoidable conflicts. Too much time spent on watching television has some health issues and specifically harms kids who watch TV for a long time. Apart from that, Some TV channels broadcasts programs which are not suitable for all and this can cause harms to people.

Describe a computer game you have played

You should say:

What it was

When you played it

What the game was about

And explain how you played this game.

For a long time I do not play computer games as I got busy with other tasks and can hardly manage time nowadays but I was a hardcore fan of the game Age of Empires 2. This was a strategy game developed by Ensemble Studios and published by Microsoft Studios. There were three series of this game and I played the second series called Age of Empire the Conqueror. This was a historic strategy games that the gamers could have played either in single player or in multiplayer mode.

I mostly played it when I was 16-18 years old. I usually played it against computer competitors and sometimes against my friends over the computer network.

There were several civilizations that a player had to pick from and then develop this civilization in every aspect to protect it from the attack of other civilizations. Each civilization had its own strength and weakness and the player had to control the game for a long time. The different soldiers, defense mechanism, war strategy, war defense and research and different technologies made it a really interesting game.

I often played it against computer when I picked a civilization and computer had other 3 civilizations. We fought each other and often I won the games against computer in Hard game mode. I often played against my friends and that was a different experience as I had to compete against real human. That was more competitive and I enjoyed thoroughly playing against my friends.

Describe an experience when you lost something

You should say:

What you lost

How you lost it

Where you lost it

And explain how you felt about it.

Model Answer:

I was in the second year of my university and at that time I lost my laptop with some other necessary papers and the experience was so bitter that I still remember it. I was on my way to home from the university and I took a public bus to reach home. I had my bag with me that contained my laptop, charger, some music DVDs, a pen drive, 2 books and some other necessary papers. I lost the bag so the things that I had in my bag were also lost.

I remember that I had my bag with me and I had to stand inside the bus as there was no seat available. After an hour I left the bus and took a shared taxi. Finally I walked for a while to reach home and when I entered my room, I felt that the bag is missing. I got so tensed and get back to the street and tried to remember exactly where I lost the item. But I could not remember exactly where I lost my bag.

I felt so low and depressed that I could not sleep at night. Even though I knew that it was impossible to get the stuffs back, I tried hard to have those items back. I reported to the nearby police station, contacted with the bus authority but after 7-8 days I gave up all the hopes I had to get my items back. I felt like a child who lost his most important toys! The laptop was really important to me as it has lots of valuable study materials and other files. I felt so stupid that, I was blaming myself for the whole thing and rebuked me not to be more careful. Honestly, the whole experience and the feelings were pretty depressing.

Alternative Answer:

Thank you very much for the opportunity you gave me to talk about my experience of losing something. In my preparation time for the given topic I thought about many occasions when I lost something and finally I decided to talk about the experience I had when I lost my University ID card. In fact, I had to go through a series of events because I lost this ID card and probably that's why I have remembered this event very clearly.

I lost my ID card when I was in the 4th semester in my university. I remember putting the ID card in my pocket while leaving home and to reach the University. I took a public bus and then a shared taxi on my way and I don't know exactly where I lost it but noticed it while entering the library of my University where every student is advised to show his/her ID card. That's the first time I noticed that the ID card is no longer in my possession and I searched every possible place of my dress, bag and even in the classroom. But to my dismay, I could not find it anywhere.

This ID card was pretty important to me as it was required to enter the University building, library or even in exam rooms and labs. This was the only valid form of Identification Card that I had at that time to show anyone in case I needed to. Let's say, if there is an emergency check post on the road, and the police men ask me to show my identity, that was the only piece of valid Identification proof for me. So losing it was a disaster to me at that time.

I felt pretty bad and was blaming myself for being such a careless person. I wrote an application to the University authority and they suggested me to make a General Diary to the nearest police station. I had to submit several applications and had to publish lost item news in the newspaper before I was issued another ID card after almost fifteen days. In the meanwhile I had to face lots of problems and had to submit several applications that made me remember this event pretty vividly.

Describe a song that you remember from your childhood

You should say:

What was it

When you heard it

Who sang this song to you

and explain why you still remember this song

Model Answer:

My mother often sang me a lullaby titled 'Oh my sweet angel look the Moon has come to play with you...' in my bed time and I have heard it so many times in my childhood that I can still remember it very vividly. This was a song usually famous in the rural area of our country that mothers often use to soothe the baby and to send them in sleep. It was an 8-10 lines song with great harmony and the way my mother sang it was extraordinary. It still echoes in my head and I miss those days.

I can remember my mother often sang this song till I got admitted in the school and I heard it from my father as well in my bed time. I was pretty touched with the lyrics and in my childhood I often imagined that the verses used in this song were true and would happen to me as well.

We often remember things from childhood specially the stories or songs we hear with great enthusiasm. This song was no exceptions. I heard it hundreds of times and as a child I fanaticized those things to be true. That is the main reason I still remember it. Maybe someday when I will become a father/ mother, I will sing this song to my children as well. This has in fact become a permanent memory and I still love the great and calming piece of music.

Describe something you own which is very important to you

You should say
 where you got it from
 How long you have had it
 what you use it for
 and explain why it is so important to you

Model Answer:

The desktop computer I have is very important to me. I spend almost 6-7 hours with this computer which is even higher than the time I spend with my friends!

My father bought me this computer 3 years back when I got admitted in the university. I have done some part-upgrades of it but the main parts of the computer remain same as they were when I purchased it.

I use internet with this computer and thus get lots of helps related to my study and assignments. I maintain the social networking, update my blogs, play video games, watch movies, listen to music, learn and practice the graphics designing and programming and many more things in this computer. This computer has become an inevitable part of my life and I can hardly think of a day without this computer. The

references and helps I get from internet regarding my study is unmatched. This saves a lot of time and helps me do better in the exams as well.

This computer is my main source of entertainment a source of knowledge to me. I send important emails and check incoming emails which helps me doing important communication. In short this is the most necessary thing that I own.

Describe a piece of modern technology you own

You should say:
 What it is
 What you use it for
 How long you have owned it
 And explain why it is important for you

Model Answer:

I have several pieces of modern technology and electronic gadgets that I often use and among them I would like to talk about the laptop I have. This is a laptop computer which is manufactured by HP. This laptop has a good configuration and it supports most of the latest software. It came with the Windows 8 operating system and it was bit expensive for me to buy. I bought it few months back when I replaced my old Dell laptop with this new one.

I use it for my official purposes as well as personal purposes. I use internet, communicate with my friends using this laptop. I sometimes prepare some documents, surf internet and play games in it as well. This laptop serves my entertainment also. I watch movies, listen to music and play games in it. In fact, I use this laptop more frequently than any other electronic device I have except the cell phone.

I own laptop for more than 10 years but I bought this current one 3-4 months ago. Since, the technology changes and to use latest software and to get faster performance, we need to upgrade our computers and laptops, I replaced my old laptop with this new one.

As I have already mentioned, I use this laptop to use internet, play games, create documents, contact my friends, maintain my blogs, watch movie, listen to music and for many other important purposes. This laptop has become an unavoidable technology for me that I use almost everyday.

Alternative Answer:

In fact I own several tech-devices & gadgets and among them I would like to talk about the Kindle Fire that I have. This device is produced and sold by Amazon and I ordered it from their website last year. This device is both a tabloid and a digital book reader. To me it is a very important technology device for purchasing online products, listening audio books and reading eBooks. I have noticed that after I have bought this device, the percentage of my reading has increased significantly. I use it to read eBooks and with the Wi-Fi connectivity it has become easier to find books online. The charges last for couple of days and this is a great device for reading books. As I bought it last year, I own it for more than a year and with time this has become an important electronic device that I own. This device is my best companion when I make my journey. The perfect design, nice outlook, good quality hardware and nice user interface make it an ideal device for book lovers. To me this is an important device as this fulfils my appetite for reading. With the internet connection with this device, I now have access to an immense number of books and reading materials. Before purchasing it, I used to read 1 book in a month on an average which has increased to around 3-4 books per month after I bought this device.

I love and enjoy reading and this is a really good device for digital reading. It is immensely important to read and for me this Kindle Fire is a companion I would like have always with me. In fact, sometimes I consider it to be the most important and utilitarian electronic devices I ever had.

Talk about something that you plan to do in life besides your work and study

You should say:

What do you want to do?

What should you do for your plan to come true?

Why do you want to do it?

and explain how would you feel once you have achieved it

Model Answer:

I have plans to visit different famous and historical places of the worlds besides my work and study. I would start from my home country and would visit all the major tourists' attractions and historically famous places of my country. Then I would visit the 7 wonders of different ages of the world and then other famous places of Asia, Europe, Africa and America.

This would not be an easy thing to accomplish as it would require a large amount of money and free times and in fact there are several hundred places to go and learn about. I would require to establish my own business and to make sure that I have enough time and money to have my trips. I would start my own business and work very hard to take it to the top level. That would take few years and I will need to get some helps from my father as well. I would have to be very hard working and prudent to achieve it.

I want to do it because I have an unquenchable thrust to visit the famous places and to learn about different customs and people. I want to explore the world as much as possible.

There is no end of the plan I have as our lives are limited for a certain span of time and the number of places worth visiting in the world is really enormous. But I won't plan to visit all the places but the most significant and famous places only. Once this starts and continue going (let's consider the fact that there is no end of it), I would feel very happy for every tour I would have. I would be very happy and contended to have my plan come true. That would be a truly amazing experience for me.

Talk about a friend you had as a child/ teenager

You should say

- ***When and how you first met this friend.***
- ***What you liked to do together***
- ***What you had in common.***

and explain why this friendship was important to you

Possible Answer:

Whenever I think about my childhood friends, I recall many of them who had been very close to me. One such friend I would like to talk about is Mark who was a really good friend. I met Mark when I was 6 or 7 years old. He was the kid of our neighbour and I met him first day at our garden. I was with my father in the garden and then suddenly Mark appeared there and asked me if I live here. This is how we first met and then we spent almost 5-6 years together until his father was transferred to some other state.

We did lots of things together and at that time we were neighbours, classmates and good friends. We used to go to school together, played at our home, read and

sometimes went to picnic together. We had many things in common; both of us like playing video games, reading stories, running in the field, stamp collecting, watching cartoons, animated movies, and many more other activities. Somehow I felt at that time that we have a similar taste of foods, clothing and views on different issues. At that moment this friendship was very important to me. We were like brothers and best friends. We had so many common interests and we enjoyed playing, studying and doing other stuffs together. He was the only neighbouring kid who could easily spent time with me with the consent of my parents. My parents and Marks parents were like family friends and that's why we got the chance to spent time together.

This friendship is particularly important to me because I have lots of happy memories related to my childhood and had become an unrepeatable part of it.

Tell me about a part of your city that is changing

You should say:

where is it?

how is it changing?

why is it changing?

and explain how do you feel about that?

Model Answer:

I have been living in (..say your city name...) for the last 15 years and know almost every street of this city. The city I knew the first time I came here is far more different than the city has evolved now. The north part of the city has changed more than any part of the city and still changing.

When I first visited this part of the city, it was mostly an open space that had lots of fields, trees and very minimum number of dwellers. There were hardly any high rising building and mostly farmers and fishers lived there. The fields, lakes and people's way of living used to give an impression which resembled to the urban area life. But this is no longer applicable for this part of the city. I went to that part of the city few days back after a long time and was very surprised to notice the changes which occurred there and still happening.

The need for industrialization, to accommodate the increasing population and for the business expansion the part has changed dramatically. The open spaces, fields, and lakes have reduced significantly and one can notice the overwhelming number of factories, industries and offices there. This place no longer gives the urban area impression rather it gives a neo industrial area. The numbers of roads and cars have increased, the farmers and fishers have moved to farther north side of the city and 2 new colleges and universities have been built there.

I feel the necessity of the new industries and offices and their importance for a country, but the way this part of the city has been transformed is really shocking. There could have been an alternative place for industries and the city administrators and authorities

could have saved the natural part of the city. Already the city is over populated and because of that we are facing lots of problems, the changes of this part of the city has caused to accommodate more people and has destroyed the natural habitat of wild lives. I feel sad to notice the changes happening of this part of the city.

Describe a building or construction that you have seen and impressed you

You should say:

where it was

what it looks like

when you saw it

and explain why it impressed you

Possible Answer:

The central Bank building is the one that really impressed me. I was then almost 17 years old when I first saw this building and I still remember that I became amazed watching and wondering about it.

10-15 stories building are quite common in our town but the 75 storied central bank building is really different. Not only it is higher than most other buildings but it also possesses a eye-catching architectural design which is bound to absorb any one's attention. From far it will only give you the impression of a futuristic mega structure but if you observe the building from nearby, you will see the real beauty of it.

It looks like every inch of it has been drawn before building it. This building is a fine piece of architect that prominently announces its presence. When I looked at the top of this building I got the impression that it is endless and has made its way over the sky. The long round clock in front of this building, ticks twice to let the city dwellers know its presence.

This central bank building is situated near the national museum of the city. From far away it looks like a pathway to sky and from nearby it seems like a massive yet beautifully designed architectural building.

Describe a wild animal from your country

You should say:

what the animal is

what it looks like

where it lives

and explain how you feel about this animal.

Model answer:

Tiger is a wild animal which is very common in our country. It is the largest animal of the cat species and grows up quite large. It can grow up to 11 feet in height and can weigh

more than 300 kg. Tigers generally live about 25 years and they require a large habitat area that supports their prey requirements.

Most of the tigers of the world are found in the widely are across Asia, Turkey and Russia. The most recognizable feature of a tiger is its dark vertical stripes on reddish-orange fur with a lighter underside. They have got a big head and sharp teeth claws. It is a carnival animal that mostly depends on the meat of other animals. The largest number of tigers can be found in India and the total subspecies and the numbers of tigers are decreasing over time. Tigers are good swimmers and are often found crossing rivers and lakes in heavy tides.

Tigers usually hunt alone unlike other animals that prey in group. They first target their prey and aim at it. When the target is fixed, it attacks with a sudden ferocity overpowering the prey with the strength and size. Tigers have great leaping ability and can run very fast.

This formidable large wild animal is getting extinct over time and they have become numbered in the world. Approximately only 3500 tigers are present in the world and the number is decreasing. Many tigers are held in the zoo for public and they usually live on supplied meat.

In my opinion, since human is superior to any other living species, we have a responsibility to prevent the extinction of the tiger as we are the primary reason for their extinction.

Tell about an equipment or tool that you mostly use at home

what is it
how do you use it
why it is important to you
and explain how the equipment works

Possible Answer:

There are many tools or equipments in my house and I use them for different purposes. The tool I would like to talk about today is the vacuum cleaner that I use to clean the furniture's, carpet and my house. I clean my house 1-2 times a week and mostly on day offs. Cleaning the whole house and the furniture is very time consuming and difficult. The vacuum cleaner that I use makes it easy specially cleaning the dusts on carpet.

The machine or equipment is very handy and I find it important to keep our house neat & clean. Our house is just beside the main road and that makes it more prone to dust. Before purchasing the vacuum cleaner, it was very tiresome and tough to task for us to clean the house. But this has become easier after I started using this tool.

The vacuum cleaner is electronic equipment that requires the AC current. After plugging in I turn on the power switch and use the long handle that sucks all the dust. I place the

front of the machine towards the dust and it gulps the dusts and they are then placed in a dustbin. The vacuum cleaner is an important tool for me as it does an important task of our home.

An interesting news story that you watched on TV

You should say:

what was the story

which channel showed it

what was the news story

and explain why the news story was interesting

Possible Answer:

Though I do not watch TV that much now-a-days, but I often watch the news, documentary and sometimes talk-shows. Many of them are contemporary world news, some of them are political news and some of them are news stories. One such interesting news was a story that covered a case file of police who caught a serial killer. This news story was broadcasted in Fox news and I watched it about one year ago.

The news channel represented the news like a documentary and used some actors & actress and they acted to show the real story. The news story was that the police found some connections among some random murders. They worked hard and suspected that one single person or a group of 2-3 persons were responsible for the murders. They worked for several months to find the killer but each time ended with unsolved mystery. After 5 years the file was reopened by a special team of police and they started reinvestigating the case. With their endless efforts, elaborate testing, extensive experiments and strong determination they finally started finding connections among the murders. They talked with different people of the places where the murders were committed; they went through every detail of the previous files and talked elaborately with the police officers who were engaged in the case first time. With 8 months' efforts they finally caught the murderer who by my surprise was a housewife of a happy family and the mother of 3 kids. She accepted the fact that she had committed the crime and that was revenge to the people who abused her during her career as a rising model of a suburban area.

I watched the whole news story with great interest. The news story by itself was adventurous and interesting. Moreover, the news channel represented it like a movie presentation which made it more interesting and watch-worthy.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Question:

Note that you are asked to talk about a news story not a news you watched on TV. Do not talk about the news program you usually watch daily on TV that gives different updates of local and international events or the talk show that TV channels broadcast. A news story is usually a broad story of public or historical or national or international interest and is usually lengthier than a single piece of news.

Describe a problem that affects the environment in the area where you live

You should say:

what the problem is

what causes it

what people feel about the problem

and explain what you think could be done to solve it

Sample Answer:

There are so many problem that negatively affects the environment in our area and among them the highly density of population in my opinion is the most severe one. While in many countries, less than 100 people live in one square kilometer, we have got around thousands of people living in one square kilometer. Because of this high population in a small city, lots of problems are arising.

The expenditure to support living is quite high compared to the average earning of the people, a heavy traffic has become a common scenario in the roads and as a consequence, lots of time is killed every day. The lower economic people are not getting the proper education and hospital facility, crime has increase than ever, lots of unplanned and risky constructions have been established, the environment is getting polluted and seems like no one cares.

There are many reasons that caused this outburst of this mass population in our city and among them the most influential reason is the centralization of industry in this city. Most of the factory, offices and organizations are located in this city and people from all area of the country are coming here to find a living. The unemployment in rural area is another reason why people are trying to stay here. The political reason not to take strict decisions on making equal opportunity in the country is another reason. The businesses and job opportunity attracts people to come and live here in this city.

People can feel the heat of this uncontrolled population and the problems are creating for that but they have little control over it. We all suffer from the problems and talk about it but I have not seen any big movement to solve this problem. On the other hand the political leaders who can take initiatives to lessen the problem are sometimes corrupted to take appropriate and honest steps.

There are lots of theories to solve this problem and seems like we all know about it. First of all decentralization should be done and industries and factories that can be moves to other areas should be moved. Proper education and job sectors should be ensured so that people can earn their living at their cities rather than coming here. Local government can be formed to support and improve each area of the country. Each local government should be able to invest and decide about the development projects in their area.

People naturally want to live in a better place where they can find the necessary infrastructure, daily needs and can earn a living. If that can be ensured throughout the country, this problem can be reduced.

Describe a plant grown in your country

You should say:

what the plant is

where it is grown

why you like or dislike it

and explain why it is important to your country.

Model Answer:

Paddy plant or rice plant is a very common plant which is grown in our country. The farmers of our country cultivate it and it is grown in most of the places in our country. If you go to a country-side in paddy season, you will find this plant is dancing with the wind. This plant grows well in fertile land and needs a good supply of water and sunlight. Rice is our chip food and we get rice from this paddy plant.

The paddy plant is a medium side plant which is thin and the leaves and body of this plant is green. Usually the rice seed is green in early states and becomes yellow when it is ripen. Our economy heavily depends on our rice production. Our environment, soil, water and fields are in favor of producing a large quantity of rice each year.

Since I live in a city now, I don't see these plants here but in my childhood whenever I went to visit our village, I found this plant in every fields. Mile after mile farmers have cultivated paddy plants and wish to get good quantity of rice. These paddy plants are beautiful and create a harmony with the wind if you hear closely. The dancing of this plant with the wind is something that would simply create a magical hallucination.

I also like it because this plant provides us rice which is our staple food. The taste and food value is good and it is our main crop. Every part of this plant has its usefulness. Our economy has a good dependency on the production of rice which we get from this plant. In our country this is probably the most important plant we grow.

Describe an interesting advertisement you watched on TV

You should say:

What was it

When you watched it

What was it about

And explain why it was interesting.

Model Answer:

We watch so many advertisements on TV and some of them we like and feel interesting. One such interesting advertisement was the ad of Cello Pen. This was a creative ads and I found it interesting.

The ad starts with a boy who was in a school and then studied in a college and finally in a university and in the mean time the ad shows some of the successes he achieved and was congratulated. Thus he became a successful journalist and finally won an international prove for his honest and bravery in his profession. His parents, mentors, teachers, friends and some others were highlighted at the end of the advertisement and as a flashback the Cello pen was shown. The ad revealed that the pen has contributed from the beginning to the end of his success and was never congratulated. Yet this is a silent partner of the man's success.

This ad was a commercial ad of a company who manufactures and sells the pen. Thus the ads revealed how important the pens are in our success and how this pen helps people to become who they are! I guess this was a creative ad and was made with care as it has been a good ad to watch.

Describe an annoying neighbour of your community

You should say:

Who is s/he

Why s/he is annoying

How s/he behaves with others

And explain what can be done to reduce his/ her annoying behaviour

Model Answer:

Mr. / Mrs. (...say a name i.e. David/ Feona/ Kumar/ Maroof...) is a very annoying neighbour who lives across the street of our house. S/he would be around 50 years old and has a really irritating personality that bothers us all.

I have seen him/her living there from my childhood and s/he's still living there.

S/he is a short tempered person who uses his/her mouth far more than his/her brain. Sometimes s/he yells aloud and uses very vulgar languages for very silly reasons. We thought that s/he had some short of mental instability but that was not correct. Actually his/her attitude and behaviours with others are so rude that people get confused and surprised. I have never found a person who can use so mean and vulgar language only kids went on to play near his/her house. S/he never returns the balls kids throw inside his/her fence unintentionally. S/he can scream and shout continuously and even with a 5 year's kid. Though s/he complaints always about others, s/he does lots of stuffs which s/he would not allow others to do. He/she is in my opinion a bad neighbour who never helps anyone. He watches TV and listens to radio with a very loud sound at night, screams with his family members, throws water in the street, does not keep his yard clean, and puts the garbage in unauthorized places.

I am not sure what would be actually work to pacify him/her but I guess s/he needs some friends and close family members who would accompany him/her and politely advises him/her. May be his loneliness and introvert lifestyle are two reasons for his rude behaviours and that can be done by people whom he would yield to. I have never seen him/her going out on vacations and I feel s/he needs to visit different place and change the monotonous life s/he is living.

Describe an adventurous thing you did when you were a child

You should say:

What you did

Why you did it

How people reacted about it

And explain how you feel about it now.

Sample Answer:

I had a very amazing and magical childhood and I spent most of my childhood in my hometown which was a beautiful place and offered lots of adventures and pleasures to me. There are many adventurous things I can remember from my childhood and among them I would like to talk about my first attempt to climb a big tree to find the next of a bird.

I was around 7 years old at that time and with two-three other kids one day we went to play near a big garden where we often used to go. Suddenly I notice that one two birds were chattering at the top of a tree and we assumed that the bird nest must have some eggs. We got curious about the bird's egg and I decided to climb the tree and reach the top to see it myself. The tree was really big and it was dangerous for me to climb it. I was so excited and mesmerized that I forgot the danger and started climbing the tree. I was not a good climber but I that did not restrained me from fulfilling what I targeted. After much effort, I could have been able to climb at the top of the tree and then I found that the harder part is still to do. The nest was at the edge of a very thin branch of the tree and I won't be able to reach there to see the bird's eggs. Then I started approaching there very slowly and found that my fellow playmates were already worried about it. I forgot everything of the ground and found the idea of reaching near the nest is the only motto I have to fulfil. After I managed to reach near the nest, I found four-five very beautiful small birds that had red lips and were playing with the mother birds. The mother bird started getting worried of my presence and then I decided not to interrupt them. The mother bird somehow reminded me my mother and I started climbing down.

That was a very adventurous event for me in my childhood and I did it out of inquisitiveness that a child usually feels for new thins. I felt great attraction to find out what there might be and that's why I did it.

Luckily, grown up people were not there and after few months when I told my mother about what I did that day, she became very anxious and rebuked me for that. She told me never to do anything like this ever again.

Whenever I think about that particular even of my childhood, I feel a great joy. It reminds me the greener and fairylike childhood I had. I remember this event with great joy and ecstasy.

Describe a thing that has become a fashion or a matter of status nowadays

You should say:

What is it

Why people use it

Do you have it

And explain what influences it has on people nowadays

Model Answer:

Nowadays mobile phones have become a matter of status and a fashion item that most of the people in my country use. Besides, this device has a great importance in the way we communicate with others.

People use it both for the convenience it offers and consider it as a matter of pride and prestige. With the technological advancement the utility of this device has expanded. A cell phone is no longer a device to talk to others and to send-receive SMS, rather it

comes with high resolution camera, music and video playing capability, FM radio, internet modem, Wi-Fi, games, social networking applications, video calling etc facilities. People have become very fond of this device and the teenagers consider it as a must have thing.

For official and business communications, cell phones are widely used and it is replacing the land phones rapidly. Day by day the price of the cell phones, talk time rates, internet using rates are falling down and as a consequence people with low economic earnings are also extensively using the cell phones for their communications.

I stay far away from my hometown where my family members live. To communicate them I find my cell phone very handy and the lowest expensive among the ways I have to communicate them. I also use it to contact my friends, classmates and teachers. Besides, I listen to music and use internet using my cell phone. I update my blog; maintain social networking via my cell phone. I have become heavily dependent on the cell phone I own and to some extent it is a fashion item to me as I could have easily purchase a low-budget phone instead of the expensive smart phone I have. For my communication, entertainment and educational reasons I keep it with me almost 24 hours a day and thus this cell phone has become an influential device that I like to use.

Talk about a true story that is very popular with people in your country

You should say:

What is this story about

Why is it popular

When you first heard the story

and explain how do you feel about this story

Model Answer:

There are many true stories that people in my country know and talk about often. One such story is the success story of Mr. Arther who is a living legend and is one of the top ten richest businessmen in the country. This story is about his determination, struggle, fight against adversity and finally the unmatched success he achieved.

The story starts with a 15 years old teenager who came to the capital city virtually with no capital and no one to turn to and started working as a very ignorable hawker. But the dream he had, the determination he had and the patience he showed was limitless. He had to face severe adversities and yet he never lost his faith and determination. With hard work and determination he continued his journey. He proved the fact that fortunes favours the brave. He had never in his early life stopped from fulfilling his dream and continued his journey. Over time he has been rewarded with some success and he became a moderate business owner. He did not stop there. He continued to work even harder and envisioned a better dream. Thus he started piling up the success and from a moderate businessman he became one of the enviable businessmen in the country. Now his one of the top ten richest and successful persons in the country and all his fortunes were hard earned.

This story is a popular story in our country and people often refer to this story to give example of a successful man who has fought hard to achieve it. We often mention this story to inspire people and to advise them how to be determined and hardworking to achieve their dreams.

I first heard this story in my childhood from one of my school teacher and in my college level I read an article in a magazine regarding the hard work, struggle and success Mr. Arther got.

I think this is a very inspiring story that advices us to have our dreams and to work hard to achieve those dreams. If your determination and planning is correct and if you work accordingly to achieve it, no matter how many obstacles come, you would overcome it and this is the lesson this true story teaches me.

Describe an important lesson you learned in primary school

You should say:

what is it

when you learned it

how you learned it

and explain how it became important in your future life

Model Answer:

Primary school is our first academic educational place and we start learning many new things from there. This is the place where the base of a student is made and that's why things we learn in our primary school last for a long. One important lesson that I learned from my primary school is the value of time. In every stage of our life we have to value the time we have and this lesson has helped me throughout my life.

I learned it throughout the 4-5 years I studied in the primary school. I was only 5 years old when I first got admitted in to the primary school and had been there till I became 10 years old. I have heard it from many teachers of my primary school. They told lots of stories and gave example from history and real events about the value of time. From my experiences I have also learned and understood it.

In fact our lives are nothing but a sum of time. We come here for a predefined amount of time and we have so many things to accomplish and do to make our lives meaningful. We have our duties and responsibilities and those duties and responsibilities change and expand with time. So being able to do things in their perfect time is the main mantra of life.

From my experience I have learned that, time is priceless and we can never get it back once gone. So utilizing it is the most important task in our life. Everything has its perfect time to be done and no matter what we do and how much effort we put later on, we can't change the actions we take with time. I have learned that, if I neglect the time and keep undone things that I should have done, it comes back to us like a boomerang. Accomplishing things in time and doing them with dedication is the first rule to achieve success. Whenever I have valued time and worked accordingly, I have been able to fulfill my aim and expectation. When I neglected time and kept things undone, I regretted it. From those experiences, I have started valuing time and that has brought me several successes that I desired. I still try to value my times and thus I can save myself from regretting later.

Describe your favourite song or piece of music

What kind of music it is

Where you usually listen to it

Why you like it

And say what kind of mood this music puts you in

Sample Answer:

The song 'High Hopes' sung by David Gilmour of Pink Floyd band is a song I have loved always and would hear often for the rest of my life. Pink Floyds is famous for their progressive and psychedelic music and high quality lyrics. This song falls under the progressive rock music genre and was the 11th song of the album Division Bell.

I usually listen to this song in my computer and sometimes in my MP3 player with the head phone. In fact I am a great fan of this music band and most of their songs are in my favorite list. This song is specifically attractive for the music composition, lyrics and theme.

This song reminds the past and compares how greener and full of possibility it was. The church bell and the lyrics make an out of the world illusion that only people who love it would realize. Every time I hear this song, I can feel my childhood, the sweet memory and the greener town I used to live. This is song that opens a horizon for me to visit my past. I love this song from my heart.

This music puts me in a sad yet charming mood. I feel sad that the past days won't be coming back and I won't have that childhood charm anymore. On the other hand this song gives me a genuine pleasure of the memories of my childhood and all the friends and people I knew then.

Describe a poisonous plant you know about

You should say:

what it is

where this plant is found

advantages and disadvantages of this plant

and explain how you know about it

Sample Answer:

Angels trumpet, more specifically Brugmansia, is a poisonous plant which is available in our country and I have seen this plants many times in different locations in my hometown. Brugmansia have large and fragrant flowers and this is the most probable reason they are called angel's trumpets. This plant is very closely related to the genus Datura. They are either semi-woody or shrub plants with pendulous and large flowers and they do not have any spines on their fruits.

This plant can be found in tropical areas of the world and since my country is a tropical country, this is found in my country as well. This plant has some medical values and alkaloids found in this plant are used to make medicines like anti-asthmatic, anticholinergic, spasmolytic, and anesthetic. Traditional usages of this plant include the treating of pains and aches.

This plant is highly toxic and the flower can cause disorder and hallucinations. The flower and the plants part can be very dangerous for children and we need to keep away the children from putting it in their mouth.

I mostly know about this plant from my childhood when the elder person prohibited us to go near this plants and strictly prohibited us from touching the flowers. Then I came to know that this plant is poisonous and later on I did some googling to find out the details of this plant. This is how I learned about this plant and its usages and toxicity.

Describe your favourite way to communicate someone

What it is

How you use it to communicate others

How long you own it

and explain why you prefer to use this way to communicate others

Sample Answer:

We usually communicate others in several ways and these communication ways differ based on the person we are communicating and our convenience of communication devices. For instance, we usually communicate via email with our clients and co-workers while we prefer using phone to communicate our friends.

My favourite way of communication is phone. This is mostly because, it is cheaper, easy to use, easily accessible almost all of the time and the communication over phone is effective.

I have a personal mobile phone and when someone calls me, I can see the information of the caller and receive the phone using the touch or tap in a button. After the conversation is done, I just need to put the phone in the pocket. This is as simple as that. Whenever I want to call someone, I just need to dial his/ her number and after s/he receives the call, the connection is on. Besides the calling, someone can easily send and receive texts on the phones which also serve a good way of communicating others.

I own a cell phone for more than 10 years and I find it very convenient for communication on personal and official matters.

There are many reasons I prefer this way communication. First of all, it is easy to carry and we can take it wherever we go. The calling rates are very cheap nowadays and we can refill the credit of our cell phones very easily. Calling locally and internationally both are supported and hence I prefer to have it as my primary way of communication. Phones reaches the recipient instantly unlike mail and email and this is why this is a very efficient way of communication when we need to reach someone urgently.

Describe what you like to wear on special occasions

What is it

On what occasion you wear this

Do other people wear the same dress in special occasions?
and explain why do you like to wear this dress

Sample Answer:

The type of dress I wear on special occasions mostly depends on the occasion types and the custom of dresses people usually wears in those occasions. However, for majority of the special occasions, I like to wear formal pants, shirts, suits and formal shoes.

I usually wear it to participate in any meeting, social pragmas like wedding, birthday celebration, official a program arranged by a relative. Yes, this is a common dress that many other people wear on those sorts of occasions. But some people wear different dresses as well. The teenagers who attend social programs usually wear jeans and t-shirts but the adults mostly wear this dress.

This dress code is a safe one to wear. First of all this dress matches the weather all around the year in my country. Secondly, this is a dress which is safe to wear as people won't criticize people who usually wear this dress on special occasions. This dress does not catch much attention and would give an impression that the person is rightly dressed.

Talk about an article you recently read in a magazine or in a newspaper

You should say:

when you read it

what was it about

was it a good or bad news

and explain how you felt after reading the news

Sample Answer:

I usually read a newspaper daily and I also enjoy reading some technology and lifestyle related magazines. There are lots of interesting, thought provoking and intriguing articles that I often confront and today I would like to talk about one such article that I recently read from a newspaper.

It was about the environment changes and our portion of contribution on that. This is not a new topic but the article I am taking about was written in a different perspective. It highlighted that changes that happened in the last one decades and how this changes have already impacted our environment and life. I read this article 2-3 weeks ago and this was written by a famous environmental scientist and researchers.

I am bit confused whether should I say it as a bad news or good news since this is a research and statistical fact type articles that showed the environmental changes in recent years, the impact of it in our lives and in other species, then it showed our

ignorance about the severity of this pollution and changes then finally some solution to minimize the problem. The first few parts are like bad news as it describes how much we have already damaged to the environment but the final part of the news/ article shows the light of hope and explained that we still have the opportunity to save the disaster. Some of the solutions were proposed and that I consider being good news.

I have read numerous articles about the ozone layer, extinction of some species in the recent years, then the danger of health for the pollution and many more similar topics but this one was written in a different perspective and tried to explain that small changes in our perception and habit can save a lot. This article alerted us and then showed us our unawareness of the issue and then gave the hope of making positive changes. I felt like I have adopted a different perception about this triggering issue and felt the need to read more on the topic. The news helped me understanding our immediate attention to a dire issue and how each of us can contribute to reduce the severity of this eminent problem.

Describe something which is produced in your country (e.g. a food, a handicraft, or a car)

what the product is

what it is used for

how it is made

and explain why your country produces this thing.

Model Answer:

We produce a lot of products which we consume or export in other countries and among those products sports items are very famous. In our country we produce fine quality game products like football, cricket bats, stamps and jersey. The cricket bats which are produced in our country are used in many cricket playing countries as well as by the big events of ICC.

The cricket bats are created from fine quality wood and some very professional and experienced people work on that. The woods are first collected and dried to omit the water portion from it. Then the wood is cut in a shape similar to a cricket bat structure. After the structure is given, the bat is then shaped and fine-tuned to produce a good quality bat. Some mechanical helps are needed to give the bats good shapes and to make it flawless. After that the bats are covered with grippers and other stickers.

Cricket is a popular game in our country and the materials and expertise which are required to produce those bats are available in our country. A large number of people have acquired the knowledge to produce this fine quality bats and as there is a very good demand for those bats both in our country and in other cricket playing countries, we produce those bats.

Describe a relaxing day you had once after a period of hard work or study

when you had this relaxing day
 where you spent this day
 who you spent it with and what you did
 and explain why it was relaxing

Model Answer:

It was mid-summer 3 years back when I joined my first job after the graduation and as it was a project based job I had to work really hard. There was a deadline for a client's project and the team I worked with had been desperate and determined to meet the deadline. Though I was a new member of the team, they expected me to participate with my maximum effort. I was bit worried at first and felt bit perplexed to have such type of pressure just after joining the job but later I took it as challenge and started working hard. After 3 weeks' of non-stop work and review, finally we were able to deliver the project in time and the office declared 3 days off for the team as well as a bonus. It was Friday and I remember having a very relaxing day. In fact I spent the whole three days with much more relaxation than usual days.

I left my bed at around 10:00 am and spent the day mostly at home. In the evening I went to meet a friend and went to watch a movie in the theatre. At night we had dinner together with 2 others friends and I returned home at around 11:30 pm.

It was a relaxing day mostly because I felt it as a reward after a really hard work and effort. I had such many days but that day was exceptional because I mentally felt it as a really relaxing day. Naturally I was feeling good to be able to finish such a tough project and I had three days' off and that's why did not fell to go to office next day. The situation, the routine free life, the contempt and the leisure activities after a long made the day a really enjoyable and relaxing day.

Describe a naughty thing you did when you were a child

how old you were then
 What you did
 Why you did it
 and explain how do you feel about it now

Sample Answer:

Childhood is magical and we remember our childhood with great joy. Even the stupid things we have done in our childhood seems very exciting to us in our later life. The naughty things that I did in my childhood are many and I will mention a particular thing that I did when I was only 7 years old. I was in grade two at that time and one day on my way to the school I found that some of my classmates have gathered near a pond

and they have planned to catch the fishes from that pond. I forgot about my school and put the school bag in a nearby tree. I was very excited about the whole idea of catching fish and then cooking it for the dinner.

I stayed for around 3-4 hours to catch the fish with my bare hand and with some small nets my classmates had with them. After 2-3 hours I was tired and was convinced that it was an easy job to do. I found that my classmates had become less interested by the time and they are planning to go home.

By the time I realized that I have done a great mistake by skipping the school and I have made my dresses dirty in the pond. I was afraid that my mother would be very angry if she finds out what I really did over here. Then I talked with my classmates and found that they got anxious as well. We were 3-4 in number and only one of us had been able to catch 2 small fishes. We then made a decision to steal some fishes from the other people who had already caught a good number of fishes and put them in their jars.

We had been successful to steal some fishes from others and when I returned home, I had 3-4 fishes in my bag. I was lucky to get over with the things I had done and I still find it very funny and naughty thing to do in my childhood. I have done many other naughty things later part of my life but this was the one that still gives me real pleasure to think about.

Describe a feature of your personal character that you find important

What is it

Is it a common characteristics

How it is helpful to you

and explain why it is important to you

Sample Answer:

Thank you very much for the topic. It's kind of tough to talk about someone's own personal characteristics as I believe, the way we judge ourselves differs from the perspective other people judge us. Nonetheless, we all have our own idea about our own characteristics and I would like to talk about my ability to stay calm even in the time of distress.

I am not hot tempered and I try to remain calm no matter how severe the situation and I find it as a helpful characteristics. From my own experience I can say that, whenever

got very much vibrated and acted very promptly without giving much consideration about the situation, I did not take the right decision and I repentance for that.

In my opinion that should be a common characteristics among other people but my personal experiences sometimes contradicts my opinion as I often find people who can't remain calm in adverse situation and act very weirdly. So to say, this is not a rare quality but many people lack it.

Remaining calm and using brain rather than the tongue is a helpful characteristic as it would help you taking the right decision and would show you the right way and course of actions. Being very fragile in action and taking prompt decision without thinking can sometimes lead us to misunderstanding and can ruin relationship. Not being able to remain calm also shows your weakness and that often allure you to take a completely wrong decision.

To me this is a very important characteristic. This quality has saved me from making many mistakes and saved me from lamenting later on. Being able to remain calm in an adverse situation helps me taking the right decision and that's something which I find very helpful in my personal and professional life.

Describe a leader or politician who you admire

Who is s/ he?

What is so appealing in him?

What type of leader is he/ she

and explain why do you admire him /her

Model Answer:

The leader I really like and admire is (...say a name of politician or a leader you know about...) who had great contributions to make our country a better place. He was a mainstream politician for a long and was involved in active politics from his school life. He had great contribution in our freedom fight as well as in several other activities for the betterment of our nation. He lived from 1940 till 2000 and his death was a great lose for the nation.

He was an honest and brave politician which has become rare in present days. He never compromised with the evil power of the politics and foreign powers. He had risked his life several times and with his bravery he had bought some advantageous changes in the country. He was an idol for the nations and for his honesty and bravery he is a well-known figure in the world.

He was an active member of the (...say a political party name...) and never longed for power or fame. He could have easily gain a powerful position in the country but he had always led a simple and yet exemplary life.

I admire him for his unmatched contribution for the country and for the nation. We need many more leaders like him and I regret the fact that we have only very few leaders like him in our country. He was an ideal leader who has put his personal benefits away while he thought for the benefits of the country and the nation.

Alternative Answer:

As a nation we are proud to have many legendary and visionary leaders who had shaped our fortune and devoted their lives and time to build the country. Among those impressive leaders and politicians I would pick (...say a famous leader's name...) as my most favourite leader whom I really admire and respect. He is such a popular and beloved leader that I have found that most of the people like and admire him. He possesses a very high political position with really immense power and yet he has chosen to lead such an ordinary and poor life that it is possible only by a dedicated, honest, good hearted and completely honest leader. While he could have made a great fortune and could have exercised his power like many other politicians and leaders, he has chosen the honesty, integrity, responsibility and truth as his virtues.

The most appealing part about him is his honesty and fierceness for the truth and just. He does not fear any one as long as it is to establish the just and right. Because of his invaluable contribution and dedication many positive changes have been made in our country. I, like many others, like him because of his honesty, truthfulness, and fight for justice, dedication, patriotism, and benevolent attitude to the poor people. He is a rare politician in this era of corruption and selfishness. The world needs more leaders like him to make it a better place.

I am sure with his contribution our nation will progress further. The vision and leadership quality of this politician would inspire the young party members to contribute towards the betterment of the nation.

Talk about one of your long-time friend

when you first met your friend

what is s/he like

how the two of you keep in touch with each other.

and explain why this friendship is important to you

Model Answer:

I have many friends and among them there are some friends whom I know for a long time. One such friend is (...say a name of your friend...) and he has many distinctive characteristics. I know him from my childhood and still I value his friendship.

He comes from a middle-class family and he has a natural talent of learning everything very quickly. I met him for the first time in my school when he sat near me. He had some distinctive characteristics and that's why I started observing closely and later we became friends. Though he was very talented, but he did not have the tendency to hold on to something for a long. He was the most talented boy in our class but because of some whimsical decisions and because of his priority to his own wishes, he does not have a bright and prosperous career. He was a very good chess player, an excellent all-rounder in cricket, a good defender in football, a tactical badminton player and the quickest math solver in our class. Everybody thought he would become either a math professor or an engineer and sometimes people thought that he would become a good athlete, but he finally did his graduation in History as he thought that this would allow

him to learn a lot. After he finished his graduation he learned some programming and designing and started his career in Information Technology. He worked for 3 years in this sector and then all of a sudden decided to leave this day job and work as a freelancer. As far as I know he's been a good programmer and designer and in his freelancing career, he is doing well.

He often travels to different places and lead a life bit away from the society. He has not married yet and I guess he has no intention to do so. He is talented and sometimes whimsical.

He is a close friend of mine and though we do not spend much time together, we have a good bonding and we value our friendship. I know how much talented and creative he is. I like his morality, talent, truthfulness, boldness, bravery and his unquenchable thrust for knowledge and freedom.

Describe an important festival in your country

what is it

what is the significance of it

what do you do / how do you celebrate

and describe the festival in details.

Model answer:

Bengali New year day, which is the First day of the Bengali calendar, is a very important festival in our country. This is usually occurs on 14th or 15th April and celebrated among the Bengali people, minor Bengali communities and in some states of the India. The famous Mughal Emperor Jalaludding Muhammad Akbar introduced the Bengali Calendar most probably because of easier tax collection of that time.

This is possibly the most widely celebrated festival in our country. People from all social-economic states, from all ages and all religions celebrate with great joy, festivity and happiness. The rally, the song, the traditional dresses, the traditional foods, the boat racing, cock-fight, pigeon racing and many more activities are very common in this festival.

The people celebrate this festival whole day starting from the early morning. Men, women, kinds all were the traditional dresses, draws some temporary arts and tattoos, goes to the central University place and enjoys the festival greatly.

The whole capital city as well as other places of the country warmly welcome the New Year and as a long tradition cook delicious dishes. This is a festival which is rooted in our history. Usually people get their harvest at that time and makes different delicious foods. After the emperor Akbar introduced this Bengali New Year, we are celebrating with great enthusiasm and in a distinctive way.

No other festival depicts the true traditions and cultures as does the Pohela Boishak.

Tips for answering this Cue Card topic:

An important festival of a country can be a major religious festival, music festival, seasonal festival, traditional and cultural festival etc. which is celebrated in the whole part of the country. For this cue card you can talk about any festival which is celebrated in your country nationwide. Do not talk about a festival which is only celebrated at a particular region of your country or among a tribal nation which is not widely celebrated in the whole country.

For the first question say the festival name (i.e. New Year eve, Christmas, Eid day, Independence Day etc.). If the festival is not widely known and might be unknown to the examiner, say a little background of the festival. Mention if this is a national festival, celebration, cultural or historical celebration or a religious festival and then say the significance of this celebration in your country. To mention the significance of the festival, give the historical/ religious/ cultural origin of the festival and also mention how this is an integral part of the people in your country.

For the final two parts of the questions, you need to give details of the festival and talk about how you celebrate this festival. Mention following points to give details about the festival and your activity:

1. Duration of the festival.
2. How widely it is celebrated.
3. Preparation for the festival.
4. What the custom and rules are for the celebration
5. What people cook and wear on the occasion.
6. What the norms are of this celebration.
7. What you like to do in this celebration.
8. What the tradition is.
9. How you feel about his celebration.
10. How important this celebration is to your countrymen.

Describe something healthy you enjoy doing

What you do

Where you do it

Who you do it with

and explain why you think doing this is healthy.

Possible Answer:

I wake up early in the morning and then walk for an hour every day. After that I swim in the nearby river for about 30 minutes and then I start my day. Waking up very early and then doing the physical exercise is the healthy habit I have developed from the early stage of my life. I remember my father insisting us to wake up very early and then took us to the nearby high school ground for exercise. Nowadays, I wake up from bed at around 5:30 am and wear my exercise trousers and the pair of shoes. Then I start walking along with the road that has passed beside the river. The fresh air in the

morning is very healthy for health. Sometimes I take my bicycle and instead of walking, I ride my cycle. I started doing this early morning exercise and swimming few years back but nowadays 2 of my friends and cousins accompany me almost every day. They enjoy doing the exercise very much. The morning is a time when the air and environment remain fresher than anytime of the day. So breathing the fresh air, doing the exercises and finally swimming in the fresh water is definitely a very healthy habit. A sound mind lies on a sound body and this habit that I adopted is pretty helpful for keeping a sound health and sound mind.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Topic:

Exercise, visiting open and natural places, good food habit etc. are some of the habits which are related to the health. Exercise can vary from going for walking in the morning & evening, running, swimming, cycling, playing outdoor games, and going to gymnasium, doing yoga etc. You can talk about any exercise habit that you have for this cue card as exercise is healthy habit.

Again you can talk about your passion on visiting different places on your vacation as travelling to open spaces gives you mental refreshment as well as help keeping good health.

Finally a good food habit is something positive we can have to maintain a good health. You can talk about your habit of eating vegetable over fishes and meats. Your habit of drinking fruit juice daily is also something health you do. Gardening is a good habit which involved both the passion and physical exercise and can be described as a healthy habit.

Pick an idea related to exercise, good food habit or travelling and talk about that particular topic.

On the other hand, reading books, cooking, listening to music etc. are good for our mental health and thus keeps us joyful which is a healthy habit. If you want to talk about your habit of listening music, painting, cooking or reading, first mention the mental benefits it offers. Then relate the mental health with the physical health and then continue describing the habit.

The second question: "why you do it" and the fourth question "and explain why you think doing this is healthy" are actually similar. For the later one describe the benefits it offer and for the second question mention that you have a passion on doing it, you spend a quality time this way and you really enjoy doing it. Since the cue card asks you to describe something healthy you enjoy doing, do not only mention the health benefit it offers. You should also talk about why you enjoy it, how passionate you feel about doing it and your involvement on the task.

Describe a game or sport you enjoy playing

What kind of game or sports it is

Who you play it with
Where you play it
and explain why you enjoy playing it

Possible Answer:

I've played several games, both indoor and outdoor games, and still try to play whenever I get time. Among those games, I enjoyed playing chess more than others. Chess is an indoor game where two players participate. This game does not involve any major physical movements like other outdoor games but a chess player has to use his/her brain and make game plans to defeat the opponent.

I mostly play this game with my friends and cousins. Sometimes I play it with my father and senior relatives. Since playing chess requires only placing the board on a surface and sitting position of the two participating players, it is convenient to play chess almost anywhere. I mostly play it at our veranda, garden or bed room. I enjoy this game because I have a fascination about this game from my childhood and I really like the overall theme and barnstorming involved in this game. It's a thought provoking game that gives the participating players to use their brains. A player can apply his/her strategy, and then allure the opponent to fall in trap which is much like a real battle field.

It's not a game where someone would only use the physical movements rather the game requires perfect game plan, finding weakness of the opponent and a battle strategy. This game gives you a feel of being the King of a regime where you decide your country men's fate. For all those reasons this is a very interesting and enjoyable game to me.

Tips for answering this Cue Card Topic:

Since the cue card is about your favourite game or sports, you can talk about any indoor or outdoor game or sport you play or know about. Alternatively you can talk about the computer games as well. If this is an indoor game you want to talk about pick chess, card, table tennis, bowling, karom, computer game, gaming device game or any other game you prefer. For the indoor games you can mention that you regularly play it with your family members or friends and enjoy it a lot. Generally physical exercise is not involved in indoor games except table tennis and you should focus on the mental improvement and enjoyment the indoor games offer. Indoor games are usually played inside homes and you should mention that you play it in your house, veranda, drawing room or in guest room. You should also mention that you play it in your relatives' houses or friends' houses as well.

If you pick an outdoor games like cricket, football, badminton, rugby you should mention that you play it with your friends and some of the neighbours. Sometimes unknown people join in such games where more than 7-8 players are needed. Mention that these games are refreshing and a good way of keeping your health fit.

For the question why do you enjoy playing this game, you should mention that you have a great passion about this game or sport and you have been playing it for a long time.

You can also mention that you are usually good at it and your percentage of winning the game is very good. If you talk about indoor game, mention the excitement and brainstorming it offers and the way you enjoy playing it with your family members and friends. For the outdoor games mention the health benefits it offer and the way you enjoy playing it.

The follow-up question of this cue card might ask you the most common types of games and sports played in your country so you should prepare for that as well.

Describe an important decision/choice that you made in your life

What the decision was?

When you took the decision?

What the results of the decision? Whether it was a good choice?

And explain why it was important?

Possible Answer:

I've made lots of decisions in my life and frankly I have taken those decisions sometimes all alone and sometimes discussing with my parents and others. The particular decision that seems very important to me was the time when I decided to major in Literature rather than major in Engineering. My mother wanted me to get admitted in the Eng. University and do my graduation majoring Engineering while my fascination was studying in Literature. I made this decision when I was 18 years of old, just after finishing my 12th grade. My father did not force me to do anything; instead he told me to do what I thought was best for me. My relatives thought that I was a fool and too immature to make a big decision for myself.

But after considering several issues and perspective I decided to get myself admitted in a University that offers graduation in Literature. I'm happy that I made this decision. I'm yet to finish my graduation but throughout the last 3 years I have enjoyed studying literature and I am doing quite well academically.

Making the decision/ choice was not easy and I had to go through a hard time as I remember. I had to fight a lot with my inner self and then convince my mother. There were always risks of picking the option I prefer my parents would have complained if I hadn't make a promising result. I still remember the dubious feelings I had that time. Sometimes it seemed to me that I should abandon my passion and yield to my parents' decision and then again I strongly felt for my own choice and passion. Since I made my own choice at that time, a strong urge and force worked on me that I have to do really good and I am happy that I took my decision and doing very good so far.

Tips for answering this cue card topic:

Remember a decision that you took which turned out to be an influential thing you decided. You should be able to talk about something you decided and later proved to be

useful and beneficial. This varies from person to person yet following are some of the ideas you can adopt to talk about yours one:

Your decision to get admitted into a college, university or studying in a particular major/ subject.

Your decision of living in a foreign country.

Your decision of taking a course or learning a thing.

Your decision of taking a part-time/ full time job.

Your decision of making a change in your family like: living in a town rather than in the village.

Your decision of obeying your parents on certain issues.

Your decision of not getting involved in a political party/ organization that eventually turned out to be harmful for others.

Your decision of helping a person/ people of your locality.

Your decision of informing a bad thing happening in your locality to the appropriate authority.

Your decision of protesting a decision taken by your relatives.

Your choice of imposing something to your family members or friends which later turned out positive for him/her.

Your decision of buying something that later become helpful for you and others.

Try to talk about something positive you decided. You are free to describe one of your decisions which become harmful for you later but it is advisable not to talk about such negative things.

Describe an idea you have for improving something at work or college

What is it about

Where you got this idea

How difficult it would be to implement

and explain why you think this would improve the work place or college

Model Answer:

Since I am student and have never worked for a company, my idea is related to the college where I study. Engaging two teaching assistants for each class is an idea that would very positively improve the study environment and facility in our college/ university. It is a large college with more than seven thousand students. Each class has

more than 40 students and not all of them are equally talented and focused to the lessons. So if the college authority arranges to enroll two promising and talented students who have the capability to manage the classes and assist the teachers to explain lessons to other students, would be a great aid for all the students who often struggle to understand the lessons but do not ask questions to the teachers. In fact that would be a great initiative by the college administration to help all the students with their lessons. I got the idea from a website of a renowned university that explained how they enroll teaching assistants and this process helps all the students of a class.

I do not think it would be very difficult to implement. The college authority needs to discuss this whole idea and then finally decide the process. That might require some administrative and decision level meeting. The extra budget that would be required would not be a big hassle for the college to support. So in my opinion I do not see any major obstacles to implement this idea.

From my experience I can say that only one-third of the whole students in a class can catch and fully understand the lectures delivered by the teachers. The remaining two-third students of a class neither understand the lessons nor ask questions to the teachers to explain things again. Many students do not ask the questions they have directly to the teachers and thus always remain as the back-benchers. If they get teaching assistants from their classmates, they would surely raise their questions to those TA and would be greatly benefitted. The overall study quality would improve and the results of the college would also improve dramatically.

Describe a competition / contest you have entered

When the competition took place

What you had to do

Describe the competition

and explain how you felt about the competition

Model Answer 1:

Ooh, it's quite hard for me to think about an example of a competition I've entered as generally speaking I am not a very competitive individual! However, I can think of one competition that I entered, which I think you will find funny. I'm going to tell you what I had to do, what the competition was for including the prize, and what happened after I entered.

Many years ago I used to live in a town called Leamington Spa. One of the few independent shops in the town was a large old-fashioned department store which sold quite traditional items like haberdashery products for sewing and knitting and gentlemen's gloves and handkerchiefs. Over time, they decided they needed to extend their product range to attract new customers, so they held a competition in a weekly local newspaper. The competition was very easy to enter, you simply had to complete your name and address on the coupon and post it in to the newspaper offices of the

Leamington Courier. The prize was to be a specially fitted lingerie set, as a way of launching their new selection of ladies underwear!

I never win competitions, or I thought I never did. So I was amazed when a couple of weeks after posting my entry I received a letter telling me that I was one of three lucky winners! I was instructed to come to the store for a fitting and informed that 'a photographer from the local paper would be on hand to photograph the winners afterwards!' It was very funny, the letter was badly written, and it made it sound as if we would be expected to pose in our winning underwear and agree to be pictured in the local news!

I duly went along to the store, where the comedy continued. Although the brassiere range was supposed to be suitable for women of all shapes and sized, in fact none of the three of us who had won could be correctly fitted into the bras available. Embarrassed, the manager of the store offered us alternative products, and the photographer from the paper said he still wanted a shot of all the winners with an appropriate background. After some discussion, he got us to peer into a brochure, as if choosing a glamorous underwear set, whilst behind us were rails and rails of lingerie. The lingerie department wasn't very big, and nor was it well lit. Our photographer was unfortunately rather generously proportioned and he struggled to move his ample frae between the rails of clothes to get the right camera angle. Eventually he stepped backwards without looking properly, and as he did so knocked over some rails of bras and knickers and ended up in a tangled heap of coat hangers, fallen rails and covered in a selection of compromising underwear. I hadn't laughed so much in years!

So how do I feel about the competition? Well, I was amazed to win something, and I did end up with quite a nice new set of underwear for very little effort, but most importantly of all I had a really hilarious day collecting my prize and I hope you will agree I got a good anecdote out of it too!

[Written by - Lucy Marris | Careers Adviser (UK), TEFL teacher (Vietnam)]

Model Answer 2:

I have attended many competitions in different phases of my life and have won some prizes from those competitions as well. One such contest that I would like to talk about was the Cycling competition that I participated in my college.

I was then a student of college and around 15 years old. One day I noticed an advertisement in our local newspaper that an inter-college cycling competition would held on next week. The entry fee would be \$20 and the prizes would be given to the first three cyclers. I had a passion on cycling and I that's why I thought to participate it.

On the day of the contest I went to the starting point and registered my name in the competition. I took my bicycle and wore my cycling dresses. I noticed there were around 30 competitors and I was asked to stand at my start point. With the sound of the whistle I start cycling. I had very less intension of winning prized but I simply did concentrate on

cycling. The total distance was around 5 miles and that required some energy and time. After I finished the racing, I was really surprised to hear that I won the third prize. I found that some of my classmates were shouting because I was one of the three prize winners.

I felt really happy and proud that I did well in this competition. Actually I never took my cycling habit seriously and after I did well in that competition, I started participating in other cycling competitions as well.

Describe a friend from your childhood

How did you first meet?

How long have you been friends?

What did you two do together?

What made you like him/ her?

and explain your friendship

Possible Answer:

Childhood has its specialty and magic and sometimes childhood friends are unforgettable. One such friend I recall was Masud who I still remember. Our friendship lasted only for a year and after that he moved to a different city with his parents. I met him at our first day in school. I was late for school due to a bad traffic and when I reached my classroom, I thought that all of the seats have been occupied and I was desperately looking for a place to sit. The class teacher asked my name and announced to make a seat for me. I found that one of the boys was asking me to go over there and sit beside him. This very boy was Masud and I was grateful to him.

In the Tiffin time I shared my foods with him and talked about lots of things. From that next day we started sitting next to each other and our friendship began to flourish. I found that he collects stamps as a hobby and I was excited to find this common hobby between us. We were very close friends and after one year I heard that he would be moving to a new city as his father has been transferred there. I did not know his postal address and as a consequence I could not communicate him. We did not meet each other after that but he was such a good and close friend that I still miss him sometimes.

We did a lot of interesting and fun stuffs together. At school we played footballs and other games in the interval period. We made kites and flew them together, we went to many places to buy stamps, we went to library to read book, we went to river to swim, we climbed in trees, we played crickets, we walked in the streets and told stories to each other and did many other things together.

He was a lively and helpful boy who liked me very much. We had many things in common and we helped each other on our studies. Since I enjoyed doing stuffs with him, I liked him as a friend as well. We had a strong bonding and intimate friendship between us. We tried to help each other whenever needed.

Tips for answering this cue card question:

This topic is very similar to the cue card "Describe a friend who you really like to spend time with" except that you should talk about a friend from your childhood.

There is a good possibility that you no longer meet him/her very often but as a childhood friend, you keep in touch.

This topic is very similar to the cue card "Describe a friend who you really like to spend time with", except that you should talk about a friend from your childhood. There is a good possibility that you no longer meet him/her very often but as a childhood friend, you keep in touch.

Following are some points you can mention to answer this cue card topic:

1. You had lots of fun stuffs together in childhood and you enjoyed his/ her company.
2. You went to school together, you played together and you spend lots of time together.
3. You meet him/her whenever you visit your hometown and you still enjoy his friendship.
4. You two have strong bonding as your friendship has matured over time.
5. You two had lots of common interest and you learned many things from him/her.
6. Describe what you did together in the childhood, how you spent time then and how you two started living in two different places.
7. Not necessarily you two have to live in two different places; you can mention that you two are still close and meet very frequently.
8. Say 1-2 interesting memories you two had together.
9. Talk about some reasons you liked him.

Describe an open-air or street market which you enjoyed visiting.

You should say: where the market is

what the market sells

how big the market is

and explain why you enjoyed visiting this market.

There's one particular street market I remember visiting a few years ago. I was traveling with some friends in Mexico and we stopped off in a town called Cuernavaca. We went to explore the center of the town one morning and it was literally mobbed with people, I think it was a Tuesday morning if I remember correctly. Anyway we asked one of the locals what was going on and they explained that it was 'market day' which apparently is a big event for them. We strolled down the street to see what all the fuss was about. When we arrived at the market it was really impressive, it spanned about 5 blocks and

there seemed to be all kinds of different things you could buy. We saw clothes, food, shoes, jewelry and many local crafts for sale as well. I think we must have spent a couple of hours there just exploring all the market stalls and some of us bought some souvenirs for friends back home. It was a great experience because there were people from all over the region who had come to set up their stalls and sell their goods there. After we had finished looking at everything we stopped at one of the food stalls to have some lunch, some spicy tacos and a nice refreshing beer, it was excellent. I think it's one of the biggest markets I've ever been to, and it was certainly one of the most colorful. They even had buskers there performing all day. As I said, we spent at least a couple of hours looking at all the offerings, but apparently it goes on well into the night as well. They run it for 2 days back to back once a month. I began to realize why it was such a big event for the locals, it was really amazing and I've certainly never seen a market like it since then. Market day is a big tradition for the town and the locals always look forward to it each month. Apparently it used to be quite a small affair when it first started hundreds of years ago, but it's grown and grown, and when we were there it was almost like a supermarket, but out on the street.

Alternative answer

I want to talk about the farmers' market in my neighborhood, which is a type of open-air market my wife and I really enjoy going to.

I live in a small town near the San Francisco Bay Area and they have a farmers' market in its small downtown every Saturday in the summertime. This open-air market is actually quite small, about only 3 blocks long, but you can find all sorts of products. Here you can find locally grown fresh fruits and vegetables as well as handmade accessories and jewelry. There are also some stands selling different kinds of snacks, such as caramel apple, kettle corn, and cotton candy.

My wife and I really enjoy going to this farmers' market because the atmosphere is quite relaxing. All the vendors are locals and they treat everyone nicely. I also feel they are honest people and would never try to trick you when selling you something. In fact, we have bought oranges, apples, and different kinds of vegetables, and everything was indeed quite fresh.

All in all, although very small, this farmers' market is a wonderful place for local residents to hang out and buy some fresh produce.

Describe an unusual or interesting thing you did recently

Where did you do it?

When did you do it?

Who did you do it with?

and describe why it was unusual or interesting?

Model Answer:

Few months back while our visit to a friend's hometown, all of a sudden the friend proposed us to go inside a nearby forest and have a picnic there. This was a plan proposed by Arnold (...say one of your friend's name...) and 4 of our friends agreed to do so.

This was bit dangerous as people scarcely go inside the forest and from the local people we have heard different scary and wild stories about this jungle. Our main attraction was the abandoned house inside the jungle and we planned to do the picnic there and take photos of wild lives and the abandoned house. We knew that my friend's guardians won't permit us to do that and hence we planned not to let them know about it upfront.

On a Thursday morning we left the friend's house and bought the necessary ingredients, vegetables, foods and other things that would be required for us to do the picnic. We entered inside the jungle and to our surprise the inside was much more open and beautiful than we thought it would be. With some difficulty we reached near the abandoned house and spent time till the afternoon. This was a very exciting and unusual experience for us. We collected some woods and made an arrangement for cooking. We eat the food we cooked and that was horrible in taste. However, we were looking for the adventure and interesting stuffs so a bad food did not kill our spirit. We could not enter inside the abandoned house as it was blocked and very fragile. We took several photos of the place and we notices some of the wild animals were observing us with suspicion.

I have to confess that was a bit dangerous and imprudent thing to do but we enjoyed our interesting and unusual picnic inside a forest.

Tips for talking about this cue card topic:

For this cue card you can talk about anything you recently did which is usually uncommon for you or was interesting in your opinion. Some such activities can be:

Fishing.

Mountain Hiking.

Taking part in a rally.

Walking in the street at midnight.

Reading a ghost story.

Visiting a friend from school.

Eating street and junk foods.

Watching movies with friends. Or absolutely anything that you enjoyed.

After you decide what you are going to talk about, take notes of the following points like the following style:

What I did?: Took part in a social welfare rally.

Where?: In my home town. The rally started from the City town and ended at the 10th Avenue. It was 2 hours long.

When?: I was 24 years old and it would be probably 1 and half year ago.

With whom?: My friend Michael was with me. Later I found John in the rally and he then joined our line.

How was it? : A completely new experience for me; I was feeling really good; That was for a great cause and I felt proud. This was bit unusual and I enjoyed doing it.

Describe a person who has done a lot of work to help people.

who this person is/was

where this person lives/lived

what he/she has done to help people

and explain how you know about this person.

Okay, I'd like to tell you about a person I learned about when I watched a documentary on YouTube. It was about Bob Geldof and the Live Aid concert which helped many people starving to death in Ethiopia. I'll tell you what I can remember about him and the event.

He was a pop singer in a band in the 1980s in the UK and one night he saw a report on the TV about a dreadful famine in Ethiopia and he was very moved by the pictures and the report of hundreds of thousands of people starving and homeless all camped out on a plain in Ethiopia.

He decided to organize a song for charity with some of the big pop stars of that time; I think some of them were his friends, in order to raise money to send food over there. They wrote and produced a song with many different popular artists all singing together which helped raise awareness and a lot of money for charity.

Following the success of that event, he visited Ethiopia personally and saw what was happening there. He discovered there were many other problems, such as transport, which meant that although food aid had arrived in the country it couldn't be transported to where the people needed it most.

When he returned to his own country he talked to lots of people and the prime minister about the problem and asked why nothing was being done. I think he felt frustrated by the lack of involvement from some officials and charities to solve the problems.

He came up with the idea to have a live music concert which was called Live Aid to raise more money to help the people suffering from the famine. It was the largest concert ever done anywhere in the world at that time. There was a live concert in England, in the UK, and another one in Philadelphia, in the USA. The two events were linked by satellite and televised all around the world.

The biggest and most popular artists took part in the event and it was a huge success. The money which was raised helped to alleviate some of the problems that the people in Ethiopia were suffering from and changed the way in which a lot of charities worked to solve problems worldwide.

I think it was the first time that one individual had done something really different from the normal methods of fundraising for natural disasters which happen around the world.

[Source: online and ielts-mentor.com]

PART 3

IELTS Speaking Samples: *Values*

Let's consider values and the way they change.

What kinds of possessions give status to people in your country?

That's a good question. Let me think...I'd say it depends on where you are and who you are with. If you are out in public, it's things like the car you are driving. If you have the latest Mercedes Benz model, then in my country that is a sign of status, as most people can't even afford a car at all, whatever the make. Property, or the house you own, and the possessions you have in it are also a sign of status. If you have a nice house in a nice area, then this shows you have money and are someone important.

Has it always been the same or were different possessions thought of as valuable in the past?

I'm too young to remember exactly what it was like a long time ago, but yes, I think it was different. For example, cars as I mentioned before only really came to our country in the last ten years or so. That kind of consumerism is a fairly recent thing so this couldn't have been used as a representation of something valuable. I think it was things like gold and jewelry that were seen as valuable. Of course these are still seen as valuable today, but previously it was these things over anything else as a lot of the modern day possessions were not available.

Why do you think people need to show their status in society?

I believe that this is because it's important in society to show you have money or are successful – it is nature, or the way we are brought up, that makes us feel like this, but also the pressure that society puts on everyone to be successful. And showing status is

basically showing that you have money and you have success, so this is what people want to do. Going back to the example of the car, driving around in a Mercedes is a very conspicuous show of status – it basically says to people, “Look, I am successful and I have money.” Another reason is possibly for respect. In many cultures, if someone has high status, then they will be respected by others and they may receive preferential treatment.

IELTS Speaking Samples: *Advertising*

Now we'll discuss the role of advertising.

Do you think advertising influences what people buy?

Yes, definitely. If there were no advertising and you went to a shop, then you would just buy what you wanted based on maybe what others have told you, what the product looks like, or, depending on the product, what it says on the label. Advertising builds up a brand and people then trust a certain thing because they have seen it on television or elsewhere. Also, there is so much advertising around it must influence us. You can't escape it as it is fed to us constantly in our daily lives – not only in magazines, radio and television, but on billboards, on TVs installed on trains and platforms, even in schools and universities. So yes, advertising influences what we buy.

Do advertisements give correct information, or do they encourage people to buy things that they may not need?

I think some do and some don't, but it's difficult to know which are giving us the correct information. For example, the skin whitening products – I do not believe that these work but we see them everywhere in Asian countries, and we are encouraged to buy them even though they are not actually necessary. The adverts, though, tell us they are necessary as they will improve our lives and we will become more accepted and successful. This then, is an example of advertising encouraging people to buy something they do not need. I do think there are checks in most countries these days to make sure that adverts are giving the correct information and not lying to people, but I think it is still easy for advertisers to exaggerate or to do this without breaking the regulations.

Is advertising really necessary in modern society?

It could be seen to be necessary in terms of the fact that, as I mentioned before, there is so much choice that we need someone to guide us in what to buy or to give us some extra information about products. Without this, it would be difficult to know where to start. However, that said, I'm not sure that I would regard it as 'necessary' as overall I think it may do more harm than good. As we just discussed, advertising encourages

people to buy things they possibly do not need. We live in a consumer society and many people are in debt because we are encouraged to buy and buy, and I'm sure advertising plays a major role in this. Without advertising we could just do our own research and decide what we really need. So no, I would not say that advertising is necessary in modern society.

IELTS Speaking Samples: *The Internet*

Now we'll move on to the influence of the internet.

Do you think people take notice of advertisements on the internet?

Despite the fact that there are many adverts on the internet these days, I think actually many people tend to ignore them, or at least that is my experience. People usually go onto the internet to find something specific that they are looking for, which may be a product, or to read about something, so they will ignore what is not relevant to that. But of course there is no doubt that some people take notice of them. Advertising on the internet is a practice most companies partake in now, and they have to pay quite substantial sums to advertise on highly ranked sites. Of course they would not do this if it were not attracting customers for them.

How do you think it will change people's buying habits in the future?

Buying from the internet is becoming more and more popular. For example, we've seen many book shops close down because people can buy online at cheaper prices from sites such as Amazon. It makes life much easier if products can be delivered direct to our door, especially with our busy modern lifestyles. I think this will only increase in the future as more people feel safe to buy online and online shops make it easier to purchase this way. Also, I think our lives are only going to become busier, so more people will choose to shop this way.

Are there any disadvantages to shopping on the internet?

There certainly are some. Firstly, buying clothes can be a problem. When you go into a shop you can check what you are buying fits you and suits you, but it is obviously not possible to do this online. Shopping does not become less hassle if you have to send something back in the post. Another problem is the security. We have to give out our bank details to people we don't know. There have been several recent reports in the press about sites that have had their security breached and credit card details have been stolen. So far this is fairly uncommon, but it is a risk none the same. Another disadvantage is to society as it could destroy local shops and businesses if people are not going out to shop in their local town.

IELTS Speaking Samples: *Transport*

Let's talk about transport.

How do most people travel long distances in your country?

I'd say that the main ways are cars, buses and trains. If someone has a car, I think this is their preference because to be honest the trains are not that much cheaper where I live. Also there are often delays with the trains which can be a real pain, so you may end up with a really long journey. The buses are a bit cheaper but I don't think that is such a comfortable way to travel. There is the option to travel by plane as well of course, but most of the bucket airlines go abroad – you can't really travel that cheaply

by plane within the country. So then, cars are really the best option, and of course they give you the most freedom when you are travelling.

Have the types of transport people use changed much over the last few decades?

I don't think they have really. We've had the transport I mentioned before for many decades now in my country, and it is much the same today. Of course cars have become much more popular as people's incomes have risen which accounts for the problems we see on the roads today such as congestion and more accidents and pollution. This has probably led to some changes within cities. Many have now introduced environmentally friendly forms of transport such as trams and guided buses that don't run on gas and mean that people can travel without the use of the car. There has also been an increase in air travel, but like I said, this is quite expensive in my country so most cannot afford it.

What kinds of improvement have there been in transport in your country in recent years?

There has been several ways that transport has improved. More major roads have been built which means it is easier to travel long distances, though of course some would argue that more roads are not an improvement. They can be an eyesore in the countryside and they have encouraged more people to drive which may mean these improvements ultimately don't work because there are more cars using the roads. As I mentioned before, there has been the introduction of mass transit in many cities, such as trams and trains. In our capital city they have also extended the underground system so it now links many more areas of the city. This has helped many people as commuting times are horrendous if you have to travel on the roads. Those are the main improvements.

IELTS FULL TEST

Good Afternoon. My name is Darrell. Could you tell me your full name please?

My name is Shi-in Lee.

And what should I call you?

You can call me Shi-in please.

Thank you. Do you work or are you a student?

I work. I do interpreting and translation.

Oh. Can you tell me about your job?

Well, there are different types of um interpreting. There is medical interpreting, and there's legal interpreting, business interpreting, and conference interpreting etc. And they are all very different and you get to meet different types of people. Um, it's very rewarding because you are helping people who doesn't have much English and you get paid for you job as well. So you get to learn a lot about current issues, and at the same time, you get a lot of headaches too, because you get to hear a lot of problems from your clients. So it's a very interesting job, and I'm enjoying it still, after seventeen years.

And err, when is the busiest time in your job?

I can't say that um...my busiest you know at a certain time of the year, it's very hard to predict so I really can't say - say around, well Summer is the busiest time of the year, or winter is the busiest or, I really can't say that a certain time of the year is the busiest.

And if you could change your job, what would you prefer to do?

Sometimes umm, although I'm working and I'm helping people and without an interpreter I guess nothing much can happen, because there won't be any communication, proper communication between you know, two parties. But then again, interpreters are not supposed to give an opinion. So you are left with the feeling that you are not contributing at all towards the result of the session. So if I changed my job I think I would pick something which is completely different from interpreting and where I can actually contribute towards the result of the discussion. So that's what I might do in the future, you never know.

What kind of music do you enjoy listening to?

Well actually, I like all sorts of music. My husband says I have Catholic tastes in music. So I like classical music, of course, because I played piano when I was a little girl. Actually, not just as a little girl, I still play. So I like classical music, and I like jazz, blues, you know, even heavy metal. Whatever is good I can appreciate it.

Do you play a musical instrument?

Yes I play piano and I play a little bit of violin as well.

And what musical instruments do most people play in your home country?

Um in Korea, I think most girls from a proper family would play at least one musical instrument and which is normally piano. So, a lot of girls would you know, start playing piano when they are five or say seven. And I started playing piano when I was six I think.

If you can play a musical instrument, does this help you to enjoy music more?

Yes and no. In some ways it makes you, I guess take more interest in music and when you listen to the music you know how to appreciate it properly.

But then again if you get to hear certain pieces of music on the radio which you've played before, straight away you find yourself sort of analysing the performer. So you really can't relax, so it's sort of- it's not maybe enjoyable as much. It suddenly, it becomes a chore; your mind is at work, analysing and assessing the performance. So I guess yes and no.

Thank you. Now I'd like you to speak for one or two minutes on a topic. You have one minute to plan your answer. Here is a pencil and paper to make notes. Here is your topic: I'd like you to describe your favourite teacher.

Thank you. Can you start speaking now please? You have one to two minutes. I will tell you when the time is up.

My favourite teacher, um, his name is Kwan Sing Pak. He was my English teacher when I was in High school in Korea. You know in Korea, all the English teachers are basically Korean. Umm..he was my teacher um, for two years, um Year eleven and Year twelve. You know the girls of that age um they normally like teachers, you know good looking, with the looks, with good sense of humour and- and all. But this specific teacher was not physically attractive at all. He was rather, not terribly good looking. (I'm sorry to be

saying this). But I really adored this teacher because um, I guess to start with I loved studying languages and he was teaching English and I really loved learning English from him. And he was very passionate about his job, teaching, and he was actually enjoying it, and I could tell he was enjoying it. He had good teaching skills. He encouraged and nearly coerced, you know, contribution from the students.

And you could actually be quite sure sitting in his class that when you give answers, how silly they might sound, you would never be laughed at or anything. So you were feeling quite free to have a conversational discussion with the teacher or other students in the class. And what was also quite special about him was that he had good sense of humour, much so much so that you only remember his jokes when actually you have the test paper in front of you and you look at all the questions and you couldn't remember the answers but his jokes only!

Thank you. And did other students also like this teacher?

Oh yes. Yep. Most of the students just loved this teacher. He was very popular.

So we've been talking about teaching. I'd like to ask you some questions about teaching and education. What are the qualities of a good teacher?

I should say a good teacher is one who always is well prepared for the class. And I guess if the person has a good sense of humour that would help because, you know, boring, ah, session, nobody would sit in the class, you know, hours after hours.

And what differences in teaching styles have you experienced with different teachers?

Some teachers can be very knowledgeable. I could tell that the person had a lot of knowledge and experience and everything. But the person just didn't have the skills to convey all that to the students. And so the rendering was really boring and everybody was just falling asleep, whereas some teachers they knew how to pass that down to the teachers somehow and the session was completely enjoyable.

Should teachers use discipline in the classroom?

Coming from where I, um, am, I think yes, teachers should discipline students. In Korea, students would respect the teachers. My mum's generation was more so, and my mum had to say one day, she thought teachers don't eat, don't go to the toilet, they are demi-Gods and wouldn't even step on the shadow of the teacher, because you respect the teacher so much. But I don't think same kind of respect is here and students sometimes

misbehave during class hours and I just find it hard to understand. There is not enough respect for the teachers and also for the learning itself.

And can students learn from computers?

I guess yes and no. I see my children, they're sitting in front of the computer sometimes writing their essays and getting information through the net. In that case, I guess comps can be educational and helpful. But sometimes I see my son sitting in front of the computer hours after hours doing you know, video games. I don't think in that case computers are educational or healthy.

Can you describe the education system in your home country?

In some ways it is quite similar to the Australian education system. The only difference I can tell straightaway is that Kindergarten is not part of the primary school education in Korea whereas here, we start from kindergarten. And three years we call it junior high. And then three years high school, and then four years, normally four years, we call it university education, tertiary education. So I don't think there is big difference between two systems.

When should children start formal schooling?

Formal schooling, I guess it starts in Australia from the age of five whereas in Korea, from six? I don't know, sometimes when I see little K students looking a little bit tired, makes me wonder whether they're a bit too young to be starting schooling at that age. But, I really have no idea.

Has education changed since your parents' day? You know, in the last twenty-five years?

I think it's changed a lot, although I can't say that I understand what education was like when my mum and dad, when they were in school. But definitely, well I'm talking about the Korean situation, in Korea, you have to study many many more subjects than your father or your mother would have, you know, in the past. And you use like different equipment, like computer and things, all these audio-visual teaching material. I guess in that way education has changed a lot.

Ok thank you. That is the end of the speaking test.

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